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The Complete Book of Taijiquan (1995)

《太极拳全书》 — Shen Jiazhen et al. · People's Sports Publishing House, 1995

A page-faithful translation of the 1963 edition, with the Chinese source transcribed alongside and figure notes describing the posture drawings as printed in the book.

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Page 1

《Complete Book of Taijiquan》

Chen-Style Taijiquan

Yang-Style Taijiquan

Wu-Style Taijiquan

Hao-Style Taijiquan

Sun-Style Taijiquan

Note on the Treasured-Books Revised Edition

Our publishing house has been established for more than forty years. In that time we have brought out many books that have been warmly received by our readers. These books have been reprinted again and again, showing their vigorous vitality. Books are humanity's mentors and friends, and sports books are the close companions of sports enthusiasts and sports professionals alike. So that our broad readership may keep these cherished books by their side, our publishing house has carefully selected a batch of excellent titles, and — guided by readers' feedback — revised and changed the content and titles of some of them, and redesigned their bindings, presenting them as treasured editions to our readers. We are certain that these treasured editions will find their way into refined studies everywhere, so that new and long-time readers alike will find them rewarding as soon as they open the covers.

People's Sports Publishing House

Publisher's Note

Taijiquan has a broad popular foundation in our country. The Yang-, Wu-, Hao- (武) and Sun-style taijiquan that evolved and were derived from the earliest Chen-style taijiquan are already familiar to and mastered by countless taijiquan enthusiasts.

In order to introduce — more systematically and completely to our broad readership — the movement characteristics and practice methods of each style of taijiquan, we have compiled into this *Complete Book of Taijiquan* the already-published *Chen-Style Taijiquan* (compiled by Shen Jiazhen and Gu Liuxin), *Yang-Style Taijiquan* (presented by Fu Zhongwen, recorded by Zhou Yuanlong, and edited by Gu Liuxin), *Wu-Style Taijiquan* (compiled by Xu Zhiyi), *Hao-Style Taijiquan* (compiled by Hao Shaoru and edited by Gu Liuxin), and *Sun-Style Taijiquan (Revised Edition)* (compiled by Sun Jianyun). When editing this book, we unified the table of contents and the pagination, corrected the obvious errors and improprieties, and made no changes to the original texts. In addition, to make the illustrations clear and the reading easy, we have re-drawn the illustrations for Hao-style taijiquan, and replaced the original photographic illustrations of Sun-style taijiquan with newly drawn line illustrations. **Colophon** Responsible editor: Wang Jie Cover design: Jin Rong

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Chen-Style Taijiquan

· 1 · (Cover)

Chen-style Taijiquan

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(Title page)

Chen-style Taijiquan

Compiled by Shen Jiazhen and Gu Liuxin
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Chen-style Taijiquan

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Note on the Reprint

This book was printed twice, in 1963 and 1964, and was not reprinted thereafter.

The Chen-style Taijiquan introduced in this book is the oldest of the Taijiquan schools. Its forms are divided into the First Route and the Second Route, both being routines transmitted by the late famous boxer Chen Fake. Chapters One, Two and Three of this book were written by Shen Jiazhen; Chapters Four and Five by Gu Liuxin. The movement illustrations were drawn from photographs of Chen Fake taken during his lifetime, and the postures not covered by these were supplemented with photographs of Chen Fake's son, Chen Zhaokui.

During the preparation of the original book, help was received from Zhou Yuanlong, Shao Bozhou, Yang Jingxuan, Chao Zhenmin, Lei Muni and others, and the text was proofread by Chen Zhaokui.

In this reprint only the "Introduction to Chen-style Taijiquan" has been rewritten and the "Preface" omitted; no changes have been made to the content of the original book. Readers are requested to point out any shortcomings, so that they may be improved.

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April 1980

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Introduction to Chen-style Taijiquan

Chen-style Taijiquan was founded by the famous boxer Chen Wangting at the end of the Ming and the beginning of the Qing dynasty. Chen Wangting was a native of Chenjiagou, Wenxian, Henan. From Chen Wangting onward, the Chen family transmitted and practised Taijiquan through the generations, continually refining and distilling the original routines, and gradually forming the First Route and the Second Route of the modern era. The linked movements of these two sets of forms were all carefully arranged; their speed and intensity differ, and their body methods, amount of exercise and difficulty differ too, yet both accord with the principles of gradual progress and of the mutual complement of hard and soft.

The movements of the First Route are comparatively simple — more soft than hard. It rests chiefly on the use of the four cardinal jins — ward-off, roll-back, press and push — and is assisted by the four corner methods of pluck, rend, elbow and shoulder; in the method of applying force it relies mainly on reeling-silk jin, with issuing jin as a supplement; the movements strive for suppleness, taking neutralising jin as the foundation, meeting hardness with softness and neutralising hardness, and in outward form it has the distinguishing qualities of slowness, softness and steadiness. In the beginning one practises with movements deliberately slow, with emphasis on training reeling-silk jin. In movement the body method leads the hand method, and the aim is to achieve the constantly varying effect of moving-apart (centrifugal force) and still-gathering (centripetal force). Because the movements are relatively slow and the frame is set at high, middle or low level, the amount of exercise can be adjusted; it is therefore suited both to those in good health who wish to strengthen their constitution and to the weak and to patients with certain chronic illnesses, for healing and health preservation. The Second Route (Cannon Fist) has more complex movements and demands speed and compactness — more hard than soft. In the use of jin it relies chiefly on pluck, rend, elbow and shoulder, with ward-off, roll-back, press and push as supplements; the movements strive for firmness and hardness and for rapidity, with emphasis on training elastic jin. The routine contains the movements of "darting, springing and leaping; shifting and dodging, flashing and fighting", and has the distinguishing qualities of fast, hard and leaping. In outward appearance its fastness, hardness and leaping seem no different from other styles of boxing, yet in essence it still has its own characteristics: in movement it continually rotates the waist and turns the spine, rotates the wrist and turns the shoulder, and rotates the ankle and turns the knee, forming a whole series of spiral movements in which one part moves and all parts move, threaded through the whole body. Thereby it obtains the unified function of opening with releasing, closing with gathering, and of containing closing within opening and containing opening within closing. Because this route is fast and its explosive power is strong, it is rather better suited to young and able-bodied people, or to those with better physical strength.

· 1 · Through training in the routine one may gradually come to grasp the content and essentials of such techniques as the mutual complement of hard and soft, that is, what is called the skill of "knowing oneself". In order to make use of the methods of adhering, connecting, sticking and following so as to understand jin, Chen-style Taijiquan also created the adversarial practice of

push hands, that is, the skill of "knowing the other". Chen-style push hands stresses yielding the self to follow the other, bringing one's own technique into play according to the opponent's external force. When the opponent moves urgently, respond urgently; when the opponent moves slowly, follow slowly. Hence one must alternately practise the form and push hands before one can master the skill of understanding jin and reach a degree of proficiency.

Chen-style Taijiquan is an ancient style of boxing. The other schools of Taijiquan (such as the Yang, Wu, Wu-Hao and Sun styles) all developed and innovated on the basis of Chen-style Taijiquan. Chen-style Taijiquan preserves rather more of the martial characteristic of neutralising softly and issuing hard, and to study and research this school of Taijiquan is of great reference value for the inheritance and innovation of the martial arts.

The First and Second Routes of Taijiquan introduced in this book are the forms fixed in the later years of the late Taijiquan master Chen Fake (a descendant of Chen Wangting, 1887–1957).

 Chapter One · The Eight Characteristics of Chen-style Taijiquan Taijiquan is an outstanding style of boxing created and gradually developed by our forebears in the course of long life practice. Only after several hundred years of repeated practice and constant summing-up of experience did people gradually come to understand its inner connections and laws of movement. The Taijiquan manuals left behind by our predecessors are the summation of just such practice. They give us valuable clues for the study of Taijiquan and can help us to learn it better. But, being limited by their times, our predecessors also left no little dross in their theory; hence in our practice we should test it against our new understanding, discard its dross, absorb its essence, and gain a firmer grasp of its correct theory, so that this style of boxing may better serve the people's cause of health care. Therefore, in learning Taijiquan one must from the very outset hold firmly to the correct theory found in these Taijiquan manuals, become familiar with where its crux lies, master it thoroughly, and only then develop and deepen it step by step from that foundation.

Throughout the whole process of movement, Taijiquan is threaded from beginning to end with "yin and yang" and "substantial and insubstantial". In Taijiquan movement this shows as the fact that every form possesses the pairs "opening and closing", "round and square", "rolling and releasing", "insubstantial and substantial", "light and heavy", "soft and hard", and "slow and fast", and that its movement contains the unique forms of left and right, up and down, inside and outside, large and small, advance and retreat, and so on — opposites in unity. These are the basic principles that constitute Taijiquan.

 Taijiquan is not only unique in outward form; it also has its own special requirements in inner work. In practising Taijiquan one must first use intent and not clumsy force; hence Taijiquan is, inwardly, a movement of intent and qi, and outwardly a movement of stirring spirit and qi. That is to say, one must train both intent and qi. This quality of intent-qi movement is where the essence of Taijiquan lies, and it governs the other various characteristics of Taijiquan as well. Moreover, when practising Taijiquan, under the mutual exchange of the extension of the whole body and of reeling silk in the forward and reverse directions, the movement must display both softness and

hardness and be rich in elasticity. Its dynamic quality requires that one part moves and all parts move, that it be threaded joint by joint and linked without interruption, completed in a single breath. Its speed requires both slowness and swiftness, the swift and the slow alternating. Its force requires both softness and hardness, hard and soft complementary. Its stance and movement require central correctness without bias, substance within insubstantiality and insubstantiality within substance, and closing contained within opening and opening contained within closing. Only when these conditions are present can Taijiquan fully develop its special function. In physical culture and health care it not only strengthens the organs of movement and the internal organs but also trains and strengthens the directing power of consciousness — that is, the ability to "use intent and not force" — so that one may smoothly direct the qi to be lively throughout the whole body. In this way one trains both qi and intent; intent and qi grow and strengthen each other, and the body is naturally made strong. Likewise in combat it has its own unique function: one may use lightness to overcome heaviness and slowness to overcome swiftness, subdue the natural and then master the natural; and in movement, one part moving means all parts move, "the whole body as one family", attaining the understanding-jin skill of knowing oneself and the other and of knowing the moment and the situation ①.

The theory of Chen-style Taijiquan has points in common with the theory of the other schools of Taijiquan, and points of difference as well. The characteristics of Chen-style Taijiquan are now set out one by one as follows.

- ① To know the moment is to know time and master time; to know the situation is to know space and master space.

· 4 · **Characteristic One · The Movement of Intent and Qi Governed by the Brain** The manuals lay down:

(1) "Use the mind to move the qi; see that it is always sunk and steady, and only then can it be gathered and drawn into the bones";

(2) "Use the qi to move the body; see that it is always smooth and compliant, and only then can it move easily as the mind directs";

(3) "The mind is the command, the qi is the banner"; "the qi is best nourished by being kept upright, and then it does no harm";

(4) "The whole body's intent is in the spirit, not in the qi; if it is in the qi, then it stagnates."

From these four provisions it can be seen that Taijiquan is a boxing that uses intent to train intent, and also one that moves qi to train qi. But in practising, one must "use the mind to move the qi"; the mind is the one who gives the order and the qi is the "banner-bearer" that carries out the order; every single movement must use intent and not force, with intent moving first and form moving after, so that one may achieve "when intent arrives, qi arrives", and when qi arrives jin arrives; only then can the movement be steady, and only after long practice can the qi be gathered and drawn into the bones, reaching the deepest skill of "moving the qi". Hence it may be said that Taijiquan is a movement of intent and qi. "Using the mind to move the qi", "using the

qi to move the body", and using intent rather than clumsy force, are the first characteristic of Taijiquan.

i. Inner qi and the use of intent

As stated above, the qi is directed by the intent, and this qi is not the air of ordinary lung-breathing, but a kind of "inner qi". In the medical theory of our motherland this qi is called "original qi", "upright qi", the qi that passes through the channels, "pre-natal qi", and so on; it is held to be inherited from the mother's womb. In acupuncture and in qigong therapy this view is still followed today. Martial artists, on the other hand, call this qi "central qi", "inner qi", "inner jin" and so on, holding that only when one has practised to the point where this qi appears and one can master it is one's skill considered "at home".

· 5 · In sum, from ancient times down to the present, whether in the medical theory of our motherland or in martial and religious circles, the existence of this qi has been held, and various practical experiences confirm that such a qi truly exists. But modern science has not yet finally established what its substance is, and scholars at home and abroad who study the channel doctrine of our motherland's medicine do not agree on what this qi is, so that one cannot decide whom to follow. For example, some say this qi is simply the nerves, some say it is bioelectricity, some say it is a special secretion within the human body, some say it is a special functional system within the human body, and so on — every man a different view — and it still awaits further exploration. But the physiological phenomena of the human body are holistic: one cannot say that when intent moves, the nerves and bioelectricity do not move. Therefore, in expounding the qi spoken of in the boxing manuals, we provisionally assume it to be a composite of nerves, bioelectricity, the oxygen in the blood and so on, and provisionally assume it to be a function of the human body still awaiting clarification; the aim is first to inherit the theory of our predecessors so that we may further explore it. In practising Taijiquan one seems to be doing "consciousness gymnastics", always emphasising the use of intent, while the movements of the limbs are merely the outward expression of intent. In this "consciousness gymnastics" what is hidden within is the process of the activity of inner qi, and what shows without is the bearing and the stirring display of outer qi; hence inner qi may issue from within to without, and may also be gathered from without to within.

Although in practising Taijiquan one should "use the qi to move the body", in practising one must not merely think about how the qi runs within the body, but must fix the intent upon the movement; otherwise the bearing will become dull and sluggish, and not only will the qi fail to flow smoothly but it will produce the morbid sign of a scattered qi-situation, so that both intent and qi suffer harm. Hence the manuals say, "Intent is in the spirit, not in the qi; if it is in the qi, then it stagnates." For this very reason, in practising one must pay special attention to the outward display of bearing, since the outward bearing is precisely the showing-forth of the inner intent. Inner intent and outer spirit must not be separated for a moment; if the inner intent relaxes even slightly, the outer spirit will scatter. This point must be known in practising.

Chen-style Taijiquan holds that movement should have both softness and hardness, both round and square, both slow and fast, · 6 · opening and closing. We hold this to accord with the physiological laws of the human body. As everyone knows, when the human body moves, the bioelectric potential rises; when the body is still, the potential falls. And the hardness and softness, opening and closing, swiftness and slowness of Taijiquan movement precisely cause the potential to rise and fall accordingly. When the potential rises, the blood circulation quickens, the partial pressure falls, and oxygen and haemoglobin rapidly dissociate, so that one feels qi. Under normal conditions the nerves cannot remain excited at the same level for a long time; hence bioelectricity generally undulates, and the ceaselessly flowing undulations of hard and soft, swift and slow, round and square in Taijiquan movement likewise accord with this law.

In terms of intent and qi too, it accords with the above law. As said above, the outward bearing and the activity of outer qi are the display of intent and qi to the outside and represent the inner intent and qi. The central link in this outer display of spirit and qi is mainly to pour the inner consciousness into the outer movement and to bring the movement to display a concentration of attention that is single-minded, firm, and lively without stagnation. But the intensity of attention, like the activity of the inner nerves, likewise has the quality of rising and falling. Hence in practising one must adapt to this quality before attention can be stabilised. At the same time, only when attention is stabilised will the thoughts not wander. But to maintain attention at an equal intensity for a long time while practising is not easy to do. In fact, even within a moment the degree of fluctuation of attention has its highs and lows. Therefore, in the course of movement, if one adopts a calm, wave-less kind of movement without fluctuation, one not only violates the above physiological law but also destroys the stability of attention. Hence, in order to stabilise attention, Taijiquan adopts a series of provisions (such as the alternation of swift and slow, the mutual containment of opening and closing, the mutual generation of round and square, and the mutual complement of hard and soft), and unifies them within a single movement.

These provisions cause intent-qi movement naturally to produce fluctuation, and cause the outward stirring of spirit and qi and the inward fluctuation of intent and qi to be coordinated, thereby raising the inner intent-qi movement, which in turn promotes the outer movement.

· 7 · Because Taijiquan is a movement of intent and qi, one who has long practised it can, merely by thinking of a certain part of the body, produce activity of qi there. Hence many people spare no time and go through the form morning and evening, constantly correcting the form, precisely in order to achieve this. Once the movements of Taijiquan have been practised into a fixed form, the processes of excitation and inhibition in the cerebral cortex can accurately alternate according to a definite programme; at the same time, the muscles can contract and relax in coordination, and even if one is suddenly stimulated by chance, this coordinated movement will not be impaired. To achieve this shows that a most solid coordinating relation has been established between the activity of the muscles and the internal organs: as soon as intent arrives, qi arrives, and as soon as qi arrives, jin arrives.

ii. The realisation of intent-qi movement

It should also be pointed out that in the use of intent and qi, Taijiquan and the static exercises (sitting, standing and lying practice) are the same, both laying stress on training intent and training qi. But Taijiquan trains amid movement (seeking stillness in movement), and so is called a movement of intent and qi; whereas the static exercises have no movement, seeking stillness alone, so the two must not be confused.

Precisely because Taijiquan trains both inner and outer, and seeks stillness amid movement, in order to do the inner intent-qi movement well one must clearly bring out the outer stirring of spirit and qi. As the "Heart Understanding of Practising the Form" says, "The form is like a falcon striking a hare; the spirit is like a cat catching a mouse." And to achieve this skill of inner-outer union and mutual training, one must fulfil the requirements of the seven characteristics set out below in this chapter; that is, only by realising those seven characteristics can this characteristic — that Taijiquan is a movement of intent and qi — be realised. In other words, although the characteristics are divided into eight, they actually dwell together in one unity, with inner connections, and are separated only for convenience of exposition.

Before describing the remaining seven characteristics in detail, let us briefly explain the role of these seven characteristics in carrying out the characteristic of intent-qi movement. Characteristic Two — elastic movement, which is the extension of the limbs and body, and may be said to be, · 8 · the result of elasticity. The soft, yielding elasticity is the inner factor that promotes the stirring of the limbs and body. Without elasticity the movement becomes rigid, and then the outward display of stirring spirit and qi can no longer be formed, and of course it cannot be coordinated with the inner fluctuation of intent and qi.

Characteristic Three — spiral movement, which can strengthen the rising-and-falling fluctuation of movement. If movement goes straight back and forth, without the up-and-down, inside-and-outside turning, it cannot bring about the rising-and-falling fluctuation of spirit, intent-qi and body method. For this, one must combine the wrist-turning and shoulder-turning, ankle-turning and knee-turning, and waist-turning and spine-turning of forward-reverse spiral movement, so as to achieve a Taiji jin that is threaded as one through the spirals and poured into all movements. In this way, when one does not move, so be it; when one moves, the situation of stirring is naturally formed, becoming the movement core for doing intent-qi movement well.

Characteristic Four — adjusting substantial and insubstantial, which is the root of the agile exchange of intent and qi and of the sensation of round liveliness like a pearl, and is the power-source of the stirring. The exchange of substantial and insubstantial in which the upper follows the lower and the lower follows the upper can cause the spirit-qi and the body method to be lively without stagnation, and the stirring of spirit-qi arises therefrom. If upper and lower cannot follow each other and substantial and insubstantial are not adjusted, then inner jin cannot reach central correctness without bias. If inner jin is biased, then inner jin and body method lean to one side, losing the requirement of supporting all eight directions. It is not easy to achieve the stirring of spirit-qi in a posture where the inner jin leans to one side.

Characteristic Five (threading joint by joint) and Characteristic Six (completed in a single breath) are essentially two stages of one characteristic; the former means that within one form the main joints of the whole body are required to be threaded like a dragon, passing through one joint after another in sequence; the latter means that in practising the whole set one form must be linked to the next without interruption, completed in a single breath, so as to enlarge the amount of exercise and achieve the concrete requirement of joint-by-joint stirring. If one cannot thread joint by joint, then broken jin arises, and where jin is broken there can be no stirring to speak of. If one cannot complete it in a single breath, then it is broken and unlinked, and where it is unlinked each form becomes isolated and cannot stir in a single breath. Hence if these two characteristics are not done well, the stirring of spirit-qi cannot be done well, so they are closely interlinked.

· 9 · Characteristic Seven (the mutual complement of hard and soft) and Characteristic Eight (the alternation of swift and slow) are two characteristics that unify the contradictions of two opposites, and are also characteristics that must be possessed technically in order to achieve the stirring of spirit and qi. Without this intertwining-as-one of swift and slow, hard and soft, it is not easy to make the preceding characteristics cooperate closely and to produce rising-and-falling fluctuation. Because these two characteristics require one to achieve "soft yet slow" and "hard yet swift", requiring hardness and swiftness to rise like an advancing wave and softness and slowness to fall back like a receding wave, such mutual intertwining will form a ceaselessly flowing propelling action. This action of the mutual complement of hard and soft and of the alternation of swift and slow can, in physical culture, achieve slow and soft movement of qi and hard and swift movement landing-points, so that qi travels throughout the body without any trace of dullness; and in combat it enables one to "respond urgently when the other moves urgently, and follow slowly when the other moves slowly", so that one can achieve the yielding of "when the other is hard, I am soft" and the sticking of "when the other is soft, I am hard". These two characteristics can drive the inner intent-qi movement and the outer stirring of spirit-qi to the peak of fluctuation.

From this it can be seen that Characteristic One is the characteristic that governs the other seven, but at the same time it can only be realised with the help of the other seven. Their relation is like that of the peony and its green leaves: they complete each other, and also restrain each other and promote each other. This must be known when first learning.

To make the first characteristic easier to grasp, its essentials are summarised as follows:

(1) In practising, the intent must always be concentrated on the movement, using intent to move qi; one must not merely silently think about how the inner qi runs.

(2) In practising, the movement must be smooth and steady, and when jin reaches its end-point it must display its jin category — these are the three measures by which intent and qi are made to stir.

(3) Firmly grasp the outer display of the stirring of spirit and qi, so as to avoid dullness and sluggishness, and in turn promote the inner intent-qi movement. (4) Skilfully use the other seven characteristics, so as to coordinate and raise the intent-qi movement.

· 10 · **Characteristic Two · The Elastic Movement of Extended Limbs and Body** The manuals lay down:

(1) "Empty the collar and lift the crown; sink the qi to the cinnabar field";

(2) "Hollow the chest and raise the back; sink the shoulders and drop the elbows";

(3) "Loosen the waist and round the crotch; open the hips and bend the knees";

(4) "Gather the spirit and restrain the qi; extend the body and hands".

From the four provisions listed above it can be seen that emptying the collar and lifting the crown and sinking the qi to the cinnabar field serve to extend the trunk; hollowing the chest and raising the back serve to extend the back, using the front of the chest as a pillar; sinking the shoulders and dropping the elbows serve to extend the arms; and loosening the waist and rounding the crotch and opening the hips and bending the knees, and enabling the legs to turn roundly and lively, are the result of extending the legs in this particular posture. Hence the stepping of Taijiquan must, in the posture of rounded crotch, loosened waist, opened hips and bent knees, exchange substantial and insubstantial by turning the ankles and rotating the legs. Outwardly this is the display of the reeling-silk jin of the legs; inwardly, in fact, it promotes the extension of the legs. This series of extensions in turn brings about the extension of the whole body; the limbs and body not only produce elasticity, forming ward-off jin, but, because the whole body is extended, the spirit is also naturally raised. Hence, so long as one has the extending posture, one will not easily fall into the fault of straining and drumming up force (clumsy force), and conditions are provided for natural loosening and for the extension of body and hands. Therefore the elastic movement of extended limbs and body becomes the second characteristic of Taijiquan.

i. Extension of the limbs and body

As said above, in practising Taijiquan the limbs and body must be extended, so as to strengthen the elasticity of the whole body; only with elasticity can one proceed further to ward-off jin. That is to say, ward-off jin is born of elasticity, and elasticity is born of the extension of the limbs and body. As to how each part of the body is to be extended, it is now set out one by one according to the manuals as follows.

· 11 · (1) Emptying the collar and lifting the crown, and sinking the qi to the cinnabar field — what is meant by "emptily lifting the crown jin" is that the crown jin is emptily lifted upward, and sinking the qi to the cinnabar field is sinking the qi downward into the cinnabar field; taken together, in consciousness there is the intention of pulling apart in opposite directions, and this gives the body the sensation of extension. (2) Hollowing the chest and raising the back — hollowing the chest requires that the chest neither protrude nor cave in, making the chest a pillar for the extension of the back, since in mechanics a compression member is not allowed to be bent. The back relies on this pillar to be extended, and this is the extension of the back. On this point, a beginner must not mistake a protruded chest for raised back; for a hunched back will

make the front of the chest cave in, which will make the front of the chest lose its pillar function, so that not only does the back lose its extending elasticity but it is also harmful to health.

(3) Sinking the shoulders and dropping the elbows — the main function of sinking the shoulders is to join the arms firmly to the shoulders through sinking down. Only when the arm is joined firmly to the shoulder can the arm take root. At the same time, dropping the elbows brings about extension between the elbows and the shoulders. When the arms perform the spiral reeling-silk movement, it is the dropping of the elbows that serves as its centre. At the same time, dropping the elbows and sitting the wrists can also extend between the elbows and the wrists. Hence sinking the shoulders, dropping the elbows and sitting the wrists constitute the extension of the whole arm.

(4) The rotation of opening the hips and bending the knees — this is the extension of the legs. The legs stand on the ground, so extension is comparatively difficult. Hence the requirement of opening the hips and bending the knees is laid on the legs, requiring that in this particular posture (rounded crotch) the substantial and insubstantial be exchanged by spiral movement, which shows mainly in the rotation of the knee-cap. Thus, when the leg rotates outward, the outer side is extended while the inner side contracts. This rotation of the legs, coordinating with the rotation of the hand, arm and body, becomes the rotation of the whole body, rising step by step, and one may then attain the jin of complete unity — "its root is in the feet, it issues in the legs, it is governed by the waist, and it takes form in the fingers".

Looking over the four provisions listed above, it can be seen that Taijiquan lays a requirement of extension on the trunk, the hands and the feet. Thereby not only is elasticity produced by the extension, becoming the founda- · 12 · tion of Taijiquan's ward-off jin, but also people's spirit is naturally raised, so that one does not fall into the morbid sign of drumming up force and so producing clumsy force ①.

ii. The physiological effect of extension

When a muscle is subjected to force it may lengthen to a certain degree, but as soon as the external cause of the lengthening is removed it immediately returns to its original state — this is the elasticity inherent in the muscle itself. Ordinary common exercise is simply the training and raising of this elasticity. Judged by human physiology, this elastic contraction and extension of the muscle can have the following four effects:

(1) It can give the muscle's own ability to contract and extend a good training, and can make smooth the dense network of capillaries within the muscle.

(2) It can strengthen the metabolism of the tissue cells and stimulate all the life processes within the body.

(3) It can strengthen the gas exchange of the muscles and of all other tissues and organs.

(4) It can give the body more oxygen, and at the same time raise the rate at which the various tissues and organs utilise oxygen.

Taijiquan is not a mere movement of the limbs and body. What shows without is the stirring of the bearing, with postures extremely complex and varied; what is hidden within is gathered spirit and restrained qi, "using the mind to move the qi" — all of which has been explained in detail under the first characteristic. Moreover, Taijiquan not only trains both inner and outer, but also performs, throughout the extension of the limbs and body, the spiral forward-reverse reeling-silk movement of twisting back and forth. Thereby not only is the elasticity of the muscle itself

- ① Extension gives the body and hands a sensation within of being slender and long, whereas the production of ward-off force is due to drumming up force, which gives the body and hands a sensation within of being thick and short. Hence extension of the limbs and body will naturally not fall into the morbid sign of drumming up force and so producing clumsy force.

· 13 · given good training, and the speed of the blood circulation is raised, so that illnesses caused by impeded blood flow can be eliminated. This is one of the important effects produced by Taijiquan's extension of the limbs and body and its raising of the spirit.

Moreover, the elastic movement of Taijiquan also has a marked influence on lowering blood pressure, because in the process of the muscle's contraction and extension there are produced such substances as triphosphoric acid and adenylic acid that dilate the blood vessels. At the same time, in the activity of threading joint by joint the number of capillaries opened within the muscle increases many times over, and this too enlarges the cross-section of the blood-vessel communication, and so can lower blood pressure. Furthermore, because in practising the muscles repeatedly extend and recover, the blood vessels are not easily hardened. Especially with the coordination of the twisting, back-and-forth spiral movement, hardening of the blood vessels can be still further prevented. A person who has long practised Taijiquan for many years will, in practising, feel that the blood vessels in the back and in the four limbs seem to have enlarged, making one feel relaxed and comfortable in movement; whereas after some time without practice one has a sensation of blockage. The production of this phenomenon is precisely due to the increase or decrease in the number of opened capillaries.

iii. The eight gateways of jin and elastic ward-off jin

Taijiquan requires the use of intent and not clumsy force, but this does not mean using intent and not using jin, for Taijiquan is constituted of the eight gateways of jin. All eight gateways of jin possess extending elasticity, and so they are called "jin" and not "force". Though the names of the eight gateways differ, in essence they are but one ward-off jin, and the other seven are merely given other names because their direction and function differ. Hence Taijiquan may also be called the boxing of ward-off jin. The content of the eight gateways is now analysed as follows, so as to make the second characteristic easier to grasp.

(1) With the whole in motion, when the centre of the palm reels silk from inside outward, it is called ward-off jin;

(2) With the whole in motion, when the centre of the palm reels silk from outside inward, it is called roll-back jin;

(3) When both hands at the same time ward off the ward-off jin outward crosswise, it is called press jin;

· 14 · (4) The downward ward-off jin in which the centre of the palm circles downward, touching one point without leaving it, is called push jin;

(5) The ward-off jin in which both hands cross and separate to left and right, front and back, is called pluck jin; (6) The jin that rolls the ward-off jin up and stores it, then suddenly shakes and flicks it out within a short distance, is called rend jin;

(7) When the wrist has gone beyond the round-square circle and wards off outward using the ward-off jin of the second line of defence, it is called elbow jin;

(8) When the elbow has gone beyond the round-square circle and wards off outward using the ward-off jin of the body as the third line of defence, it is called shoulder jin.

Summing up what has been said above, in the last analysis the one chiefly trained within is ward-off jin. Ward-off jin is a soft, ceaseless "spring jin". This is the problem that must first be made clear.

iv. Mastering elastic movement (ward-off jin)

(1) To train ward-off jin one must first destroy the original stiffness in a person's body. In any movement — for example lifting a heavy object — force must be used, and over the years this makes a person form, from childhood on, the habit of drumming up force to carry or lift weights. Drumming up force is straining, also called clumsy jin, whereas what Taijiquan requires is the spring jin of the whole body extended. Hence in practising Taijiquan there should be two stages: first the stage of eliminating the drummed-up force, then the stage of growing the new spring jin. If the old jin does not go, the new jin is not born; so the boxing discourse says, "Movement is like steel tempered a hundred times; what hardness can it not shatter ①?" That is to say, one must pass through a hundred smeltings and a thousand temperings in which no clumsy force whatever is used, and, in the various postures of extension and loosening, perform the twisting, back-and-forth kneading, before one can reach the point of extreme softness and shatter the person's

- ① The "Heart Understanding of Practising the Form" is a theoretical document guiding the practice of the form; it is not a rule governing two-person push hands.

· 15 · old stiffness — that is to say, so long as movement is like steel tempered a hundred times, then any stiff jin at all may be shattered without remainder. This is the sum of the experience of former masters of boxing, so this transforming of hardness into softness is an indispensable stage, which the beginner must on no account neglect. The longer this stage lasts the better, because only thereby can one become more thoroughly soft. Otherwise, if one's softness is not thorough, in the future it will be hard for the practitioner to avoid remaining within the shortcoming of having too little softness and too much hardness, and so being unable to reach balance.

(2) Ward-off jin is not a jin inherent in the human body. As said above, of the eight gateways of jin, ward-off jin is the basic one. Ward-off jin is born of elasticity; this elastic jin is not only the elasticity of the muscle itself, but is trained from the joint extension of the bones and ligaments and so on together with the muscles upon the basis of muscular elasticity. Hence it is not a jin inherent in the human body, but a jin that can be produced only after long practice. Its development is from nothing to having, and from having to strength. To train this elastic ward-off jin, one should do one's utmost according to the four provisions of the manual given above. The key essential is still to begin from the use of intent, so that in one's thinking there is the idea of extension. When this has been used for a long time, then together with the concrete extension of the limbs and body, one will not readily go astray.

(3) Gathered spirit and restrained qi are the foundation for strengthening elasticity and raising ward-off jin. When the limbs and body are extended, a person's spirit is raised and concentrated and the qi sinks and is restrained within — this is a naturally occurring phenomenon. Conversely, that is to say, so long as spirit is gathered and qi restrained, one can guide consciousness to have the bearing of extension, causing the limbs and body to extend, and thereby raising elasticity and strengthening ward-off jin. At the instant of gathered spirit and restrained qi, the muscle groups contract more fully, while the opposing muscle groups relax more fully; hence, through long training in relaxation and contraction, the elasticity of each part of the limbs and body is naturally strengthened, and at the same time the constitutional quality of the body is raised.

To make the second characteristic easier to grasp, its essentials are summarised as the following five points:

(1) Taijiquan chiefly trains ward-off jin; ward-off jin is born of elasticity, and elasticity is born · 16 · of the extension of the limbs and body, so one must pay attention to the extension of the limbs and body.

(2) The extension of the trunk and the upper part must be by emptying the collar and lifting the crown, sinking the qi to the cinnabar field, and hollowing the chest and raising the back.

(3) The extension of the hands and feet must be by sinking the shoulders and dropping the elbows, loosening the waist and rounding the crotch, and the rotation of opening the hips and bending the knees.

(4) In training ward-off jin, first seek softness and yielding so as to remove the old force (clumsy force), and at the same time extend so as to grow the new elastic jin.

(5) Only practising with gathered spirit and restrained qi is the inner factor that strengthens ward-off jin.

Characteristic Three · The Spiral Movement of Reeling Silk

The manuals lay down:

(1) "Movement is like drawing silk";

(2) "Movement is like reeling silk";

(3) "However you open out and gather in, never for a moment may you depart from the Taiji";

(4) "The skilled hand, in a single movement, is a single Taiji; when the traces have wholly melted away, it returns to nothingness."

From the four provisions listed above it can be seen that Taijiquan movement must have the form of drawing silk. Drawing silk is drawn out with a revolving motion, for in drawing straight within revolving a spiral form is naturally produced — this is the unity of the opposites curved and straight. As for reeling-silk jin or silk-drawing jin, both mean this. Because in the process of reeling, in extending and contracting the four limbs one likewise produces a spiral appearance, so the boxing discourse says that whether the movement is a large one opening out or a small compact one, one may never depart from this Taiji jin of opposites in unity. When one has practised until proficient, the reeling-silk circles are practised smaller and smaller, reaching the state of there being a circle but no circle seen · 17 · — the state where one knows purely by intent ① — and so the spiral movement of the unity of the opposites of forward and reverse reeling silk becomes the third characteristic of Taijiquan.

i. The essence of movement as reeling silk

Taijiquan movement must be like reeling silk, or like drawing silk. Both these figurative comparisons say that the appearance of the movement is like a spiral. At the same time, this spiral must travel along an arc: just as a bullet, after passing through the rifling in the gun-barrel, in moving through space has both a spiral rotation of its own and a parabolic path of movement. The reeling-silk jin of Taijiquan must possess this appearance.

Having explained above the meaning that movement must be like reeling silk, how then should it be carried out in actual movement? It is extremely ordinary and simple: under the requirement of one part moving and all parts moving, the centre of the palm turns from inside outward or from outside inward during the movement ②, making it form the image of the Taiji diagram (as in Figure 1). At the same time, because the centre of the palm turns inward and outward, in the upper limbs this shows as turning the wrist and rotating the shoulder, in the lower limbs as turning the ankle and rotating the leg ③, and in the trunk as turning the waist and rotating the spine. The three combined form a spatial revolving curve whose root is in the feet, which is governed by the waist, and which takes form in the fingers. This is a requirement that Taijiquan must fulfil. Hence the manuals especially point out that in practising, whether the movement opens out broadly or is compact

- ① The small frame that Mr Yang Shaohou set out in his later years shows only the issuing of jin, not the movement. This is because the movement circles have become so small as to be invisible, leaving only the concrete display of the issuing of jin; it is the proficient skill of compactness in which no circle is seen.
- ② What is meant by turning from inside outward or outside inward is standardised by the turning of the index finger. As in Figure 1, when the hand goes from point 1 to point 2, the

movement of the index finger at this time is a turning from inside outward, and so it is forward reeling; when the hand goes from point 2 to point 3, the movement of the index finger is a turning from outside inward, and so it is reverse reeling.

- ③ The division of the legs' forward and reverse reeling silk is standardised by the direction of rotation of the knee: when the knee, from the inner side of the patella, turns forward and downward, obliquely reeling outward, or from the outer side of the patella turns backward and upward, obliquely reeling inward, both are forward reeling; when the knee, from the outer side of the patella, turns forward and upward, obliquely reeling inward, or from the inner side of the patella turns backward and downward, obliquely reeling outward, both are reverse reeling.

· 18 · (A) Diagram of the left hand's reeling silk (B) Diagram of the right hand's reeling silk
Notes: 1. The solid-line segments are forward reeling silk; the dashed lines are reverse reeling silk. 2. Every point marked in the diagrams is a change-over point of the reeling silk.

图 L0F1

Diagrams of forward and reverse reeling silk: (A) diagram of the left hand's reeling silk; (B) diagram of the right hand's reeling silk. The solid-line segments are forward reeling silk, the dashed-line segments are reverse reeling silk, and every point marked in the diagrams is a change-over point of the reeling silk.

图 L0F2

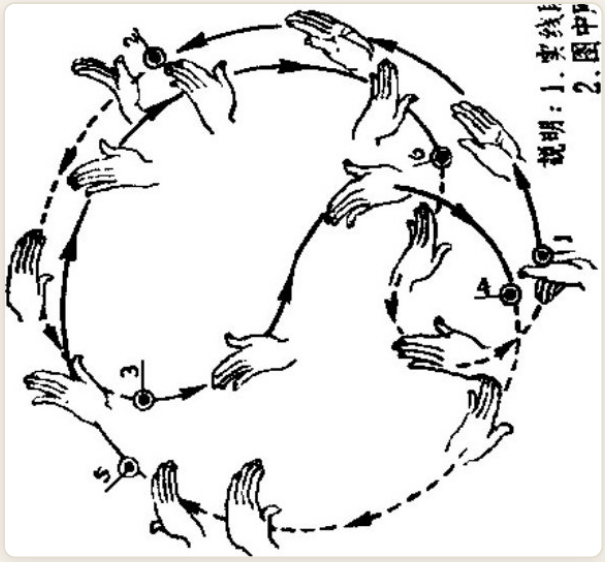


Diagram of one-directional arc movement: a straight back-and-forth arc, where the pressure opposes the direction of the drive-out, and so butting-resistance is produced (the small labels read "pressure" and "produces butting-resistance").

图 L0F3

Diagram of spiral silk-drawing movement: silk-drawing movement on a spiral rod, where the pressure can fall away through the rotation.

图 L0F4

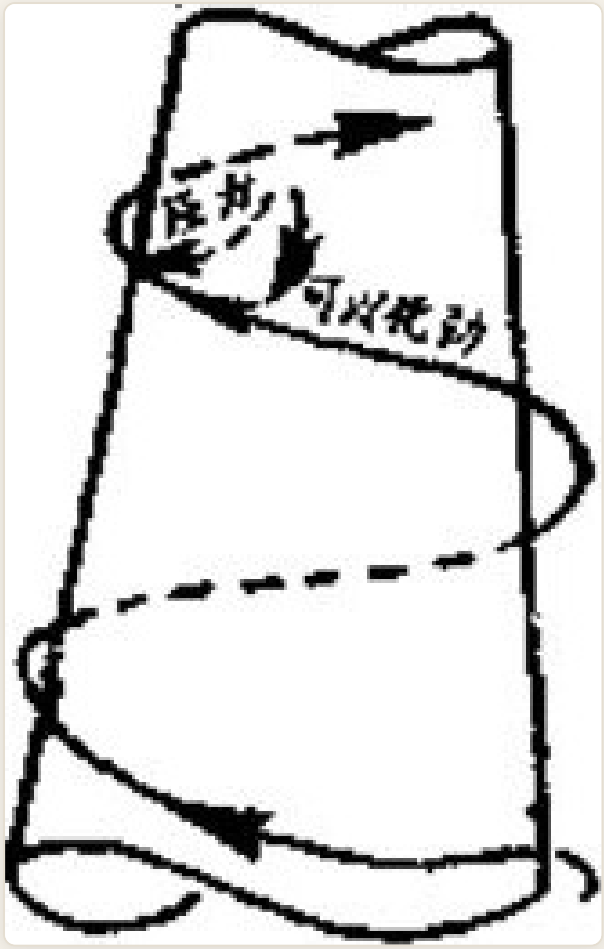


Diagram of the twelve reeling-silk jin categories: "basic reeling silk" divides into "forward reeling silk" and "reverse reeling silk", and governs below it "directional reeling silk", which further divides into the five pairs of directional reeling silk: left-right, up-down, inside-outside, large-small, and advance-retreat.

and for threading joint by joint like the whole body as one family, there is also the coordination of the two pairs of directional reeling silk, large-small and advance-retreat, so as to satisfy the special needs of health and of combat. Hence every form of Taijiquan must, upon the basis of the forward-reverse basic reeling silk, have at least three pairs of directional reeling silk combined together in the movement. So long as one has grasped this law, one may have a definite basis for the movement in drawing arcs, and both learning and correcting the forms will be much easier. In practising, if one feels that some movement has lost its proper position and feel, one may, according to where the reeling silk is not smooth, shift the waist and legs a little, so as to obtain smoothness, and the posture can then be corrected. Hence to have grasped the reeling silk is to have grasped the tool of self-correction. Let us now give examples to illustrate its function.

(1) "Cloud Hands" — this form is the only one among the thirteen postures that contains the large left-right reeling silk of double forward turning to double reverse. In the movement, the basic reeling silk of the two hands is the forward reeling silk in which the centre of the palm turns from inside outward, turning to the reverse reeling silk in which it turns from outside inward; its directional reeling silk is left-right, up-down, and slightly inside-outside. Left-right and up-down are a flat circle; if · 22 · one further makes the drawn circle slightly inside-outside, it can become a three-dimensional circle of a spatial curve, and can attain the function of qi adhering to the back.

(2) "White Crane Spreads Its Wings" — its basic reeling silk is one forward and one reverse, a kind of reeling silk rather common within the forms; its directional reeling silk is left-right, up-down and inside-outside. Because it is one forward and one reverse, in the left hand it is reverse reeling silk turning inward and downward, and in the right hand it is forward reeling silk turning outward and upward; the two together, under the requirement that the two arms be linked ①, become the "right-forward left-reverse separating ward-off circle" of upper-right and lower-left.

The examples above show that although the various forms of Taijiquan are manifold and their turns differ one from another, yet analysed from their basic reeling silk they are extremely simple. All the forms come down to no more than the three combinations "double forward reeling silk", "double reverse reeling silk", and "one forward one reverse reeling silk". If one constantly analyses and ponders one's own accustomed form by this method, and makes a table of it, it can become one's own basis for practice. With such a basis one can distinguish the jin categories clearly, achieve inner-outer union and threading joint by joint, and reach the requirement of correct posture upon the foundation of raised elasticity.

iv. Mastering spiral movement

Characteristic Three is the origin of the boxing's name "Taiji", and its function has been as described above. Hence our predecessors, in order to enable later students to practise movement like reeling silk well, made a special treatise in the "Taijiquan Treatise", which is a summation in practice of movement. The first part of it discusses reeling-silk jin. To master Characteristic Three one need only practise according to this part, and use it as the basis for normally checking one's own form, and one can obtain correct posture and movement. We now

- ① The linking of the two arms means that in movement the two arms seem to be tied to each other by a rope: when one arm moves, the other can also move along with it, keeping the rope essentially taut — that is, the two arms must always contain a tautly drawn ward-off jin.

· 23 · summarise and explain this part as follows.

(1) Grasping Characteristic Three from the spiritual substance. (A) "In every single movement, the whole body must be light and nimble" — if the spirit can be raised, there need be no worry of heaviness and sluggishness; this is the method of seeking lightness. If intent and qi can be agilely exchanged, then intent and qi will not stagnate at any one point; this is the method of seeking nimbleness. The first point in grasping reeling-silk jin is that in the course of movement

the whole body must be light and nimble, for only thus can favourable conditions be provided for doing the reeling-silk movement well.

(B) "The movement must be threaded joint by joint" — in movement like reeling silk, one must be light and nimble, and especially must thread through; this too is an important link in movement, which must not be neglected in learning. For its details, see Characteristic Five of this chapter.

(C) "The spirit should stir; the qi should be restrained within" ① — if the mind cannot carry through into the movement but has other thoughts, showing dull intent and sluggish spirit, then the spirit will not easily stir, and at the same time the qi cannot be restrained within so as to follow the mind, with the result that the qi-situation becomes scattered, the jin has no reserve, and the body method is disordered. Hence one must first carry the mind through into the ceaselessly flowing and ever-rising-and-falling movement; then the spirit will of itself stir. Next, one must make the lung-breathing coordinate with the movement. Because the spirit stirs, the qi of itself is restrained and does not become scattered; and when the qi is not scattered, it can, led by the spirit, be stirred together with it.

Looking over the three requirements listed above, one may say that "movement light and nimble and threaded through; spirit-qi stirring and restrained within" is precisely the spiritual substance that must be grasped in mastering reeling-silk jin.

(2) Grasping Characteristic Three from jin categories.

(A) "Let there be no place of defect" — in applying reeling-silk jin, whether forward or reverse, one must always bring the eight gateways of jin onto the back of the spiral's bow — that is, onto the spiral's contact surface — and must on no account be sometimes on the back of the bow and sometimes sunk inside the bow. This is the fault into which reeling silk most readily

- ① Spirit and qi may be stirred, and may also be restrained within. Hence the boxing discourse says, "If you would have the spirit-qi stir, you must first raise the spirit, so that the spirit does not scatter outward."

 falls. Once it sinks inside, it not only weakens the ward-off jin but also loses the frictional property in the reeling silk. Hence, if once there is a defect, the jin cannot reach the spiral's contact surface, and the pulling function of the reeling-silk jin is also lost (as in Figure 5).

(B) "Let there be no place of convexity or concavity" — in the path of application of reeling-silk jin, all processes must achieve a gentle curve and form a smooth and compliant posture; at the same time, they must be soft and yielding yet rich in elasticity, and this is one method of eliminating convexity and concavity. Even when issuing jin one must fling it out like a soft leather whip. In this way, because the body and hands are extended, the limbs and body are Figure 5 · Diagram of the defect in reeling silk — a place in the Taiji diagram caves in inward, beside it the label "defect".

Figure 6 · Diagram of the convexities and concavities of silk drawing — the reeling path shows many sharp convex-concave bends and notches.

图 L0F5

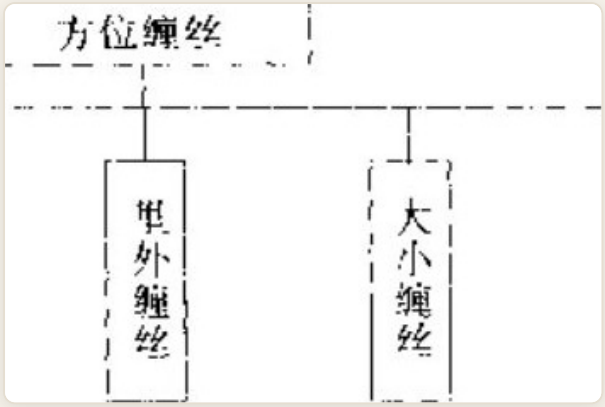


Diagram of the defect in reeling silk: a place of inward depression, a "defect", appearing in the reeling-silk path.

图 L0F6

Diagram of the convexities and concavities of silk drawing: many sharp convex-concave bends and notches appearing in the reeling-silk path.

图 L0F7

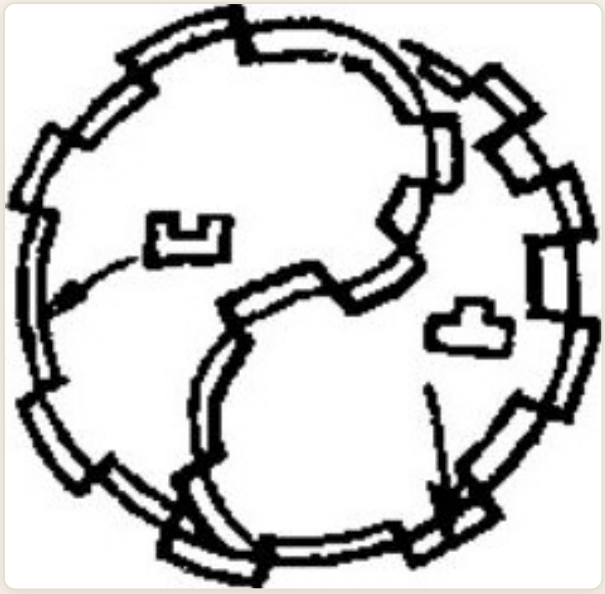


Diagram that reeling silk must have no break or continuation: on a single circle of reeling-silk path, the upper and lower sections are marked "this section must have no break or continuation", and the two sides are marked "related parts".

Looking over the three items listed above, they explain that in the process of reeling silk — that is, in the process of movement — one must on no account produce the faults of defect, convexity-concavity, or break-and-continuation. Of these three faults, even if one commits one, one can no longer develop the function that reeling-silk jin should have. This is a problem that must not be neglected in learning.

To make it easier to grasp, the essentials are now summarised as follows.

(1) Reeling-silk jin is the origin of the naming of Taijiquan; without reeling-silk jin one cannot make the jin rise joint by joint around the limbs and body and reach complete single breath.

(2) One must know that the requirement of "threading through" is not only that the movement must pass through the joints, but also that it must pass through the flesh above and below the whole joint; this is the function of spiral reeling silk.

(3) Taijiquan has one pair of basic reeling silks and five pairs of directional reeling silks, which are the · 26 · the best tool for [learning] Taijiquan.

(4) Movement as reeling silk can be realised only under the conditions of lightness-nimbleness and threading through; at the same time, in respect of spirit-qi there must be stirring and restraining within.

(5) In the application of reeling-silk jin, one must not produce the three faults of defect, convexity-concavity, and break-and-continuation.

Characteristic Four · The Substantial-Insubstantial Movement of an Upright, Centred Body with Upper and Lower Following Each Other

The manuals lay down:

(1) "Intent and qi must be exchanged nimbly, and only then is there the delight of round liveliness — this is what is meant by saying that in changing and turning, substantial and insubstantial must be attended to."

(2) "Substantial and insubstantial should be clearly distinguished; each place has its own substantial and insubstantial, and every place always has this one insubstantial and one substantial."

(3) "Standing must be central, correct, at ease and comfortable, supporting all eight directions"; "when upper and lower follow each other, the opponent finds it hard to invade."

(4) "The coccyx is centred and the spirit runs through to the crown"; "upper and lower are one thread."

The four provisions listed above can explain that all the movements of Taijiquan must clearly distinguish substantial and insubstantial. If movement can clearly distinguish substantial and insubstantial in its change-over, then one can endure long without fatigue; this is the most economical kind of motive activity. Hence in practising Taijiquan both hands must have substantial and insubstantial, and both feet must have substantial and insubstantial; and what is especially important is that the left hand and left foot, and the right hand and right foot, must clearly distinguish substantial and insubstantial with upper and lower following each other — that is, when the left hand is substantial the left foot should be insubstantial, and when the right hand is insubstantial the right foot should be substantial. This is the central link in regulating inner jin so as to keep it central and correct. Moreover, in forming the landing-point, within the insubstantial there must be substantial and within the substantial there must be insubstantial, so that in every place there is always this one insubstantial and one substantial, and inner jin everywhere attains central correctness without bias. In the beginning one may use large-insubstantial and large-sub- · 27 · stantial, and afterwards gradually train into small-insubstantial and small-substantial, finally reaching the state where within there is substantial and insubstantial but without no substantial and insubstantial is seen; this is the deepest skill of adjusting substantial and insubstantial.

The core of the nimble exchange of substantial and insubstantial lies in the nimble exchange of intent and qi, and at the same time it must be accomplished under the condition of "the central earth not leaving its place" ① and of central correctness of inner jin. For this, in practising one must at all times adjust substantial and insubstantial by "the coccyx centred", "at ease and comfortable, supporting all eight directions", "emptying the collar and lifting the crown", and "upper and lower are one thread". Hence an upright, centred body and the adjustment of substantial and insubstantial with upper and lower following each other become the fourth characteristic of Taijiquan.

i. Proportions of substantial and insubstantial

According to Taijiquan theory, in all movements substantial and insubstantial must be clearly distinguished, so in practising one must see that the movement has, in every place, this one insubstantial and one substantial. In order to adjust substantial and insubstantial well, one must first recognise the correct meaning of substantial and insubstantial. What is called insubstantial is not being wholly without force; what is called substantial is likewise not being wholly weighted down. Taking the two feet, the insubstantial is not that this foot bears no load at all, and the substantial is not that all the load is placed on that one foot (excepting such forms as lifting the leg, standing on one leg, and wrist-locking and seizing), but merely that the insubstantial is somewhat lighter in load than the substantial. The origin of these terms substantial and insubstantial is, mechanically speaking, that the centre of gravity of the body's total load constantly shifts. When the centre of gravity shifts to the right, then the right foot is substantial and the left foot insubstantial; when it shifts to the left, then the left foot is substantial and the right foot insubstantial (as in Figure 8). As said above, the motive power of Taijiquan is itself produced in the exchange of the shifting of the centre of gravity; if there is no shifting — that is, if the centre of gravity sits exactly on the centre-line — then double-weighting ② is formed, the motive power is lost, and the fault of sluggish heaviness arises. At this time, if the two hands are emptily lifted in ward-off, then

- ① "The central earth not leaving its place" means that the body's centre of gravity does not leave the middle third of the distance between the two legs; see Figure 9 in detail.
- ② Double-weighting is when the two feet do not distinguish substantial and insubstantial but become double-substantial, and the two hands too do not distinguish substantial and insubstantial but likewise become double-substantial. Hence double-weighting is formed, so that substantial and insubstantial are obstructed and the change-over is not nimble; therefore it is a fault.

 one can become a skilled adept of double-sinking ①, and can make the movement regain the motive power of change-over.

Substantial and insubstantial are not fixed; they change as the form changes. In beginning to learn, it is fitting to adopt the posture of large-insubstantial and large-substantial, like the ratio two-to-eight (the two-to-eight ratio refers to the proportions of load on the two feet: if the whole body weighs one hundred jin, one foot bears twenty jin and the other eighty jin). As one's skill becomes proficient, one turns to the posture of small-insubstantial and small-substantial, such as when the load on the two feet is distributed in a four-to-six ratio. After passing through this compact skill, because the degree of movement becomes smaller, substantial and insubstantial can be exchanged more nimbly. The inner reason for the nimble exchange is the nimbleness of the exchange of intent and qi, whereby one can avoid stagnating on one side and concentrating on one point: for example, if in some form one should pay attention to the left hand, one can with no effort immediately turn to the left hand ②. In this way one can have the sensation, in practising, of aid on every hand, producing the delight of round liveliness like a pearl rolling on a

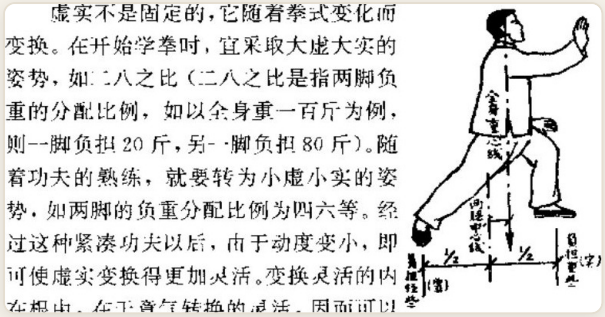
plate. In terms of posture, under any change-over one may never let "the central earth leave its place"; only without leaving its place can one change to front, back, left and right without obstruction. If the body leans to one side in making the change-over, it must be adjusted before it can become nimble. This Figure 8 · Diagram of the shifting of the centre of gravity — the diagram is labelled: the central coccyx line, the centre-of-gravity line, left foot load 1/2 (insubstantial), right foot load 1/2 (substantial), with e marking the shifting of the centre of gravity.

图 L0F8

Diagram of the shifting of the centre of gravity: a side-facing bow-stance posture, labelled "central coccyx line", "centre-of-gravity line", "left foot load 1/2 (insubstantial)", "right foot load 1/2 (substantial)", with e marking the shifting of the centre of gravity.

- ① Double-sinking is when the two feet, though not yet distinguished into substantial and insubstantial — that is, only slightly insubstantial and substantial — become double-substantial, but the two hands are wholly insubstantial, or only slightly insubstantial and substantial. In this way a leaning-to-insubstantial arises, as in Cross Hands, which is a double-substantial and double-insubstantial of upper and lower following each other — this is double-sinking. At this time, though the two hands and two feet are double-insubstantial and double-substantial, there is still within them a distinction of host and guest, and so it is not a fault.
- ② This refers to people's habit of mostly using the right hand; but sometimes when attention should be on the left hand, it is still on the right hand.

图 L0F9



Half-light half-heavy: a bow stance with the two feet opened front and back, both feet having their footing, with the centre of gravity within the middle third of the distance between the two legs (labelled: left foot 1/3, right foot 2/3).

图 L0F10

Leaning-light leaning-heavy: the centre of gravity goes beyond the middle third, one foot being especially heavy and the other floating and swinging (labelled: too light, too heavy).

图 L0F11

Diagram of Square and Circle (circle within square, square within circle; the diagram marks the circle-point, the square-point, the spiral line (circle), the opening line (square), the human body, and the region of movement)

· 29 · is a gap of lost position, and because an extra procedure is added it makes the movement turn slow and lets slip a good opportunity. In Taijiquan terminology this is called losing the moment. Losing the moment and losing the position are grave faults in Taijiquan; hence the exchange of substantial and insubstantial can attain the requirement of nimble change-over only under the condition of standing centred — this is one of the important keys that must be grasped. **ii. The three basic substantial-insubstantial states** (1) The substantial and insubstantial of the feet — the division of the feet's substantial and insubstantial is simply that one foot bears somewhat more and the other somewhat less. According to mechanical principles, if the centre of gravity of the body's weight is located in the middle third of the distance between the two legs, then both feet can have their footing, and this is called half-light half-heavy ① (as in Figure 9). If the centre of gravity goes beyond the range of the middle third, then the insubstantial foot, being too insubstantial, will produce the phenomenon of floating and swinging Figure 9 · Half-light half-heavy Figure 10 · Leaning-light leaning-heavy (2) One should be "sinking", not "heavy" — what is called "heavy" means the phenomenon of sluggishness produced by over-filling. What is called "sinking" means that although it is a sinking down, one can still "of itself soar into emptiness"; that is to say, sinking is produced within upper and lower following each other: if the foot sinks down and is substantial, while the hand lifts up in ward-off and is insubstantial, then one can make substantial-within-insubstantial. Hence "sinking" is not a fault, whereas "heavy" is a fault (except for half-light half-heavy). Therefore in dividing substantial and insubstantial one should be "sinking", not "heavy".

(3) One should be "light", not "floating" — "light" is to make the movement manifest nimble lightness with footing within the square-and-circle; whereas "floating" is going out of the square-and-circle, making the heel float up and drift without footing — that is, being insubstantial to excess. Hence floating is a morbid sign. Therefore in dividing substantial and insubstantial one should be "light", not "floating".

(4) The three faultless substantial-and-insubstantial — in practising the form one should learn and achieve the three faultless substantial-and-insubstantial: "double light①", "double sinking", and "half-light half-heavy". Among these three

- ① Under the movement of qi in which the intent is empty-and-nimble without delusion and clear brightness resides in the person, one drums and surges the top jin; above, the two arms are linked, and below, the two legs follow; substantial and insubstantial differ only by a minute amount, yet they can naturally and nimbly convert — this is double light, and therefore it is not a fault.

· 34 · faultless substantial-and-insubstantial, the skills of "double light" and "double sinking" are comparatively fine and hard to do; if not done well, there is the possibility of drifting into "double floating①" (hands insubstantial and feet also insubstantial) and "double heavy" (hands substantial and feet also substantial), and to this one must give full attention. In particular, the skilled hand of "double light" and "double sinking" and the faulty hand of "double floating" and "double heavy" differ by only a hair's breadth in the shifting of hands and feet; hence one should all the more guard against the possibility that this hair's-breadth difference becomes a thousand-li error. Table 1. Faulty hands and skilled hands in the division of substantial and insubstantial

No.	Name of faulty hand	Morbid sign	No.	Name of skilled hand	Function	Note
1	Double heavy	Fault lies in over-filling	1	Double light	Naturally nimble and light	This table is obtained from an analysis according to the boxing treatise "Explanation of Light, Heavy, Floating, and Sinking in Taijiquan". The whole division of substantial and insubstantial has twelve items, of which skilled hands are only three, while faulty hands are nine, occupying three

						quarters. Therefore a slight carelessness in practice easily produces faulty hands, and attention should be paid.
2	Double floating	Fault lies in drifting	2	Double sinking	Of itself soaring into emptiness	
3	Leaning-light leaning-heavy	Leaning without footing	3	Half-light half-heavy	Half having footing	
4	Half-floating half-sinking	Erring by insufficiency				
5	Leaning-floating leaning-sinking	Erring by excess				
6	Half-heavy leaning-heavy	Sluggish and not correct				
7	Half-light leaning-light	Nimble but not round				
8	Half-sinking leaning-sinking	Empty and not correct				
9	Half-floating leaning-floating	Vague and not round				

(5) The separating hand is an important measure for remedying leaning-heavy and leaning-floating② — in practising alone

- ① Double floating is when the two hands are insubstantial, and the two feet, because of excessive great insubstantiality and great substantiality, are such that in the process of movement not only does that insubstantial foot float up, but even that over-substantial foot, when changing, is dragged so that one stands unsteadily and floats up, so that the whole body drifts without footing — this becomes double floating, and is therefore a fault.
- ② What is called leaning-heavy leaning-floating arises from the hand and foot on the same side being both insubstantial above and below, or both substantial above and below, so that the jin is biased to one side. Therefore the dividing of substantial and insubstantial with upper and lower following each other is precisely proposed in order that leaning-heavy and leaning-floating may not occur.

· 35 · practice one can achieve the requirement of changing substantial and insubstantial without going out of the corner — that is, one will not go out of the square-circle and produce leaning-heavy and leaning-floating substantial-and-insubstantial. But when pushing hands with a person, two sides are already involved, and one absolutely cannot, by subjective wish, one-sidedly think that one can refrain from going out of the corner and thereby refrain from going out of the corner. If the opponent uses the separating hand of pluck and rend to seize hard and strike hard, then one will sometimes unavoidably go out of the corner. Therefore one cannot but use the separating hand to remedy this out-of-the-corner substantial-and-insubstantial, so as to make it return again within the square-circle and attain the substantial-and-insubstantial of half-light half-heavy. For example: the right hand goes out of the corner and the left hand strikes out; if the person meets the left hand, then the right hand can again return within the four cardinal directions of the square-circle. This is the technique of remedying one's own substantial-and-insubstantial going out of the corner. (As in Figure 12.)

图 L0F12

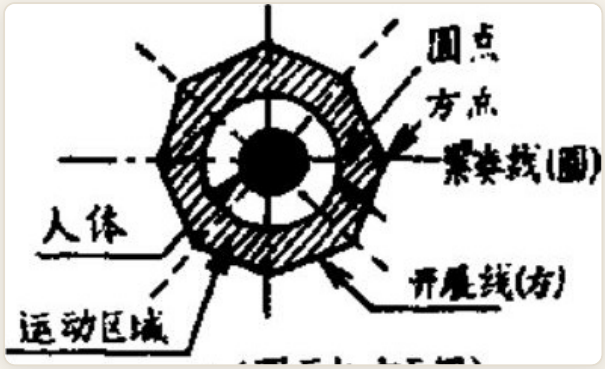


Diagram of the range of movement of the four cardinal and four corner directions (the diagram marks the opening circle, "within the square-circle is the range of activity of the four cardinal directions", the human body, the range of combat, "within the circle is the range of activity of the four corner directions (using shoulder, elbow, hip, knee)", and the out-of-corner hand (the corner-interstice thrust-and-seize remedy))

(6) To do substantial and insubstantial well, do not forget the separating hand — for example, when pushing hands, if the opponent is one who greatly opens and greatly spreads and leans and tilts, and often thinks to use the out-of-corner technique to control others, then at this time, if one does not dare or is not accustomed to use the separating hand to deal with his separating hand, but still thinks to use the four cardinal directions to deal with his four corners, and with him to stick, adhere, and draw circles, · 36 · pushing ceaselessly, then such a movement goes against the rule of corner hand dealing with corner hand, and will make one unconsciously produce the substantial-and-insubstantial of leaning-heavy and leaning-floating; one may say this is a defect produced by being habituated to using the four cardinal directions. Therefore the boxing treatise says: "Pluck, rend, elbow, shoulder are all the more marvellous; in doing them one need not spend mental effort" — this precisely explains the importance of the corner hand. If one forgets the grasp of the corner hand, then the leaning-heavy and leaning-floating of substantial and insubstantial cannot be corrected, and moreover one will be impelled further to go out of the corner. This is the defect produced by being habituated to the four cardinal directions and forgetting the four corners, becoming a "one-legged" person.

In order conveniently to grasp the fourth characteristic, its main points are summarized as follows.

(1) Clearly distinguish the three main substantial-and-insubstantial: namely the substantial-and-insubstantial of the feet, the substantial-and-insubstantial of the hands, and the substantial-and-insubstantial of one hand and one foot.

(2) Pay attention to adjusting the substantial-and-insubstantial of hand and foot in the left hand and left foot, and the right hand and right foot — this is the main key to "when upper and lower follow each other, one is hard to invade".

(3) According to the principles of light, heavy, floating, and sinking, constantly examine the defects in one's own division of substantial and insubstantial.

(4) One must achieve the three faultless substantial-and-insubstantial of double light, double sinking, and half-light half-heavy; this requires constant attention and long training before it can be formed.

(5) When pushing hands, do not forget the principle of "corner hand dealing with corner hand". The four-cardinal hand and the four-corner hand must convert into each other, and both must be practised.

BOOK PAGE 33

Fifth Characteristic: The Joined-Segment Continuous Movement of Waist and Spine Leading, with Inner and Outer Mutually Fitting

Fifth Characteristic: The Joined-Segment Continuous Movement of Waist and Spine Leading, with Inner and Outer Mutually Fitting

The boxing manual lays down:

(1) "The waist and spine are the first rulers; when one moves, nothing does not move";

(2) "The whole body, segment by segment, is strung together, not allowing the slightest interruption";

· 37 · (3) "If one wishes the whole body to be one family, one must first have the whole body free of defects";

(4) "Move the qi like a nine-bend pearl, so that there is no subtle place it does not reach".

From the above four provisions one can see that, in order to attain "when one moves, all move", one must take the waist and spine as the centre, because the waist is the central axis of the left-right parallel turning, and the spine is the foundation of the up-down bending. Since the movements of Taijiquan require that when one moves all move, then on the movement path one cannot merely turn horizontally left and right, nor can one exclusively do bending movements up and down, forward and back; rather one must unite waist and spine so that the path of movement forms a spatial curve that is at once left-right and also up-down, forward-back, thereby establishing the foundation of "when one moves, all move". That is to say, only through taking waist and spine as the centre can one cause the nine main movement joints of the whole body② to be strung together in sequence. Moreover, one must achieve whole-body freedom from defects, strung together like a nine-bend round pearl; only thus can one's skill advance to

the stage of the whole body as one family. Therefore the joined-segment continuous movement with waist and spine leading and inner and outer mutually fitting becomes the fifth characteristic of Taijiquan.

I. The Essence of Joined-Segment Continuity

In order to make clear the essence of joined-segment continuity, let us take the lower half of the body as an example for explanation. When the jin starts from the heel, passes through the ankle joint, circles around the calf and rises to the knee joint, then from the knee joint rotates and rises, circling the thigh to the hip joint, and one can do this without the slightest interruption — this is called the joined-segment continuity of the lower half of the body. This shows that the so-called continuity is not only moving at the joints, but should make the whole leg circle and rise in motion. If one does not pass through the large and small legs, but moves only through the joints of ankle, knee, hip, and so on, then that belongs to a movement leaping from one segment to another, and this is a kind of "zero-break jin". Therefore only the jin that rises through the large and small legs is the true "continuous jin"③.

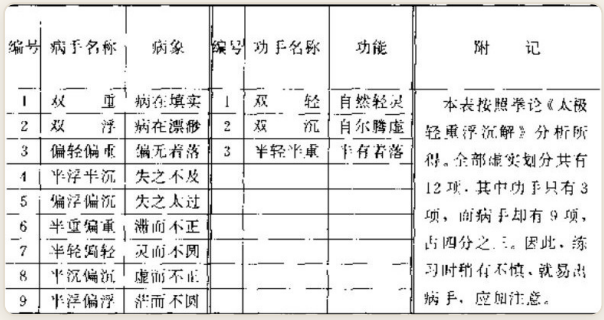
- ① The nine main joints refer to: neck, spine, waist, hip, knee, ankle, shoulder, elbow, and wrist.
- ② "Zero-break jin" is only joint movement, whereas "continuous jin" is muscle and joint moving together.

· 38 · Once the continuous jin is made clear, one can find the point of application of force. If the leg is front-bowed and back-collapsed without left-right rotation, then no matter how one tries it is impossible to string joints and muscles together; at this time one can only manifest the joint's contraction and release, which has no direct relation to the lengthening of the muscle. If the arm straightens and retracts directly, the situation is likewise. Therefore this requirement of continuity cannot be attained except by using the reeling-silk spiral-style rising.

II. The Relation of "When One Moves, All Move" to Waist and Spine

The movements of Taijiquan first require that the nine main external joints can move in sequence and in continuity, for only thus can the internal organs be caused to produce a "massaging" action. When practising the form one must absolutely not have a few joints moving while other joints do not move. In order to make all the body's joints move in sequence and in full, one must find on the human body its central link and use it to lead the various joints to move in sequence; only thus will the movement become comparatively simple. Otherwise, one would have to use mental effort to attend to nine joints moving segment by segment together, which would cause one to attend to this and lose that, bustling without rest, and not only would one fail to attain the goal of continuous all-movement, but one would also lose the requirement of seeking stillness within movement.

图 L0F13



编号	病手名称	病象	编号	功手名称	功能	附　记
1	双　重	病在填实	1	双　轻	自然轻灵	本表按照拳论《太极轻重浮沉解》分析所得。全部虚实划分共有12项，其中功手只有3项，而病手却有9项，占四分之三。因此，练习时稍有不慎，就易出病手，应加注意。
2	双　浮	病在漂渺	2	双　沉	自尔腾虚	
3	偏轻偏重	偏无着落	3	半轻半重	半有着落	
4	半浮半沉	失之不及				
5	偏浮偏沉	失之太过				
6	半重偏重	滞而不正				
7	半轻偏轻	灵而不圆				
8	半沉偏沉	虚而不正				
9	半浮偏浮	浑而不圆				

Diagram of "when moving then separating, when still then joining": (a) elevation, (b) plan; the diagram marks separating, joining, and the arm

We know that the two organs, waist and spine, occupy the middle of the human body; they naturally · 39 · possess the function of a central axis. Therefore, if one can make waist and spine cooperate with the spiral movement of the third characteristic, one can attain the requirement of joined-segment continuity; hence in Taijiquan the waist and spine are called the first rulers. Because of this central axis, the two hands can use the unity of centrifugal and centripetal force to achieve "when moving then separating, when still then joining" (as in Figure 13).

BOOK PAGE 34

III. Joined-Segment Continuity and Strengthening the Joints

III. Joined-Segment Continuity and Strengthening the Joints

When Taijiquan has been practised to the point of joined-segment continuity, one can then attain the skill of the whole body as one family. Having formed this skill, one need only simply move very slightly, and one can make all parts of the body, inner and outer, move in coordination. This movement of continuity through the various joints can strengthen the joints and prevent them from degenerating. According to the laws of human physiology, regular joint activity helps preserve the normal structure of the cartilage tissue on the joint surfaces; if one does not often move, the cartilage tissue will undergo the degenerative action of fibrous change. If one does not move for a long time, its accessory organs will further harden, and thus a stiff state of immobile joints is formed. The cause of these pathological changes lies in the decline of the secretion of the synovial fluid that lubricates the joint surfaces.

From this one can see that the requirement of joined-segment continuity in Taijiquan plays an important role in strengthening joint function. In general, in practising Taijiquan one first seeks extension, and extended movement also enlarges the range of the human skeleton's activity. Therefore, when practising Taijiquan, a series of sounds often comes from the joints, making one

feel relaxed; this shows that the joints have been exercised. Not only can this preserve the normal function of the joints, but it can also make the function of the bones steadily increase and accelerate the blood supply to the joints and their surroundings; hence even in old age one may step as briskly as a youth.

IV. The Adjustment of Joint Mobility

Although Taijiquan requires joined-segment continuity, with one movement moving all, nevertheless the mobility of its movements · 40 · is of varying size. The influence of a person's daily movements on the joints is uneven: among the nine joints, the one that turns most easily and most often is the wrist joint, and the one that turns least and least often is the spine. Yet the requirement of joined-segment continuity in Taijiquan is exactly contrary to this: it requires that the wrist joint move as little as possible, while the spine is required to lengthen and to move rather more — that is, the mobility of straightening and bending must be made greater. When the mobility of the wrist joint is reduced, one is forced to enlarge the body method to help attain the requirement of joined-segment continuity, and is forced to take waist and spine as ruler; otherwise one cannot turn smoothly and freely. If the mobility of the wrist joint is not reduced, then at one turn of the wrist a movement can easily turn and slip past without relation to the spine, and of course the waist moves little. Therefore the famous masters of Taijiquan often say: "In practising Taijiquan one should practise on the body, not on the hands." As for the wrist joint, one must reduce its mobility, forcing every movement to use the body method and to come out from the waist and spine.

The author had a friend who had practised Taijiquan for years, but paid attention only to hand technique, and his movement did not reach the body; in movement one saw only the arms moving, while the body was like a wooden stick, advancing and retreating with the stepping. Later, on another's advice, he used two pairs of thin boards to clamp his two wrists (four pieces in all), bored two holes in each end of the boards, and tied the boards with rubber bands, allowing the wrist only a small degree of bending. After practising thus for no long time, he transferred the former movement of the hands onto the body; once it reached the body, then when one moved all moved, and the requirement of joined-segment continuity also made comparatively good progress, the temper also gradually surged, and the body and limbs produced the flavour of round livingness like a pearl. This is the result of reducing the mobility of the wrist joint in order to raise the body method.

图 L0F14

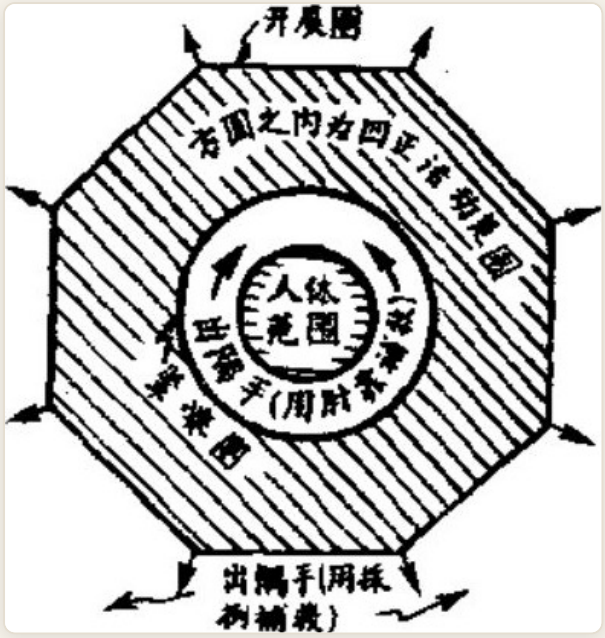


Diagram of the mobility of the (boxing) joints (the spine joint, which moves least)

V. The Grasping of Joined-Segment Continuity

V. The Grasping of Joined-Segment Continuity

图 LOF15

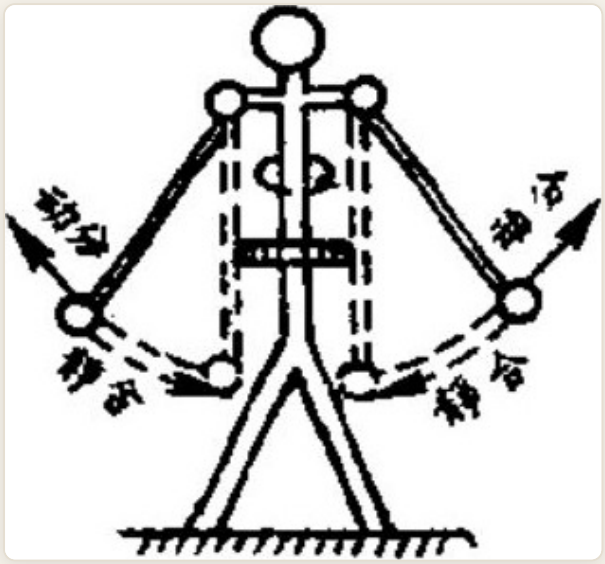


Diagram of the inclination of the curved surface of Taijiquan movement (the diagram marks the horizontal plane of movement, the vertical plane of movement, the planar movement path, and the oblique angle 0° < α < 90°)

图 LOF16

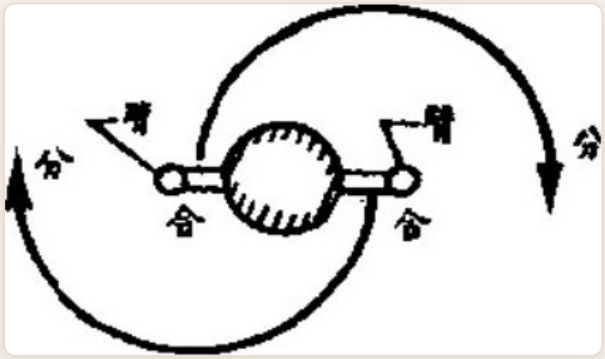


Diagram of firmness and softness mutually aiding (the diagram marks the soft-moving line (round line), the movement's landing point, the firm point (square point), and square-and-round generating each other)

In movement one must use the waist and spine as the motor, with the waist and spine as the centre; only thus can one practise well the skill of joined-segment continuity. And in order to

make waist and spine the ruler, not attending to this and losing that and not dispersing one's thought, one can only use the centrifugal force possessing an angle of inclination to initiate the movement (Figure 15); only then can one naturally carry the jin onto the waist and spine. Therefore when practising the frame one must certainly cultivate this habit of movement, so that in movement one does not disperse one's mental attention; not only can one achieve the movement of waist-and-spine leading, but one (3) Do well "softness moves the qi, firmness lands the point" — after the whole-body lengthening has met the requirement, one can further, at the landing point of each opening and closing, in conjunction with the outward manifestation of spirit and qi, form the square point, manifesting the jin categories of the four cardinal and four corner directions; this is the practice of the square within Taijiquan's "square and round generating each other". At the square point one must manifest extremely firm firmness (that is, one must make the body and limbs taut to the extreme and long), and after the firmness has passed, one requires that throughout the entire process of movement one manifest extremely soft moving of qi. The whole round of the frame should be carried out under such a condition of firmness and softness mutually aiding. Therefore when practising the form one should firmly remember the six-word essential: "softness moves the qi, firmness lands the point".

(4) The application of firm and soft and "vigorous spirit and bearing" — the application of firm and soft must be combined with the application of intent, spirit-and-qi, and breathing; that is, on the basis of "vigorous spirit and bearing"

· 55 · one coordinates the use of deep and long exhalation to make the body and limbs sink and lengthen, thereby strengthening elasticity and becoming elastic firmness (as in issuing jin); on the basis of quiet intent and gathered qi, one makes the muscles of the limbs loosen along with it, thereby forming a lively and unclogged softness, and from softness changing in ten thousand ways. Both of these are physiologically a kind of natural phenomenon.

In short, the firmness of Taijiquan is not the firmness of bulging effort, and the softness of Taijiquan is not an elasticity-less softness; rather, "vigorous spirit and bearing" manifested outwardly becomes firmness, and quiet intent and gathered qi concealed inwardly becomes softness. When intent moves, spirit and qi follow; as spirit and qi conceal and manifest, so firm and soft transform. Therefore in practising one round of the frame, spirit and qi should conceal and manifest suddenly, intent should unceasingly direct, and spirit and qi should also unceasingly conceal, manifest, and drum-and-surge; only thus can the muscles unceasingly transform firm and soft. This is an important path for grasping and practising the transformation of firm and soft.

In order conveniently to grasp the seventh characteristic, its essentials are summarized as follows.

(1) In the initial period one must transform away the original rigid jin, and the softer the better; the longer this period the better too, generally requiring one or two years.

(2) After the whole body has been practised to pliancy, one can then proceed to concretely practise the lengthening of the whole body, in order to practise firm jin.

(3) Moving the qi uses softness, the landing point uses firmness — this is Taijiquan's dividing line between firm and soft.

(4) Intent combined with the sudden concealment and manifestation of spirit and qi and with breathing is Taijiquan's rule for the transformation of firm and soft.

(5) Firmness and softness alike attaining a high level is the standard for the title of Taijiquan marvellous hand①.

- ① According to Chen Xin's "General Discussion and Elucidation": "Pure yin without yang is the soft hand, pure yang without yin is the hard hand; one yin and nine yang is the root-headed stick, two yin and eight yang is the scattered hand; three yin and seven yang still feels hard, four yin and six yang is akin to a good hand; only five yin together with five yang, yin and yang without bias, is called the marvellous hand; the marvellous hand in one movement is one Taiji, and when the traces are fully transformed it returns to nothingness." This is the Chen style's standard for the softness-firmness degree of Taijiquan. Because Chenjiagou lies in the Yellow River's slope, where many practise hard-style boxing, and hence people fear that they will be tempered by their environment into gradually tending to hardness, there are the names hard hand, scattered hand, good hand, marvellous hand, to serve as the standard limiting practitioners from tending to hardness.

BOOK PAGE 38

Eighth Characteristic: The Movement of Alternating Fast and Slow, from Slow to Fast and from Fast to Slow

Eighth Characteristic: The Movement of Alternating Fast and Slow, from Slow to Fast and from Fast to Slow

The boxing manual lays down①:

(1) "When the opponent moves urgently then respond urgently, when he moves slowly then follow slowly";

(2) "When he does not move, I do not move; when he moves slightly, I move first";

(3) "When first learning one should be slow, but slow must not become idiotic; after practice one becomes fast, but fast must not become chaotic";

(4) "The form resists the five peaks, the posture presses the three summits; from slowness enter swiftness, from shallow enter deep".

From the above four provisions one can see that when first practising the Taijiquan routine (one round of the frame), the movements should be as slow as possible, and the time may be drawn out. Only when the movements are slowed is there opportunity to make corrections, and only thus can one examine the places that are not smooth. But slowness must not go so far that the face shows idiocy; this is the limit of slowness. Later, as one's proficiency increases, one may gradually speed up, shortening the time needed to walk one round of the frame. But in turning from slow to fast there must likewise be a limit, namely that although fast, the movements must still be steady, still be able to manifest the categories of jin, and must not give rise to floating and drifting or chaotic phenomena. This refers to the length of time needed to practise one round of the frame. On this premise of being able both to be slow and to be fast, when applying it to each boxing form one must unify this pair of opposites, fast and slow, into

- ① In the boxing manual, the meaning of fast and slow has two contents:

The first meaning refers to the length of time needed to practise one round of the frame. If A takes twelve minutes to practise one round of the frame and B takes fifteen minutes, then we say "A is fast and B is slow".

The second meaning refers to the speed of movement within each boxing form. It is slow at the conversion, gradually quickens after passing the conversion, is fastest when carried to the landing point, and after issuing returns again to slowness.

Among the four lines of principle quoted here, the first two refer to the second meaning, and the latter two to the first meaning. This is a question that must be distinguished clearly when learning.

· 57 · a single boxing form: that is, at the conversion it must be slow, after passing the conversion it gradually quickens, it is fastest when carried to the landing point, and afterward slows again, and so on in a cycle. (As in Figure 17.) Therefore every boxing form of Taijiquan must undergo the training of being able both to be slow and to be fast; only thus can one, in pushing hands, "when he moves slightly, I move first" and "when he moves urgently then respond urgently, when he moves slowly then follow slowly", creating conditions favourable to oneself, and can attain the unity of alternating fast and slow.

Therefore the movement of alternating fast and slow, from slow to fast and from fast to slow, becomes the eighth characteristic of Taijiquan.

I. The Development Sequence of Fast and Slow

At the initial stage of learning Taijiquan, one must absolutely not be fast, and must strive for slowness with all one's might, the slower the better. Because slowness allows one to carefully ponder the correctness of the postures, proceeding from coarse to fine, and there is ample time to examine the ins and outs of every movement; thus the postures are easily corrected, and at the conversion one can examine whether it is smooth. But slowness is not to be slow without limit; generally after one or two years of learning, imitating, checking, and correcting, it will do.

On this point one must have a correct notion when first learning. This is the period of seeking only correctness of posture, not distinctness of jin categories.

The slowness of this period must further have a condition, namely that the slowness must be sought on the premise of raising the spirit and not letting the spirit scatter. If in the movements one is so slow that in spirit and qi one manifests dullness and rigidity, and in action manifests sluggishness and immobility, then this is contrary to the requirement of Taijiquan's intent-and-qi movement. Therefore slowness must be sought under the drumming-and-surging of spirit and qi and the nimble conversion of intent and qi; this is Taijiquan's standard for slowness. For this reason, when first learning one must absolutely not contract this habit of sluggish intent and dull spirit, causing difficulties for later improvement.

Later, as one's proficiency increases, one may gradually quicken the speed; but fast must not be chaotic — this is the period of training the categories of jin. Finally, after one's skill has become refined, the boxing forms may develop from extension to compactness, so that the speed of movement gradually slows again, while at the conversion · 58 · its angular velocity is even faster. This is the three-layer skill of first slow, then fast, then again slow, and is also the three stages of the development of fast and slow.

II. The Time and Conditions for Turning from Slow to Fast

At what time and under what conditions is it most suitable to turn from slow to fast? To answer this question, one must first clarify the two standards for turning from slow to fast.

(1) Movement steady — within the whole round of the frame, even if one moves somewhat faster than before, one still must not change the original steadiness of the movement; this is correct speeding up. If one cannot, and floating and drifting appear, then it shows the movement has been speeded up too much, and one should at once slow down somewhat. Under the guidance of this standard, one can gradually speed up as proficiency increases.

(2) Being able to manifest the categories of jin — Taijiquan is composed of the eight gates and five steps. In moving jin one should fully manifest one of the eight jins (such as the four cardinal's ward-off, roll-back, press, push, or the four corners' pluck, rend, elbow, shoulder). If the movement is too fast, it slips past in a single turn, and it is not easy to manifest the required category of jin. Therefore if one feels it is very hard for one to manifest the category of jin again, it shows the movement has already been speeded up too much, and one should slow down somewhat. This is also a standard for turning from slow to fast①.

The above two points are the two standards for turning from slow to fast. With these two standards, one can be guided correctly to grasp the time and conditions for turning from slow to fast, making the speed of movement turn from slow to fast just to the right degree. The fast referred to here does not mean changing all the movements of Taijiquan into fast movements, but rather that in the opening and closing of every boxing form, at the conversions and foldings

and pilings, one must manifest, in a manner of relaxed-yet-not-relaxed and about-to-extend-yet-not-extended, the lingering attach-

- ① However much one speeds up, in order to manifest steadiness and the categories of jin, the first route's thirteen-posture frame is at fastest no more than eight or nine minutes. This was the speed at which teacher Yang Chengfu publicly performed Taijiquan at the annual meeting of the Nanjing Physical Education Research Society in 1914.

· 59 · ment and vermicular soft slow movement. Therefore the so-called fastness is manifested only in the process of turning from round to square. (As in Figure 17.) This accelerated movement is the foundation from which the eight categories of jin arise; without this angular acceleration, one cannot manifest the categories of jin of the four cardinal and four corner directions, nor can one suit the requirement of "when he moves urgently then respond urgently". The issuing jin of Taijiquan is realized precisely by using this accelerating process: under the condition of closing concealed within opening and with the inner jin curved-stored, when one reaches near the target object, one suddenly shakes and issues like a bowstring released from its catch, sending the inner jin out from within a short distance. Martial artists call this "inch jin"①.

图 L0F17

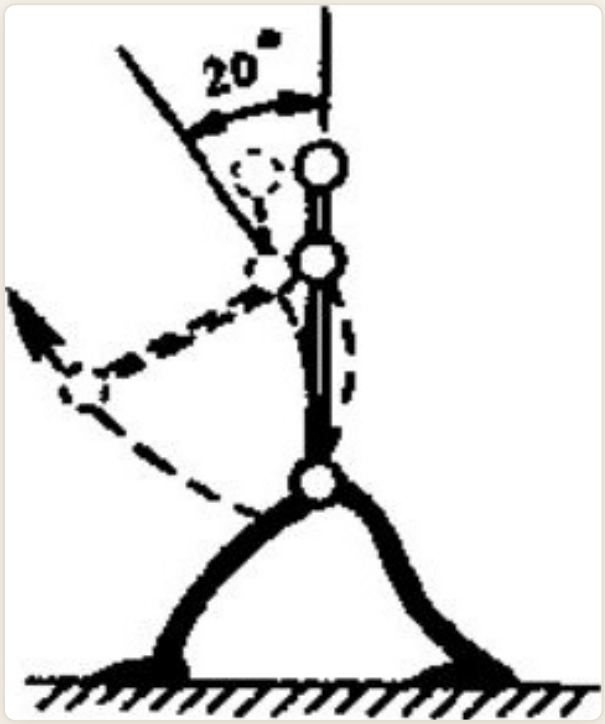


Diagram of alternating fast and slow (the diagram marks the spiral turn of "from slow to fast" and the spiral turn of "from fast to slow", with "square and round generating each other" at the centre, and words such as "opening cannot not enter-and-exit (jin category and square point)" and "slow at the conversion" marked at the two sides)

III. Alternating Fast and Slow, and Evenness-and-Clearness, and the Categories of Jin

III. Alternating Fast and Slow, and Evenness-and-Clearness, and the Categories of Jin

From the above theory one can know that any isolated slow movement or isolated fast movement does not conform to the requirement of Taiji yin and yang aiding each other. Secondly, as regards man's attention,

- ① "Inch jin": any storing and issuing of jin within a distance of one chi is called inch jin.

· 60 · in terms of stability, from the psychological and physiological basis one can see that it is impossible to make attention engage in long-term attention of equal intensity without destroying its stability. To make attention stable and the intent not scatter, one must make the intensity of attention high and low. Now Taijiquan is an intent-and-qi movement, and it requires pouring intent into the movement; therefore, in order not to let the intent scatter, the movement must alternate fast and slow, and only thus can it suit the rising-and-falling characteristic of intent and qi, impelling attention to become stable and spirit and qi to drum-and-surge. In fact, the alternation of fast and slow in movement is also a natural instinct of mankind; it is both necessary for health and indispensable for combat. Therefore, taking a single boxing form, one requires the attainment of alternation of fast and slow (as in Figure 17). Yet taking one round of the frame, this alternation of fast and slow of each boxing form further requires an even range of variation. That is to say, from the beginning of the movement to its end, when slowness is needed it is all equally slow, and when fastness is needed it is all equally fast; in Taijiquan terminology this is to achieve "evenness-and-clarity". If one can attain this requirement, then one's breathing will certainly be regulated very "evenly and clearly", and there will be no phenomenon of gradually becoming urgent. This skill of making both movement and breathing attain "evenness-and-clarity" is a concrete manifestation of being well cultivated in Taijiquan, and is the true skill obtained from long practice. Therefore when first turning from slow to fast, one must not fear urgency of breathing and so not dare to do the speeding-up movement — that would be to give up eating for fear of choking. In short, Taijiquan should be like the waves of the great Long River, surging endlessly and yet with even clarity, rising and falling in movement.

Taijiquan is composed of the eight gates and five steps. When first learning, in order to transform away the original rigid clumsy force of the body and limbs, one may temporarily not manifest the categories of jin, and may be only round without square. The reason why it is permitted in this period not to manifest the categories of jin is that one has not practised enough, one's skill is not deep, and the habit is not yet formed; it is because if at this time one were required to manifest the categories of jin, one would easily produce the fault of straining and bulging effort, and would no longer be able to produce the elastic jin of lengthening the body and limbs.

After practising for one or two years the skill of seeking softness and destroying rigidity, and when one feels the rigid jin has been wholly removed, one may then manifest the categories of jin when walking the frame. Manifesting the categories of jin is the practising · 61 · This is indispensable to Taijiquan and is also what the eight jins require — namely that the accelerating force, on reaching the landing point, must manifest:

(1) Outward there is ward-off jin, inward there is roll-back jin, double closing there is press jin;

(2) Downward there is push jin, double separating there is pluck jin, issuing out there is rend jin;

(3) When the wrist has gone out of the square-and-circle there is elbow jin, and when the elbow and arm again go out of the square-and-circle there is shoulder jin.

Only movement like this can be called a Taijiquan composed of the eight gates and five steps. For this reason, after practising the form for a certain period, when walking the frame one should fully do well this movement of alternating fast and slow. By long practice of alternating fast and slow, one can make the eight-gate jin go from nothing to having, and from having to strong, becoming eight gates and five steps in name and reality.

IV. The Grasping of Alternating Fast and Slow

(1) When first learning, strive for slowness with all one's might — when first learning, in order conveniently to check and correct every movement, one must be slow, and must progressively pass through this period of seeking slowness; one must not be impatient, lest one create difficulties for later improvement.

(2) One must seek slowness under the conditions of raised spirit and nimble conversion of intent and qi — when first learning, one cannot but be slow in order to check and correct the postures. But as said above, slowness must have a limit; that is to say, one must not be so slow as to seem to move and seem to stop, with fixed eyes and dull spirit, as if there one were thinking of something else. This kind of slowness is close to the standing skill of standing the frame, and is not what is needed for moving. Therefore slowness must be sought on the premise of raised spirit and nimble conversion of intent and qi; only thus will one not produce the faults of idiocy and scattering of spirit.

(3) One must seek fastness under the conditions of steady movement and being able to manifest the categories of jin — seeking fastness, like seeking slowness, is likewise not going toward fastness without limit; it likewise must have a limit: although fast, the movement must still be steady. Steady fastness is the fastness required by Taijiquan; unsteadiness is a morbid sign. At the same time, one must seek fastness under the condition of being able to manifest the categories of jin, because manifesting the jin limits the fastness. Such fastness is beneficial and harmless · 62 · fastness — it will not float and drift without sinking, nor be indistinct in the categories of jin, nor lose the function of square and round generating each other.

(4) Slow at the conversion, quicker when turning toward the square point — the above three points explain the measure of fast and slow one should grasp in walking one round of the frame; now let us speak further of the principle of fast and slow for each boxing form. Taijiquan lays down that at the conversions and foldings and pilings one should be slow, and after passing the conversion one uses accelerating jin to move toward fastness, and carries on thus in a cycle. At the same time, within one round of the frame, this transformation of alternating fast and slow further requires attaining "evenness-and-clarity". This is the foundation for training the eight categories of jin, making them go from nothing to having and from having to strong.

In order conveniently to grasp the eighth characteristic, its essentials are summarized as follows.

(1) When first learning one must be slow, in order to have opportunity to check and correct.

(2) Seeking slowness must take raised spirit and nimble conversion of intent and qi as its premise.

(3) As proficiency increases, one should gradually shorten the time needed to walk one round of the frame. But seeking fastness must take steady movement and being able to manifest the categories of jin as its premise.

(4) The principle of alternating fast and slow is: slow at the conversions and foldings and pilings, and after passing the conversion gradually quicken, and after passing the square point slow again. At the same time, at the conversion moving the qi must be slow, and at the landing point at the end must be fast.

(5) Within the whole round of the frame, the range of variation of alternating fast and slow is required to achieve evenness-and-clarity.

Conclusion

The eight characteristics of Taijiquan are selected and refined from the Taijiquan manuals, again and again. The precious form-practising experience left by our predecessors has long since become the principles for practising Taijiquan at present, and is also the standard that people unanimously follow in practising Taijiquan.

It should further be pointed out that although the characteristics are divided into eight, their essence is one; therefore when practising the frame or pushing hands, one must not treat these characteristics in isolation, and must in every movement gradually come to conform to these characteristics. Because every boxing form or movement must use concentrated consciousness to direct the whole course of the movement (characteristic · 63 · one), making the body and limbs elastic on the premise of raised spirit (characteristic two), and, amid nimble transformation of substantial and insubstantial (characteristic four) and forward-reverse spiral reeling silk (characteristic three), bringing about the union of inner and outer, attaining the joined-segment continuity of "when one moves, nothing does not move" (characteristic five) and the accomplishment in one breath of unbroken connection (characteristic six), manifesting the

quality of firmness and softness mutually aiding (characteristic seven) and the speed of having both slow and fast (characteristic eight) — these are the special features that Taijiquan should possess.

From the above analysis one can see that these characteristics are mutually dependent, mutually constraining, mutually promoting, and mutually transforming. Therefore, if one treats them in isolation and attempts to carry out only one characteristic while abandoning the others, then one not only harms the latter but also affects the former. Hence these characteristics are not peculiar to one particular movement, and still less is it that a certain movement has only a certain one characteristic; rather, they are characteristics that every boxing form constituting the entire Taijiquan routine should possess.

In the Taijiquan popular today, whatever the style, and regardless of whether the postures are extended or compact, and regardless of whether the frame has a few more or a few fewer boxing forms, one need only observe carefully: these Taijiquan frames, though differing in outward appearance, all possess these common characteristics more or less within. The only difference is that some manifest them clearly on the outside, while others conceal them within by way of hidden jin. This also explains why Taijiquan, popular for several hundred years, has not been assimilated by other martial arts and can still stand alone as a style of its own — it is these common characteristics that have served as the mainstay. Therefore when learning Taijiquan one must not treat it lightly.

But when first learning, to wish to grasp these eight characteristics all at once is impossible. When first learning, one need only recognize these characteristics, know that they are the summary of experience left by predecessors, and understand that they are the basic elements constituting Taijiquan; then it is not difficult, following the predecessors' experience and proceeding steadily along the direction they have already pointed out, to obtain the efficacy that Taijiquan should have.

Sequence of the Form Names of the First Route of Chen-Style Taijiquan

No.	Form name	No.	Form name
1st form	Preparatory Form	16th form	Draping-Body Punch
2nd form	Vajra Pounds the Mortar	17th form	Back-Bending Shoulder
3rd form	Lazily Tucking the Robe	18th form	Green Dragon Emerges from Water
4th form	Six Sealing and Four Closing	19th form	Double Push Hands
5th form	Single Whip	20th form	Three Changes of Palm

6th form	Second Vajra Pounds the Mortar	21st form	Punch Beneath the Elbow
7th form	White Crane Spreads Its Wings	22nd form	Reversed Rolling of the Arm
8th form	Diagonal Twisted Step	23rd form	Retreating Step Pressing Elbow
9th form	First Gathering	24th form	Central Plate
10th form	Forward Crossing Twisted Step	25th form	White Crane Spreads Its Wings
11th form	Second Diagonal Twisted Step	26th form	Diagonal Twisted Step
12th form	Second Gathering	27th form	Flash through the Back
13th form	Forward Crossing Twisted Step	28th form	Concealing-Hand Arm Punch
14th form	Concealing-Hand Arm Punch	29th form	Six Sealing and Four Closing
15th form	Third Vajra Pounds the Mortar	30th form	Single Whip

No.	Form name	No.	Form name
31st form	Moving Hands	58th form	Moving Hands
32nd form	High Pat on Horse	59th form	Swinging Foot and Dropping into the Split
33rd form	Right Brushing Foot	60th form	Left and Right Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg
34th form	Left Brushing Foot	61st form	Reversed Rolling of the Arm
35th form	Kick with One Heel	62nd form	Retreating Step Pressing Elbow

36th form	Forward Crossing Twisted Step	63rd form	Central Plate
37th form	Striking the Ground Punch	64th form	White Crane Spreads Its Wings
38th form	Turn Body Double Kick	65th form	Diagonal Twisted Step
39th form	Beast-Head Posture	66th form	Flash through the Back
40th form	Whirlwind Kick	67th form	Concealing-Hand Arm Punch
41st form	Kick with One Heel	68th form	Six Sealing and Four Closing
42nd form	Concealing-Hand Arm Punch	69th form	Single Whip
43rd form	Small Capturing Strike	70th form	Moving Hands
44th form	Clasp Head and Push the Mountain	71st form	High Pat on Horse
45th form	Three Changes of Palm	72nd form	Cross-Shaped Lotus Sway
46th form	Six Sealing and Four Closing	73rd form	Punch Pointing at the Crotch
47th form	Single Whip	74th form	White Ape Offers Fruit
48th form	Front Beckon	75th form	Six Sealing and Four Closing
49th form	Rear Beckon	76th form	Single Whip
50th form	Wild Horse Parts Its Mane	77th form	Sparrow Earth Dragon

51st form	Six Sealing and Four Closing	78th form	Step Up Seven Stars
52nd form	Single Whip	79th form	Retreating Step Straddling the Tiger
53rd form	Double Stamp of the Foot	80th form	Turn Body Double Lotus Sway
54th form	Jade Maiden Works the Shuttle	81st form	Cannon Facing the Head
55th form	Lazily Tucking the Robe	82nd form	Vajra Pounds the Mortar
56th form	Six Sealing and Four Closing	83rd form	Closing Posture
57th form	Single Whip		

A Few Notes on the Illustrations

1. The action-breakdown diagrams in the illustrations of the first route were drawn from photographs of the postures of fellow student Chen Zhaokui. The action-breakdown diagrams in the illustrations of the second route (Cannon Fist) were drawn from photographs of the postures of teacher Chen Fake; in addition, according to the needs of the action breakdown, some diagrams were added, drawn according to fellow student Chen Zhaokui's build.

2. To make it convenient for readers to check the directions of the boxing forms, the directions of the postures in the photographs are agreed as follows: facing the reader equals facing south, the back to the reader equals facing north, the reader's right of the facing figure equals east, and the reader's left of the facing figure equals west. After the reader has practised proficiently, he may choose any direction according to the shape of the ground, and need not necessarily begin the preparatory form standing facing south.

3. All arrows in the diagrams, whether drawn with a solid or a broken line, indicate the direction of the action of the hand or foot, and the arrows in all the diagrams indicate the direction of action passing from this diagram to the next. Where a movement is relatively simple and can be explained by the text, its direction of action is no longer shown in the diagram, and one may refer to the text and the following diagram to understand it; moreover, for a boxing form identical with some earlier form, where the action-breakdown diagrams are abbreviated from several to one or

two, one may refer to the breakdown diagrams of the same earlier boxing form, and no longer show its direction of action in the abbreviated one or two diagrams.

4. Arrows drawn with a solid line indicate the direction of action of the right hand or right foot, and arrows drawn with a broken line indicate the direction of action of the left hand or left foot.

5. Because the movement of the feet in Taijiquan is also fairly fine, in order to show the feet and the ground, shadows are drawn beside the feet to distinguish them. (See the diagram below.)

· 67 · (Continuation of point 5 of the notes on the illustrations — the method of showing the shadow of the foot on the ground)

a. A shadow joined as one body beside the foot indicates that the whole foot is on the ground.

b. Where there is no shadow beside the foot, it indicates that the whole foot is off the ground.

c. Where the shadow beside the foot is joined only at the heel, it indicates that the heel is on the ground.

d. Where the shadow beside the foot is joined only at the toe, it indicates that the toe is on the ground.

Chen-Style Taijiquan, First Route

First Form: Preparatory Form

Stand with the body upright and centred, with the two feet a little wider apart than the shoulders, the two toes turned slightly outward, the two arms hanging naturally down, and the eyes looking level ahead. (Figure 1)

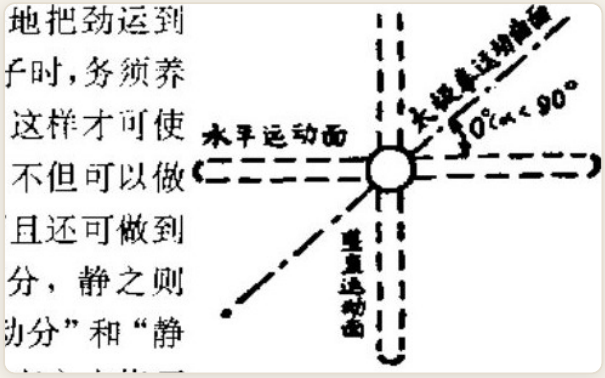
Essential points:

· 68 · The preparatory form is the preparation in consciousness and in posture before beginning the movement; it requires: solidifying the spirit within and showing ease without; hollowing the crown and holding up the top jin — that is, the head must be upright and the crown must be hollowly held up, holding the top jin as if suspended; the lips lightly closed, the teeth lightly together, the chin slightly drawn in; sinking the shoulders — that is, the two shoulders slightly rolled forward and relaxed and sunk; containing the chest and drawing up the back — that is, the chest contained without being concave inward or convex outward, and the spine and back having the intention of pulling and lengthening upward and downward; the crotch must be open and have a feeling of round emptiness; the two knees slightly bent, standing without being stiffly straight, with the knee joints keeping a margin; the whole body relaxed, the breathing natural, and the intent stored in the cinnabar field.

The above essential points must be attended to at every moment, not only when doing the preparatory form but also when doing any movement in the entire set. Moreover, as said above, although each aspect has its own requirement, they also each influence one another. For

example: because the shoulders are slightly rolled forward and relaxed and sunk, it is easy to achieve containing the chest and drawing up the back, solidifying the spirit within, sinking the qi to the cinnabar field, and hollowing the crown and holding up the top jin; because the knees are slightly bent, the crotch is easily opened and rounded (the crotch is the perineal part between the two excretory openings; opening the crotch means feeling that there is qi lifted up and that the skin of this part does not sag).

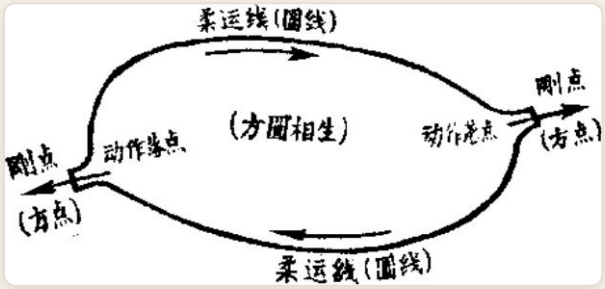
图 L1F1



Preparatory Form

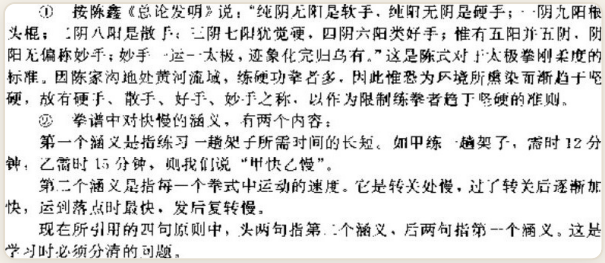
Second Form: Vajra Pounds the Mortar

图 L1F2



Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action one): the body slightly squats, the two hands close in strength, palms facing down

图 L1F3



① 按陈鑫《总论发明》说："纯阴无阳是软手，纯阳无阴是硬手；一阴九阳像头棍；二阴八阳是散手；三阴七阳犹觉硬，四阴六阳类好手；惟有五阳并五阴，阴阳无偏称妙手；妙手一运一太极，迹象化完归乌有。"这是陈式对于太极拳刚柔度的标准。因陈家沟地处黄河流域，练硬功者多，因此惟恐为环境所熏染而渐趋于坚硬，故有硬手、散手、好手、妙手之称，以作为限制练拳者趋于坚硬的准则。

② 拳谱中对快慢的涵义，有两个内容：

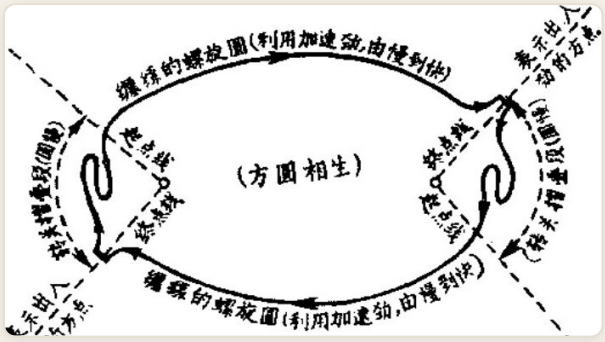
第一个涵义是指练习一趟架子所需时间的长短。如甲练一趟架子，需时12分钟，乙需时15分钟，则我们说"甲快乙慢"。

第二个涵义是指每一个拳式中运动的速度。它是转关处慢，过了转关后逐渐加快，运到落点时最快，发后复转慢。

现在所引用的四句原则中，头两句指第二个涵义，后两句指第一个涵义。这是学习时必须分清的问题。

Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action one): the body turns slightly left, the two hands raise toward the left front diagonal

图 L1F4

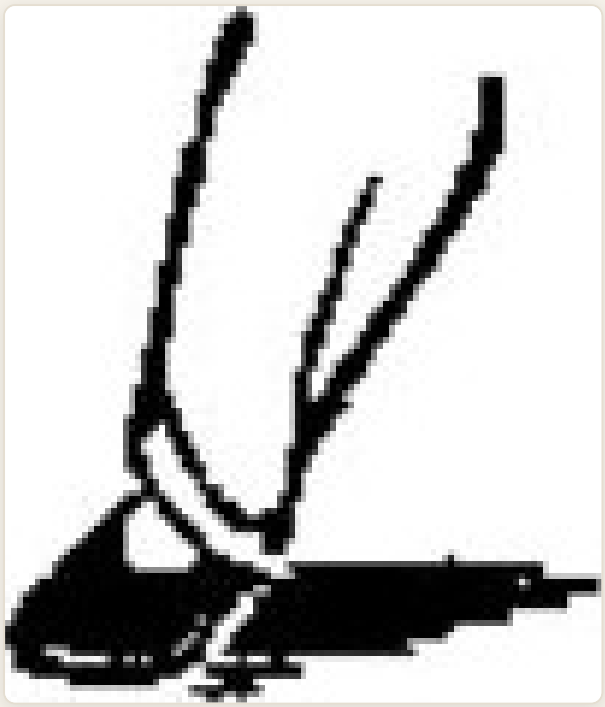


Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action one): the body turns right and squats, the left foot lifts, the two hands open out toward the right rear

Action one: The body slightly squats, the two elbows slightly bent, the two palms facing down (the two hands having the intent of closing strength), and the eyes looking level ahead. (Figure 2) The body turns slightly to the left; at the same time the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, are raised toward the left front diagonal to the height of the shoulders, the two palms still facing down. (Figure 3) The body turns to the right and continues to squat, with the whole weight shifted onto the right leg, and the left foot lifted; while turning the body, the two hands still with the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward open out toward the right rear, palms facing the right rear, and the fingers stretched out and not soft. (Figure 4) Action two: The left foot's toe is raised, and with the inner side of the heel touching the ground one thrusts toward the left front · 69 · out, and as the centre of gravity moves forward one gradually comes to the left foot firmly planted; at the same time the two palms still with the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, open out in reeling silk toward the right rear and sink slightly, and at the same moment as the left foot is firmly planted, the two hands follow the body weight shifting forward. (Figure 5A, Figure 5B) The centre of gravity moves forward onto the left leg, and the body turns left along with it; the right foot steps forward one step and touches the ground with the toe; at the same time the two hands, from the rear forward, the left reeling

reverse and the right reeling forward, with the left hand's palm facing down and the elbow bent, press forward, and the right hand, as the right foot steps up, sweeps forward, so that the two hands form closing strength. (Figure 6)

图 L1F5甲



Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action two): the left foot thrusts toward the left front, the centre of gravity moves forward, the two hands open out in reeling silk

图 L1F5乙

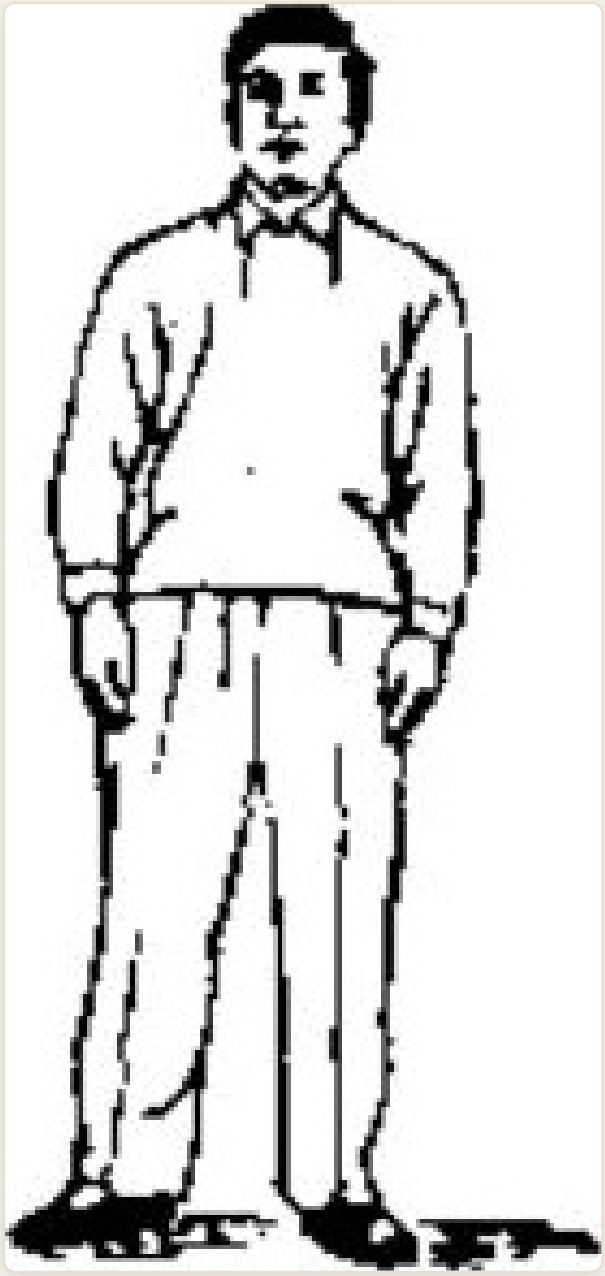
Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action two): the centre of gravity moves forward onto the left leg, the two hands close in strength

图 L1F6

Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action two): the right foot steps forward one step touching the ground with the toe, the left hand with bent elbow presses forward, the right hand sweeps forward

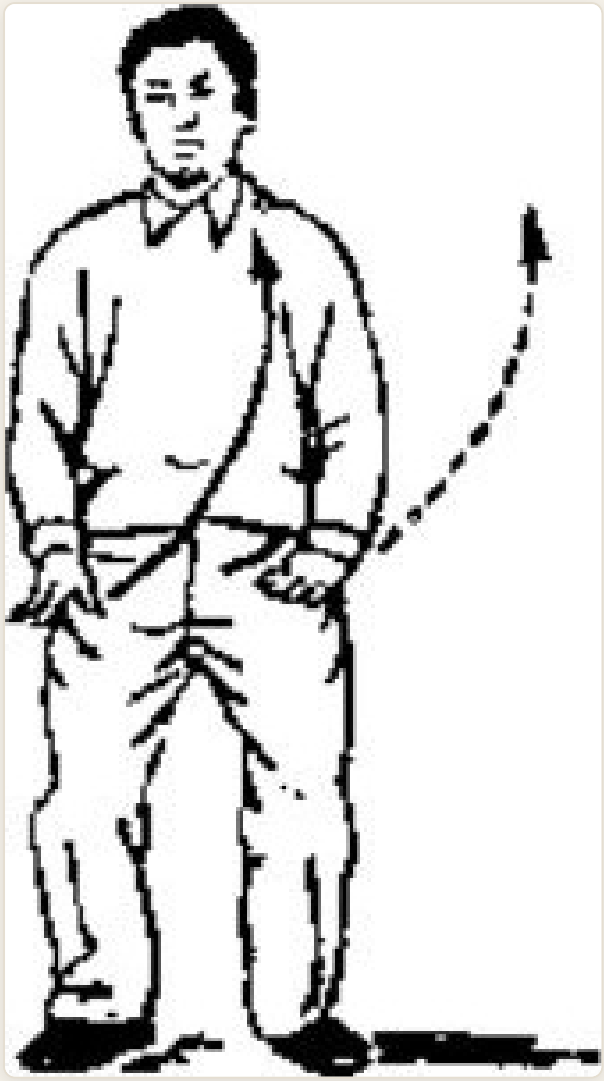
· 70 · Action three: The right palm changes into a fist, reeling forward from outside upward, and the left palm reels forward from inside downward; at the same time the right foot is lifted and drawn back. (Figure 7) The left palm drops to in front of the abdomen, and the right fist thereupon drops into the left palm; at the same time the right foot stamps the ground beside the left foot. (Figure 8)

图 L1F7



Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action three): the right palm changes into a fist and reels forward from outside upward, the left palm reels forward from inside downward, the right foot is lifted and drawn back

图 L1F8



Vajra Pounds the Mortar (action three): the left palm drops to in front of the abdomen, the right fist drops into the left palm, the right foot stamps

图 L1F9

The set posture in which both hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, close their jin in a cross before the chest, changing from the left leg solid to the right leg solid.

图 L1F10

The two hands enlarge the reeling-silk circle and separate, the right upper reeling forward and the left lower reeling reverse, forming an opening jin.

Continue drawing the arc, turning from the great opening into the great closing of double forward reeling (Figure 12A); the centre of gravity gradually shifts right, the right toes press down firmly, the body turns slightly left, and the right hand extends slightly to the left. (Figure 12B)

图 L1F11

The set posture of the opening jin; at the opening, the right leg solid changes to the left leg solid.

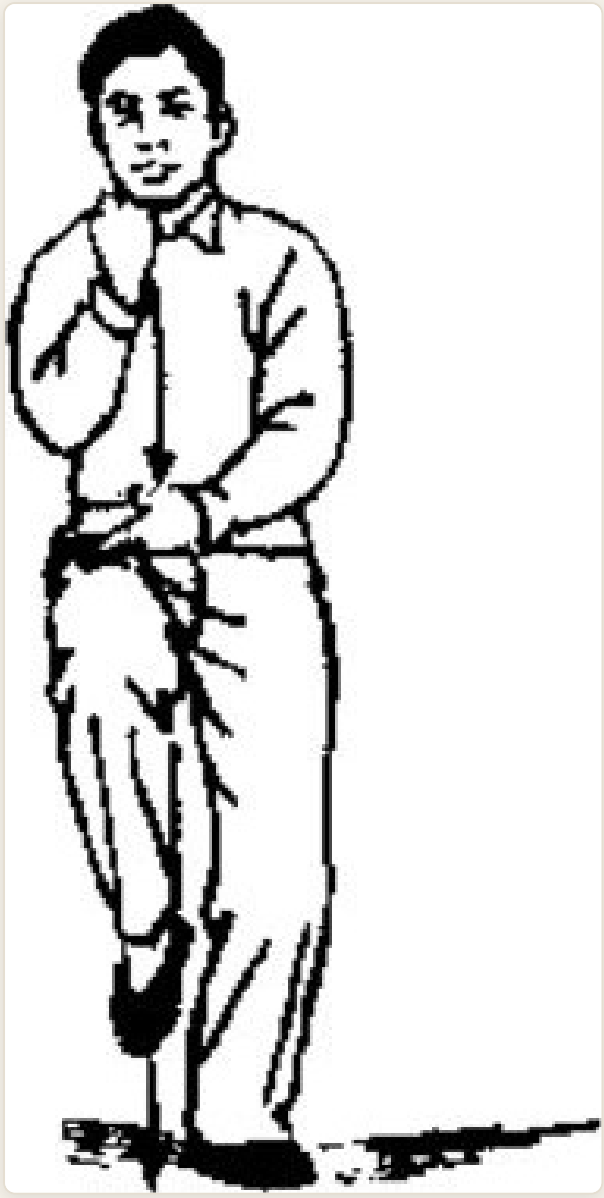
图 L1F12甲

Continuing the arc, turning from the great opening into the great closing of double forward reeling.

图 L1F12乙

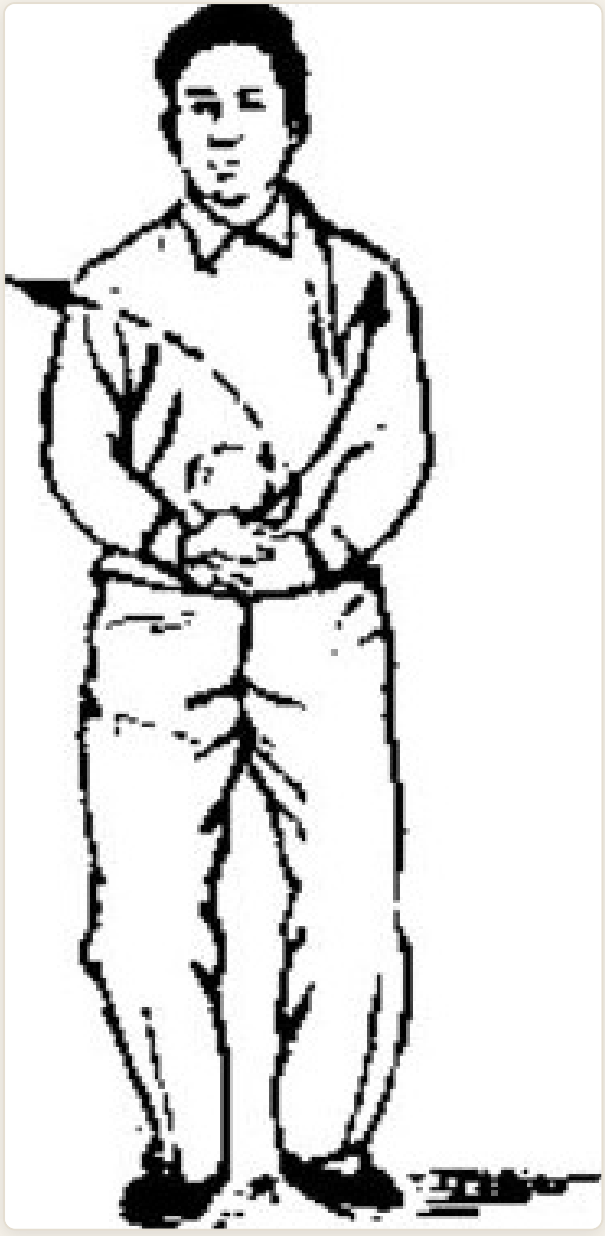
The transitional posture in which, after the great closing of double forward reeling, the centre of gravity shifts gradually to the right leg, the body turns slightly left, and the right hand extends slightly to the left.

图 L1F13



The set posture: the body turns slightly right, the two hands go from closing to opening again, the right hand winds its arm out to the right with a large forward reeling, and the left hand, after a small reverse reeling, turns its palm over and places it before the left waist, the left palm facing up.

图 L1F14



The set posture of the body turning straight, the rear kua adjusted, the whole body relaxed and open, and the qi sinking downward.

· 74 · When the circle turns to the upper ward-off, the hand is insubstantial, and the foot beneath that hand becomes substantial; the reverse is also true. This too is the key to seeking the centre-correctness of inner jin (but the case of lifting one leg and standing alone is excepted: because one foot stands, in order to keep centre-correctness and balance the centre of gravity, the single standing foot is substantial, and the hand above the substantial foot must still be substantial). This is shown most clearly in Figures 10 and 11. 4. Lazily Tucking the Robe is one of the basic postures of Chen-style Taijiquan; it is formed by the left hand's small inner reverse reeling and the right hand's large outer forward reeling. It requires that there be no hollows, no defects, and no breaks in the inner jin; the small inner reverse reeling is especially difficult, and only much

attention and practice will meet the requirement. In this posture one must above all take note that within the closing (when the circle is contracted) there is opening, and within the opening (when the circle is released) there is closing jin; the secret lies in adding more of the inner-and-outer reeling within the process of closing and opening, which makes this requirement easy to attain; only when this requirement is met can one "draw along the coming and going so that the qi clings to the back."

5. The two arms' ward-off turns into a closing jin: because the qi clings to the spine and the two upper arms strike one another, the ward-off jin is not lost, and there arises the wondrous use of "opening hidden within closing"; likewise, because the two upper arms strike one another, when the two arms separate and become an opening jin, there is inwardly nonetheless a closing jin, and there arises the wondrous use of "closing hidden within opening."

图 L1F15甲

The position of the two hands before the chest and abdomen when the two arms close their jin and the qi clings to the spine.

图 L1F15乙

The position of the two hands separated front and back when the two arms open their jin and the two upper arms strike one another.

Fourth Form: Six Seals and Four Closings

· 75 · Movement One: The body turns slightly left, the centre of gravity shifts left, and the left leg becomes solid; at the same time the two hands, each in its own place, first wind the arm and draw a small circle (to initiate the movement): the right hand winds its arm with a large forward reeling and wards off to before the abdomen, while the left hand with a small reverse reeling wards off to before the chest, and the two hands form a closing jin; the body turns slightly right, the centre of gravity shifts right, the left hand with the side of the thumb presses close to the right ribs and rolls inward, until the palm faces left, while the right hand reels reverse and turns the palm to face downward (Figure 15A, Figure 15B). The body turns slightly right, the centre of gravity shifts right, and the right leg becomes solid; at the same time, the right hand winds its arm with a forward reeling and the left palm makes a small reverse reeling, the two hands holding their jin together and pressing out in an arc up and to the right (Figure 16).

图 L1F16

The set posture in which the body turns slightly right, the right hand winds its arm with a forward reeling and the left palm makes a small reverse reeling, and the two hands holding their jin together press out in an arc up and to the right.

图 L1F17

The transitional posture in which the two hands support upward to the right, the left hand after its reverse reeling turns the wrist joint upward, and the right fingers hang downward.

图 L1F18

The transitional posture in which the two hands go from closing to opening, led by the waist-and-spine axis, and the two palms are separated up and down.

图 L1F19

The set posture in which the body turns slightly left, the two hands reel forward, turn their palms over, and are placed separately beside the two ears, the palms slanting outward.

2. The posture Six Seals and Four Closings means six parts sealing and four parts closing. Its function resembles the "Vajra shaking force" in Hua Tuo's Five Animal Frolics. When the two hands press down, one must purse the lips and slowly breathe out one deep, long breath; this greatly helps to regulate the respiratory system.

图 L1F20

The set posture in which the two palms close their jin and press down to the right (the press exactly reaches bottom when the exhalation ends), the body turns right with the two hands, and the left foot steps in abreast.

图 L1F21

The posture in which the two palms have pressed to before the abdomen and the centre of gravity has shifted onto the right leg.

Fifth Form: Single Whip

Action one: The body turns slightly right and thereupon turns back to the left; at the same time the right hand reels forward inward, and the left · 77 · The hand reels reverse and turns over one circle outward each; thereupon the right hand changes into a hook hand and is raised to the right, and the left palm arcs across to before the abdomen; while the body turns left and right, the left foot also follows, pivoting on its toes. (Figures 21–22)

Action two: Next, the whole weight shifts onto the right leg, the left foot is lifted, the body squats, and the left foot is thrust out with the left heel along the ground, insubstantially, to the left; at this moment the kua root opens wider, and as the centre of gravity shifts left, the left toes gradually come down to the ground and the left leg becomes solid. (Figures 23–24)

图 L1F22

The transitional posture in which the right hand changes into a hook hand and is raised to the right, the left palm arcs across to before the abdomen, and the left foot pivots on its toes.

图 L1F23

Action two: the posture in which the left foot is lifted and thrust out with the left heel along the ground, insubstantially, to the left, and the kua root is opened wider.

Action three: The left palm supports upward slightly to the right from before the abdomen, thereupon arcs to the left in a forward reeling, and when it has reeled to the left side level with

the shoulder, the palm root presses down slightly; when the left palm has reeled to the left side and turns to press, the right hand accompanies it with a slight forward reeling outward, forming an opening jin; at the same time the proportion of substantial and insubstantial between the two legs is increased, and once the Single Whip is formed the rear kua is loosened and the body is turned straight. (Figures 25–26)

图 L1F24

Action three: the set posture in which the left palm has reeled to the left side level with the shoulder and the palm root presses down slightly.

图 L1F25

The set posture in which the left palm has reeled to the left side, the right hand makes a slight forward reeling outward to form an opening jin, and the substantial-and-insubstantial proportion of the two legs is increased (the Single Whip is now formed).

图 L1F26

The set posture of the Single Whip: the two arms are extended, the right hand is a hook hand raised to the right, the left palm extends to the left, and the substantial-and-insubstantial proportion of the two legs is increased.

图 L1F27

The set posture in which the body turns slightly left, the left palm at the left side reels reverse one full circle, the right hook hand changes into a palm and reels forward outward with the palm facing outward and upward, and the two arms ward off outward and close their jin together.

· 80 · the latter part of the explanation of action two of the Second Form, "Vajra Pounds the Mortar", except that the direction differs: when this posture is completed one faces due east.

Action three is the same as action three of the Second Form, "Vajra Pounds the Mortar", except that the direction differs: this posture faces due east. (Continues with Figures 7–8)

图 L1F28

The set posture in which the two hands enlarge the reeling-silk circle and, with the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, close their jin and carry it from the left upward and around to the right, the left hand reaching before the right chest, the right hand reaching the right side level with the head, and the right leg becoming solid.

图 L1F29

White Crane Spreads Its Wings, action one: the set posture in which the two hands cross before the chest and the two arms ward off outward.

图 L1F30

White Crane Spreads Its Wings, action two: the transitional posture in which the right hand arcs up to the right and the left hand arcs down to the left, separating.

图 L1F31

The posture in which the two hands both reel reverse, the right foot steps out to the right side, and the body squats.

图 L1F32

The set posture of White Crane Spreads Its Wings: the right hand is raised up to the right, the left palm presses down to the lower left, and the left foot draws in toward the right foot, touching with its toes insubstantially beside the right foot.

图 L1F33

Diagonal Brush Step, action one: the posture in which the left hand winds its arm and raises up to before the forehead, the right hand presses down, and the left foot pivots on its toes.

图 L1F34

The posture in which the body turns back to the right and straight, the centre of gravity is still on the right foot, and the right leg is solid.

图 L1F35

Action two: the posture in which the left foot is thrust out to the left front diagonal with its heel along the ground, the right hand reels reverse and extends upward, the left hand reels forward and pushes out in an arc toward the front of the right shoulder, and the elbow is still kept bent.

图 L1F36

Action three: the set posture in which the left hand continues to reel forward and downward, passes before the abdomen, sweeps across the left knee, changes into a hook and raises up to the left; and the right hand bends its arm and reels past the right ear, the palm facing the right ear.

图 L1F37

The transitional posture in which the right hand continues to reel reverse from the left front to the right and separates from the left hand.

图 L1F38

The set posture in which the right kua is loosened, the body turns slightly left, the two shoulders sink, the right hand presses down slightly, and the left hand suspends.

图 L1F39

Ninth Form, First Herding, action one: the posture in which the two toes turn slightly right with the body, the left hook hand changes into a palm and reels forward together with the right hand, closing their ward-off with the palm roots toward the front of the left chest, the left hand in front and the right hand closed beside the left elbow.

· 85 · Action one: The two toes turn slightly right with the body; at the same time the left hook hand changes into a palm and reels forward together with the right hand, closing their ward-off with the palm roots toward the front of the left chest, the left hand in front and the right hand closed beside the left elbow. (Figure 39)

Action two: The body turns slightly right and drops with a downward thrust to the right, the whole weight shifts onto the right leg, and thereupon it turns and rises, drawing the left leg back and up, the left toes hanging naturally, the right knee slightly bent, forming the right single-leg-standing posture; when the body turns right the two hands reel with the left reverse and the right forward, and as the left foot is raised the two hands change to a double reverse reeling downward, closing their jin, the two palms slanting toward the front and down. (Figures 40–41 — From Figure 39 to 45 the direction of the postures in the plates has been turned to conform to the direction in the movement descriptions)

图 L1F40

First Herding, action two: the posture in which the left leg is drawn back and up, the left toes hang naturally, the right knee is slightly bent forming the right single-leg-standing posture, the two hands reel double reverse downward and close their jin, and the two palms slant toward the front and down.

图 L1F41

The right single-leg-standing set posture: head upright and body straight, the two hands closing their jin before the left knee.

Key points:

1. In action one (Figure 39), the two palms must, with the two upper arms linked, close their jin facing one another front and back. The body turns right, and as the two hands reel half a circle to the right with the left reverse and the right forward, the two palms face downward and at the same time the right leg gradually drops; after the half circle, the two hands begin to raise, and the two palms again face one another front and back; the left foot is lifted, the body stands up, and it becomes the right single-leg-standing posture, the two palms · 86 · and again the hearts of both palms slant toward the front and down, closing their jin. In double reverse reeling one must take note of the little fingers of the two hands.

2. This posture is the meaning of drawing back the lute for the first time: it requires using the elastic jin after the right leg drops, together with the slight reeling-silk jin of the two hands (left reverse, right forward), to make the body turn and rise into the single-leg-standing posture.

3. This posture is a single-leg-standing posture of closing jin; to attain stability in it is harder than attaining stability by an opening jin. The key lies in lifting the top jin, sinking the qi to the cinnabar

field, reeling the two hands reverse, and fixing the intent on the little fingers of the two hands — thus it is easy to attain stability.

Tenth Form: Forward Treading Brush Step

Action one: Next, the left foot begins to descend; at the same time the two hands fall to the right side with the left reeling forward and the right reeling reverse downward (the inner jin must not be lost; continue from the preceding posture). (Figure 42) The left foot's reeling jin descends forward (east), the toes slanting toward the left front, and the body turns left. At the same time the left hand reels forward, winds its arm to before the chest, the palm facing the right front; the right palm reels reverse to above the left forearm, the palm facing the left front; the two arms cross. The body continues to turn left. (Figures 43–44)

Action two: The centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg, and the right foot strides one step across to the right front (southeast) diagonal; at the same time the two palms reel reverse and separate, extending to left and right, the two palms both facing outward and the fingers pointing up. (Figure 45 and the front view of Figure 45)

图 L1F42

Forward Treading Brush Step, action one: the posture in which the left foot begins to descend and the two hands fall to the right with the left reeling forward and the right reeling reverse downward.

图 L1F43

The posture in which the left foot descends forward (east), the toes slant toward the left front, the body turns left, and the left hand reels forward to before the chest.

图 L1F44

The posture in which the two arms cross, the right palm reels reverse to above the left forearm, and the body continues to turn left.

图 L1F45

The set posture in which the right foot strides one step across to the right front (southeast) diagonal, the two palms reel reverse and separate to left and right, the two palms both facing outward and the fingers pointing up.

图 L1F45附图

The front view of Figure 45.

图 L1F46

Second Diagonal Brush Step: the posture in which the body turns left, the left foot is thrust out toward the left front (northeast) diagonal with its heel along the ground, the left hand reels forward and raises, and the right hand presses down.

图 L1F47

The set posture in which the left hand continues to reel forward and downward, passes before the abdomen, sweeps across the left knee, changes into a hook and raises up to the left; and the right hand bends its arm and reels past the right ear.

图 L1F48

The set posture in which the right hand continues to reel reverse from the left front to the right and separates from the left hand, the body turns slightly left, the two shoulders sink, the right hand presses down slightly, and the left hand suspends.

Key points: the same as the key points of the Eighth Form, "Diagonal Brush Step".

Twelfth Form: Herding Again

The movements, directions, and key points are all the same as the Ninth Form, "First Herding". (Figures 39–41)

Thirteenth Form: Forward Treading Brush Step

The movements, directions, and key points are all the same as the Tenth Form, "Forward Treading Brush Step". (Figures 42–45)

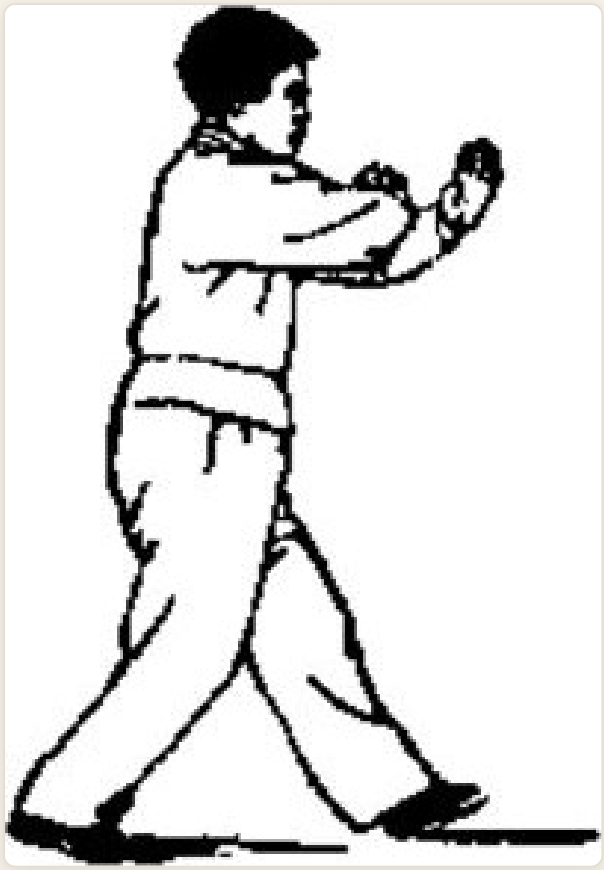
Fourteenth Form: Cover-Hand Forearm Punch

Action one: The body turns slightly left, the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg, and the right leg is lifted; as the body turns and the centre of gravity shifts left, the right palm changes into a fist and reels forward to before the chest; the left palm reels reverse and closes on the upper side of the right arm, crossing with the right arm, the palm facing the right shoulder. (Figure 49) The two hands reel forward and sink, and the crossing point of the two arms moves forward; at the same time the right foot stamps on the ground with a stomp as the qi sinks. (Figure 50)

Action two: The left foot steps toward the left front (northeast) diagonal, and the centre of gravity gradually shifts left; at the same time the crossing point of the two arms continues to move forward, and thereupon the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right forward, reel to the

left · 89 · up and to the right and down, separating in arcs, the right palm facing down and the left palm facing outward. (Figures 51–52)

图 L1F49



Cover-Hand Forearm Punch, action one: the posture in which the right palm changes into a fist and reels forward to before the chest, the left palm reels reverse and closes on the upper side of the right arm, crossing with the right arm, the palm facing the right shoulder.

图 L1F50

The posture in which the two hands reel forward and sink, the crossing point of the two arms moves forward, and the right foot stamps on the ground with a stomp as the qi sinks.

图 L1F51

Action two: the transitional posture in which the crossing point of the two arms continues to move forward and the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right forward, separate in arcs up to the left and down to the right.

图 L1F52

The set posture in which the right palm faces down, the left palm faces outward, and the body turns slightly right.

Action three: The body turns slightly right, and the whole body's qi sinks downward. At the same time the right fist reels forward, goes to the right and up past before the chest, and is drawn back to the right side of the ribs; the left hand goes from reverse reeling to forward reeling and moves to before the chest. (Figure 53)

Action four: The body turns slightly left; at the same time the two hands reel forward and close before the chest, the left palm and the right fist both facing up, the right fist placed on the left palm (seemingly stopping yet not stopping, the body continuing to sink to store jin). The centre of gravity shifts rapidly left, forming a left bow stance, the right leg slightly bent and not straightened · 90 · straight. At the same time the right fist is issued swiftly toward the right front (east, slightly south), its fist-heart turning to face down; the left hand is also swiftly drawn back to the left side of the ribs. (Figure 54 — From Figure 49 onward the foot descends in the direction of the front view of Figure 45; in fact the direction of the left foot's stepping in the movement is the northeast diagonal; Figures 49–54 show their front faces)

图 L1F53

Action three: the posture in which the right fist reels forward, goes to the right and up past before the chest, and is drawn back to the right side of the ribs, and the left hand goes from reverse reeling to forward reeling and moves to before the chest.

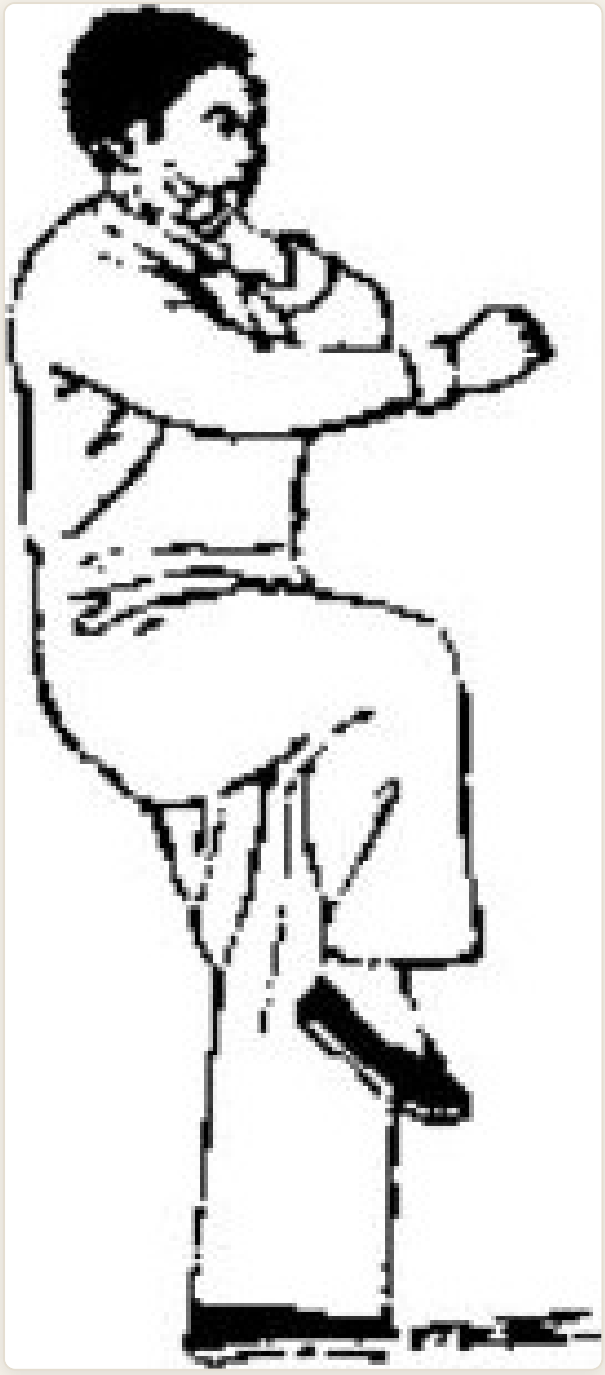
图 L1F54

Action four: the set posture in which the centre of gravity shifts rapidly left forming a left bow stance, the right fist is issued swiftly toward the right front, its fist-heart turning to face down, and the left hand is swiftly drawn back to the left side of the ribs.

图 L1F55

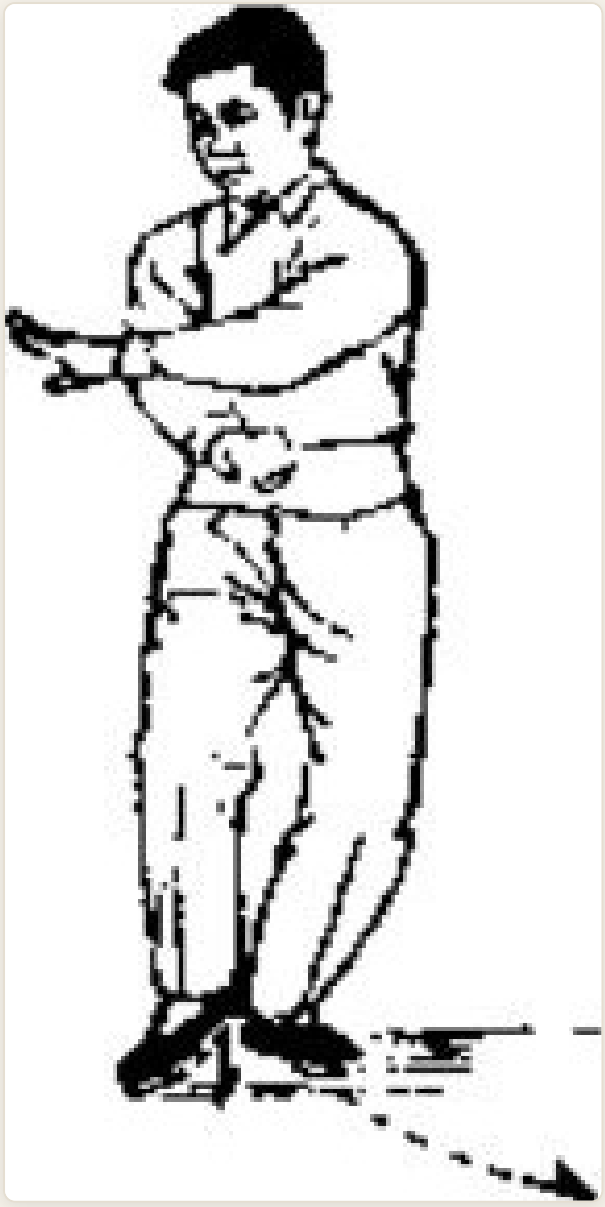
Third Vajra Pounds the Mortar, action one: the posture in which the body turns slightly right, the right fist changes into a palm and reels forward, drawing back slightly to the right rear, and the left palm still at the side of the left ribs reels reverse slightly to accompany it.

图 L1F56



The set posture in which the two hands, the right reeling forward and the left reeling reverse, arc toward the chest and cross, closing their jin, the left hand above with the palm facing down and the right palm facing up.

图 L1F57



Action two: the posture in which the body turns right, the right palm reels forward to the upper right, and the left palm reels reverse to the lower left, extending.

图 L1F58

The posture in which the right foot is drawn back and pointed forward with its toes before the left foot, and the whole weight shifts onto the left leg.

图 L1F59

The set posture in which the two hands reel, the left reverse and the right forward, the left hand bends its elbow with the forearm across before the chest, the palm facing down, the right hand sweeps up toward the chest, and the two hands form a closing jin.

Action three is the same as action three of the Second Form, "Vajra Pounds the Mortar". (Continues with Figures 7–8)

Key points:

1. Turning from the opening jin and issuing jin of the preceding posture, Cover-Hand Forearm Punch, into the closing jin of this posture, the right hand must draw in slightly and then give a small ward-off forward in the direction of the issuing jin, to tease the broken jin back into connection, so that the inner jin is unbroken and threads through into the closing jin of the double closing that follows.

2. In this posture each half-circle movement that opens as wide as possible changes into a contracting movement that closes into an extremely small half circle; it is required to feel full throughout the body, with majestic momentum.

3. This posture differs from the first two Vajra Pounds the Mortar in that: the first time manifests the ward-off jin of the five paired directions in Taijiquan; the second is the opening jin that follows on from the Single Whip, turning · 93 · into a closing jin; the third mainly teases back into connection the broken jin after the issuing jin of the previous posture. It is the close of the fifth posture of the thirteen Taiji postures.

Sixteenth Form: Drape-Body Punch

Action one: The two hands reel reverse and extend to left and right, the five fingers hanging down and the palms facing inward. (Figure 60) The two hands continue to raise and turn to forward reeling, and when they are level with the shoulder the palms turn to face front and up. (Figure 61) The whole weight shifts onto the left leg, the right foot is lifted and thrust out with its heel along the ground to the right, and thereupon the centre of gravity shifts right, forming a horse stance; at the same time the two hands continue to raise slightly, and as the right foot steps to the right they reel forward toward the chest and cross, closing together, the left palm outside. (Figures 62–63)

图 L1F60

Drape-Body Punch, action one: the posture in which the two hands reel reverse and extend to left and right, the five fingers hang down, and the palms face inward.

图 L1F61

The posture in which the two hands continue to raise and turn to forward reeling, and when they are level with the shoulder the palms turn to face front and up.

图 L1F62

The posture in which the whole weight shifts onto the left leg and the right foot is lifted and thrust out with its heel along the ground to the right.

图 L1F63

The set posture in which the horse stance is formed and the two hands, as the right foot steps to the right, reel forward toward the chest and cross, closing together, the left palm outside.

· 94 · Action two: The two hands change into fists; the right fist, before the face, reels reverse from inward to the right and opens, thereupon turning from right to forward with a forward reeling and closing, circling one full circle, the fist-heart facing inward; the left hand reels reverse to the left and opens, thereupon turning to forward reeling and closing slightly as the right hand closes, the fist-heart facing right; when the right hand has circled half a circle to the right, the centre of gravity shifts slightly right and the body turns slightly right; when the right hand has circled one full circle, the centre of gravity shifts back and the body turns straight. (Figure 64)

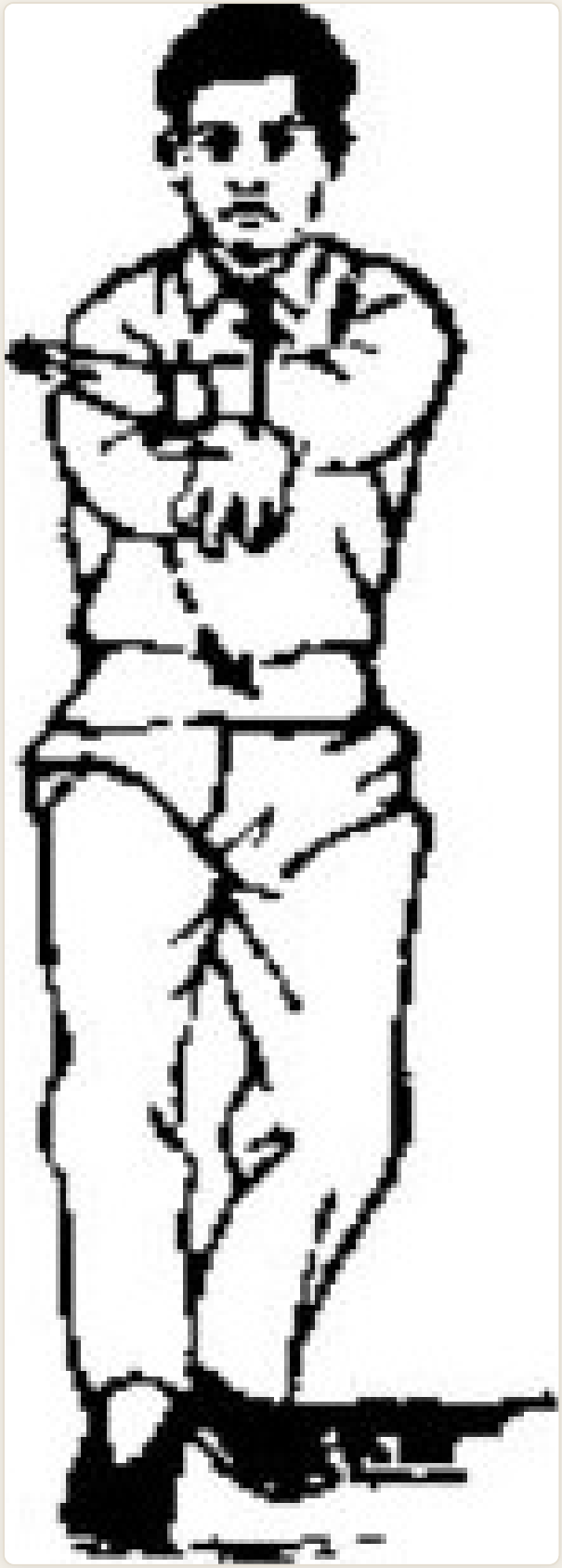
图 L1F64

Drape-Body Punch, action two: the set posture in which the two hands change into fists, the right fist circles one full circle, and the left hand closes slightly as the right hand closes.

图 L1F65

Action three: the posture in which the body turns slightly left, the left leg forms a bow, the right fist moves to before the left ear level with the head, and the left fist at the original place on the left side reels forward in a small circle to accompany the right fist's closing jin.

图 L1F66



The set posture in which the centre of gravity shifts right and the right leg forms a bow, the right fist arcs down to the right with a forward reeling to beside the right leg, and the left fist

reels forward from left to right passing before the face, closing its jin together with the right fist.

· 95 · **Key points:** 1. This posture turns from the closing jin of the preceding posture, Vajra Pounds the Mortar, into a double reverse opening jin; after opening it changes to double forward reeling, the two palms turning to face outward in a closing jin of the two hands, and thereupon the two hands reel forward and cross, closing together; during these openings and closings one must take note of the substantial and insubstantial of the two hands and of the two feet, and especially of the substantial and insubstantial between hand and foot. On this point see the fourth characteristic.

2. Actions two and three (Figures 64–66) are movements after the two palms change into fists; they must be made continuous as one, and performed under the requirement that the qi cling to the spine and the waist be the axis; the key lies in specially enlarging the inner-and-outer reeling silk and in letting the earlier reeling silk lead the later reeling silk; only thus can the movements in the three figures be joined into one, and the inner jin be not lost, changing over without any hollows or protrusions. On this point see the fifth characteristic.

3. Throughout all the processes of this posture's opening-and-closing and closing-and-opening, it is rich in soft jin; it is the soft jin of the four corners, serving as an auxiliary within the four cardinal frame.

Seventeenth Form: Back-Bending Shoulder

Action one: The body turns left by 90 degrees. At the same time the right hand reels reverse and raises in an arc, the fist-heart facing left; the left hand winds its arm with a forward reeling and descends in a left arc to the side of the left waist, the fist-heart facing back. (Figure 67)

图 L1F67

Back-Bending Shoulder, action one: the posture in which the body turns left by 90 degrees, the right hand reels reverse and raises in an arc with the fist-heart facing left, and the left hand winds its arm with a forward reeling and descends in an arc to the side of the left waist with the fist-heart facing back.

图 L1F68

Back-Bending Shoulder, action two: the posture in which the right arm is bent before the top of the head, the face of the left fist presses close to the left waist, the back near the right shoulder leans to the right rear, and the crotch opening sinks further.

图 L1F69

Green Dragon Emerges from Water, action one: the posture in which the right fist winds its arm with a forward reeling and descends in an arc from above, past before the chest, to the right side of the right leg with the fist-heart facing up, and the left fist leaves the left waist with a reverse reeling and raises in a left arc with the fist-heart facing inward.

图 L1F70

The set posture in which the right fist raises in a right arc and turns again to forward reeling until the fist-heart faces left, and the left fist changes to forward reeling, bends its elbow with the forearm across, and descends past before the chest to be placed before the abdomen with the fist-heart facing up.

图 L1F71

Action two: the posture in which the left fist changes into a palm and extends with a reverse reeling toward the right front with the palm facing the right rear, and the right fist reels forward, bends its elbow, and descends to be placed before the chest above the left arm with the fist-heart facing inward.

Action two: The body turns slightly left. At the same time the left fist changes into a palm and extends with a reverse reeling toward the right front, the palm facing the right rear; the right fist reels forward, bends its elbow, and descends to be placed before the chest above the left arm, the fist-heart facing inward. (Figure 71) The centre of gravity shifts slightly right. At the same time the left hand reels forward and sinks, the palm facing the right rear; the right fist reels

forward and gathers in beneath the chest, closing its jin together with the left palm, drawing the spine taut. (Figure 72) The body turns slightly left, and as the kua jin sinks, the right fist winds its arm with a reverse reeling and suddenly "releases the catch" from the spine, issuing jin toward the right front with the ulnar side near the wrist; the left hand reels forward and is drawn back at the same speed as the right fist's issuing, to be placed at the side of the left waist. (Figure 73)

图 L1F72

The posture in which the left hand reels forward and sinks, the right fist reels forward and gathers in beneath the chest, closing its jin together with the left palm, and the spine is drawn taut.

图 L1F73

The set posture in which the body turns slightly left, the right fist winds its arm with a reverse reeling and "releases the catch" from the spine, issuing jin toward the right front with the ulnar side near the wrist, and the left hand reels forward and is drawn back to be placed at the side of the left waist.

Key points:

1. Chen-style Taijiquan applies reeling-silk jin not only in the two hands; in fact the two legs also simultaneously ap- · 98 · ply it. Because this posture has a long stride and a wide crotch opening, it is the clearest example of the legs manifesting reeling-silk jin. Leg reeling silk is: when the hand on one leg reels forward, that leg likewise generally reels forward with the knee turning out; conversely, the knee turns in with a reverse reeling (for the principle of leg reeling silk see the second key point of the Twenty-first Form, "Punch Beneath the Elbow"). From the posture in this figure, the two legs seem not to have moved at all, and one sees only the two arms changing movement; in fact the legs too are reeling silk.

2. Taiji jin is the inner jin that arises from the heel, is issued from the leg, is governed by the waist and spine, and takes form in the fingers; reeling silk is a fairly long path of movement through which this inner jin passes. In the whole body there are two such paths, namely from the left heel to the right fingers and from the right heel to the left fingers, and they cross each other on the spine, one after the other.

3. To thread all the joints of the whole body through like a single line, one must complete it by the spiral of reeling silk. Reeling silk is governed by the waist and spine, leads the two arms, and has its foundation in the two legs; if the legs have no reeling silk, one cannot attain the realm of the whole body as one family. On this point one should take note.

4. The reason this posture is called "emerging from water" is that this kind of issuing jin is like "a thing about to be raised being given a downward check" — that is, at the end of the downward half circle there is an upward jin, and so it is also named the shaking jin of emerging from water.

5. The issuing jin of this posture belongs to the rend jin among the four-corner hand; the reason it is not called a "strike" or a "blow" is that rend jin is a short-distance strike, and so some also call it "inch jin".

Nineteenth Form: Double Push Hands

Action one: The centre of gravity shifts slightly right, and the body turns slightly right. At the same time the right elbow bends slightly, the right fist gathers slightly, the fist-heart facing inward; the left palm extends forward to the inner side of the right wrist, and thereupon the two hands ward off outward slightly (to draw on the movement that follows). (Figure 74) Then the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg, and the body turns slightly left; at the same time the right arm reels forward and wards off down to the left to before the abdomen, and the left hand with a small reverse reeling accompanies the right arm · 99 · in drawing it in and warding off. (Figure 75) What follows is the same as the latter part of the explanation of action one of the Fourth Form, "Six Seals and Four Closings". (Continues with Figure 16)

图 L1F74

Double Push Hands, action one: the posture in which the right elbow bends slightly, the right fist gathers slightly with the fist-heart facing inward, the left palm extends forward to the inner side of the right wrist, and the two hands ward off outward slightly.

图 L1F75

The posture in which the right arm reels forward and wards off down to the left to before the abdomen, and the left hand with a small reverse reeling accompanies the right arm in drawing it in and warding off.

Action two: The same as the former part of the explanation of action two of the Fourth Form, "Six Seals and Four Closings". (Figure 77, continuing with Figure 76; the difference is that in this posture the left palm passes the waist before pressing down again) Then the left toes turn out, the body turns left (the chest going from facing south to facing east), the whole weight shifts onto the left leg, the right foot is drawn back and touches the ground with its toes toward the left front (south, slightly east). At the same time the right palm continues to reel forward with the palm supporting upward; the left palm reels reverse and is drawn back to the side of the left ribs, braced with the back of the hand, the palm slanting upward. (Figure 77 — From Figure 77 to 85

the movements in the plates are all done with the body facing east, and the plates show their front faces)

图 L1F76

Action two: the posture in which the two hands are the same as the former part of action two of "Six Seals and Four Closings" and the centre of gravity shifts onto the right leg.

图 L1F77

The posture in which the left toes turn out, the body turns left, the right foot is drawn back and touches the ground with its toes toward the left front, the right palm reels forward and supports upward with the palm, and the left palm reels reverse and is drawn back to the side of the left ribs, braced with the back of the hand, the palm slanting upward.

图 L1F78

Action three: the posture in which the two hands reel forward, turn their palms over, and are placed separately beside the two ears with the palms slanting outward, the right toes pivot on the ground, and the right knee turns with the body.

图 L1F79

The set posture in which the right foot steps to the right, the centre of gravity shifts onto the right leg, the left foot steps in abreast to the right and touches with its toes beside the right foot, the body turns right, and the two palms close their jin and press down to the right as the body turns.

图 L1F80

Three Palm Changes: the posture in which the right palm draws back inward past before the chest with a forward reeling and the palm facing inward, and the left palm reels reverse, winds its arm, and extends forward level, turning to face the palm upward.

图 L1F81

The posture in which the right palm reels forward and pushes out with ward-off jin, the palm slanting outward, and the left palm, as the body turns, reels reverse and is drawn back to before the abdomen, the palm facing up.

图 L1F82

The posture in which the right palm reels forward and is drawn back to before the abdomen, and the left palm, from before the abdomen, reels reverse upward and forward past above the right arm, pushing out with ward-off jin.

图 L1F83

The opening of Punch Beneath the Elbow: the posture in which the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, open out separately, the left hand down-left and the right hand up-right.

图 L1F84

The posture in which the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, reel slightly until level with the shoulders, both palms facing down (the opening stage of Punch Beneath the Elbow).

图 L1F85

The posture in which the two hands, left reverse-reeling and right forward-reeling, close with jin, the left arm changing from reverse to forward reeling with the left forearm raised upright and the palm reeling round to face right, and the right palm becoming a fist that reels forward and, bending its elbow forward-left with closing jin, comes to rest below the left elbow.

图 L1F86

The posture in which the left palm, from below the left elbow, passes before the abdomen and then upward to the right, changing from forward to reverse reeling, and reels in an arc to beside the right cheek, the palm slanting toward the left front.

图 L1F87附图

The posture in which the left foot, passing beside the right ankle, steps back in an arc to the left rear (northwest) with the centre of gravity shifting back and the left leg becoming full, the right palm reeling reverse and pushing forward, and the left palm crossing beneath the right forearm and opening out in an arc to the left rear. The attached figure shows the rear view.

图 L1F87正面图

The front view of the same movement as the attached figure 87, with the chest facing due east.

图 L1F88附图

Continuing from the attached figure 87, the posture in which the left palm continues to open out in an arc to the left rear and the right palm pushes forward. The attached figure shows the rear view.

· 105 · Action two: The two hands and the two legs each reel forward in a small circle (by a turning jin), and then the centre of gravity shifts left. At the same time, the left palm, from the left, goes upward, changing from forward reeling to reverse reeling, and reels in an arc to beside the left cheek, the palm slanting toward the right front; the right palm, from small forward reeling to large forward reeling, reels from right to left past before the chest and downward. (Figure 89) The right foot is lifted and, passing beside the left ankle, steps back in an arc to the right rear (southwest); the centre of gravity shifts back with it and the right leg becomes full. At the same time, the left palm reels reverse and pushes forward; the right palm crosses before the chest beneath the extended left forearm, that is, from the lower right, as the right foot steps back, it opens out in an arc to the right rear. (Figure 90)

Action three is the same as action two, only left and right are reversed. (Figure 91, then follow the front view of 88)

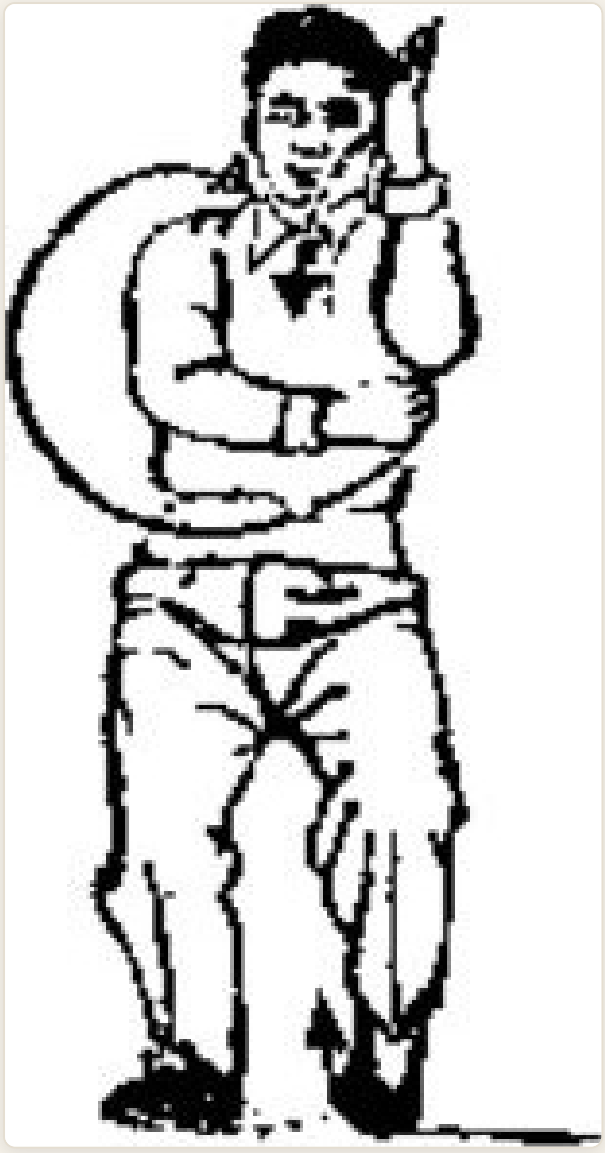
图 L1F88正面图

The end of action one (continuing from the attached figure 88): the front view of the posture in which the left palm opens out in an arc to the left rear and the right palm pushes forward, with the chest facing due east.

图 L1F89

The beginning of action two: the posture in which the left palm, from the left, goes upward, changing from forward to reverse reeling, and reels in an arc to beside the left cheek, the palm slanting toward the right front, and the right palm reels from right to left past before the chest and downward.

图 L1F90



The posture in which the right foot, passing beside the left ankle, steps back in an arc to the right rear (southwest) with the centre of gravity shifting back and the right leg becoming full, the left palm reeling reverse and pushing forward, and the right palm crossing beneath the left forearm and opening out in an arc to the right rear.

图 L1F91

Action three, the same as action two with left and right reversed: the posture in which the right palm reels in an arc to beside the right cheek and the left palm reels past before the chest and downward, whereupon the left foot, passing beside the right ankle, steps back in an arc to the left rear, the right palm pushes forward, and the left palm opens out in an arc to the right rear.

图 L1F92

Action one of Step Back and Press the Elbow: the posture in which the left palm turns its arm forward-reeling and opens out to the lower left with the palm facing down, and the right palm reels reverse and opens out slanting to the upper right with the palm facing outward.

图 L1F93

Continuing from figure 92: the posture in which the right palm reels forward toward the front and inside, changes to reverse reeling and circles once to the right, and the left palm, as the right palm circles right, reels forward and draws an arc to the right to before the right ribs.

图 L1F94

Action two: the posture in which the right palm reels forward and is drawn back in an arc with its fingers adhering to the left abdomen, and the left elbow presses up past the inner side of the right palm with the left palm reeling reverse and its finger-backs adhering to the right ribs and rising.

图 L1F95

Continuing from figure 94: the posture in which, as the body turns right and the right foot stamps, the left palm pushes out on the slant toward the left front and the right palm, its fingers adhering to the body, moves to the right abdomen.

图 L1F96

Action one of Middle Plate: the posture in which the left palm, as the body turns right, reels reversely with the arm from the left up to the right to before the right ribs with the palm facing up, and the right palm reels reverse and is raised to the right rear with the palm facing right, the right foot being lifted as the right palm rises.

图 L1F97

Action two: the posture in which the right foot comes down beside the left foot, first touching with the toes and then stamping the ground with the heel, with the centre of gravity shifting onto the right leg and the left heel lifting, the right hand reeling reverse with its elbow bent so the elbow tip passes above the right palm and draws an arc from above to before the left eyebrow, and the left palm reeling forward and shifting down to below the left ribs with the palm facing up, the two arms crossing before the chest.

图 L1F97附图

Another view of the same movement as figure 97, showing its front aspect (chest facing east).

· 109 · Action three: The body turns slightly left; the left foot opens one step sideways to the left rear (north, slightly west) on the slant, bending the knee and squatting down; at the same time, the two hands reel forward and press outward, the palms turning outward and down, and as the left foot opens the two arms close slightly, the two palms turning inward; immediately the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, open out separately, the left hand to the upper left and the right hand to the lower right, both palms facing down. (Figures 98–99, and attached figures 98 and 99)

图 L1F98

Action three of Middle Plate: the posture in which the left foot opens one step sideways to the left rear (north, slightly west) on the slant, bending the knee and squatting down, and the two hands reel forward and press outward with the palms turning outward and down, the two arms closing slightly as the left foot opens.

图 L1F98附图

Another view of the same movement as figure 98.

图 L1F99

Continuing from figure 98: the posture in which the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, then open out separately, the left hand to the upper left and the right hand to the lower right, both palms facing down.

图 L1F99附图

Another view of the same movement as figure 99.

Essential points:

1. At the beginning of this posture, attention should be paid to the size of the forward and reverse silk-reeling. In order that the movement gain posture and gain jin, when the right palm passes below the left elbow it should tighten the diameter of its circle; this is also the time when the large and small forward and reverse reeling begins to form. Before the double opening one must inhale, and on changing to the double opening one must exhale, exhaling all the way until the two hands have opened to their fixed point; this too is what brings this movement to a state of spirits-and- · 110 · one of the methods.

2. In the double closing (figure 98), it is required that the closing harbour an opening; the key is that before the double closing the qi must adhere to the back, and when the two palms cross and close the palms must turn outward and down, for thus the closing can harbour opening jin; if one has not attained parting within the closing, the jin will be balled up and stuck on the body, losing its elasticity and becoming the defect of collapsing.

3. In this posture, when the body squats down squarely upright, the kua opening must be broad. Thus the qi of the perineum will naturally rise from the coccyx, which is very beneficial. But when squatting, the height of the kua opening must not be lower than the knee, lest a sagging crotch form; if there is a sagging crotch it will make the outer sides of the two feet float emptily, and thereby cause sluggishness in the transformation of empty and full, so at the same time one should also avoid the defect of double weighting in the legs.

Twenty-Fifth Form: White Crane Spreads Its Wings

Action one: The body turns slightly left; the right foot steps up beside the left, touching its toes beside the left toes. At the same time, the right palm turns its arm forward-reeling and draws an arc leftward past before the abdomen, the palm facing up; the left palm reels reverse, passes before the face, and bending its elbow to the right joins above the right arm. (Figure 100, the front view of attached figure 100) The right foot steps out on the slant to the right front (southeast). What follows is the same as action two of the seventh form, "White Crane Spreads Its Wings". (Continuing to figures 31–32)

图 L1F100

Action one of White Crane Spreads Its Wings: the posture in which the right foot steps up beside the left with its toes touching beside the left toes, the right palm turning its arm forward-reeling and drawing an arc leftward past before the abdomen with the palm facing up, and the left palm reeling reverse, passing before the face and bending its elbow to the right to join above the right arm.

图 L1F100附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 100.

图 L1F101

Action one of Flash Through the Back (the same as action one of the ninth form, "First Withdrawal").

图 L1F102

Action two: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts onto the right leg and, pivoting on the right heel, the body turns to the left rear with the chest turning to face north, the right foot following the turning body back in an arc and coming down with its toes beside the left foot, the right hand reeling forward and turning over so the palm faces outward, and the left hand reeling reverse, closing with jin rightward past before the abdomen and adhering with its palm below the right forearm with the palm facing inward.

图 L1F102附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 102.

Action three: The body squats slightly; at the same time, the two hands reel forward slightly and close a little, then change to reverse reeling and open out separately to left and right (note the

little fingers): the left hand turns its wrist inward so the palm faces inward, and the right hand is held as a horizontal palm with the wrist tilted up so the palm faces outward. (Figure 103, the front view of attached figure 103)

Action four: Pivoting on the right heel, the body turns right; the left toes touch the ground and pivot, the left knee turning with the turning of the body. At the same time, the right hand closes leftward and inward to the left side of the abdomen, the palm · 112 · faces up; the left hand reels forward and, as the body turns, bends its arm and pushes forward and down, the palm facing forward. (Figure 104, another side view of attached figure 104) The left foot steps forward one step, and the centre of gravity immediately shifts forward, the left leg becoming full. At the same time, the left palm passes before the chest leftward and then is placed beside the left kua, the palm facing down-right; the right palm reels forward and extends forward, the palm facing up. (Figure 105, another side view of attached figure 105)

图 L1F103

Action three of Flash Through the Back: the posture in which the body squats slightly and the two hands reel forward slightly and close a little, then change to reverse reeling and open out separately to left and right, the left hand turning its wrist inward so the palm faces inward and the right hand held as a horizontal palm with the wrist tilted up so the palm faces outward.

图 L1F103附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 103.

图 L1F104

Action four: the posture in which, pivoting on the right heel, the body turns right with the left toes touching the ground and pivoting and the left knee turning with the turning of the body, the right hand closing leftward and inward to the left side of the abdomen with the palm facing up, and the left hand reeling forward and, as the body turns, bending its arm and pushing forward and down with the palm facing forward.

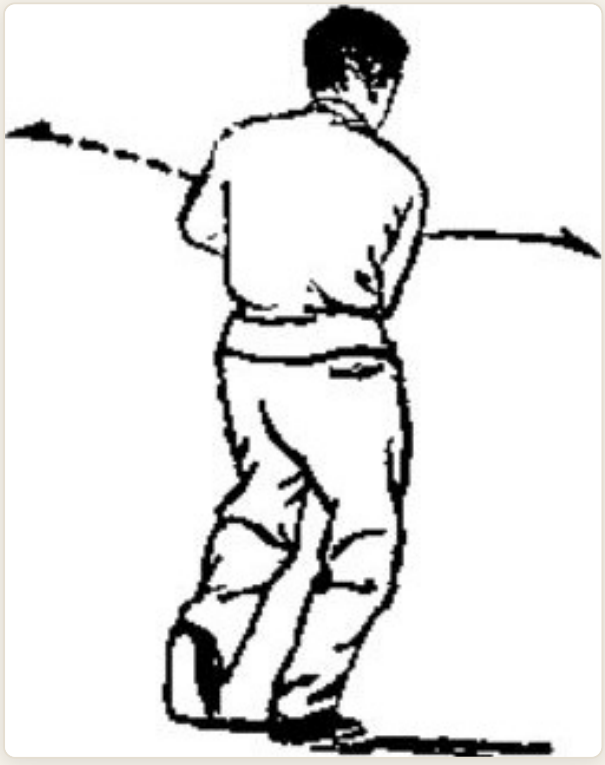
图 L1F104附图

Another side view of the same movement as figure 104.

图 L1F105

Action four of Flash Through the Back: the posture in which the left foot steps forward one step and the centre of gravity immediately shifts forward with the left leg becoming full, the left palm passing before the chest leftward and then being placed beside the left kua with the palm facing down-right, and the right palm reeling forward and extending forward with the palm facing up.

图 L1F105附图



Another side view of the same movement as figure 105.

图 L1F106

Action five: the posture in which, pivoting on the left heel, the body turns rapidly to the right rear and the right foot, its ball of the foot adhering to the ground, turns half a circle to the right rear with the turning body and then its heel kicks out to stamp the ground, the right hand reeling forward and turning inward until its palm faces outward while pressing down in an arc to beside the right kua with the palm facing down, and the left palm bending its arm and turning upward to push out forward and down past beside the left ear.

图 L1F106附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 106.

图 L1F107

Action one of Cover Hand and Forearm Punch: the posture in which the two hands part to left and right with opening jin.

图 L1F107附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 107.

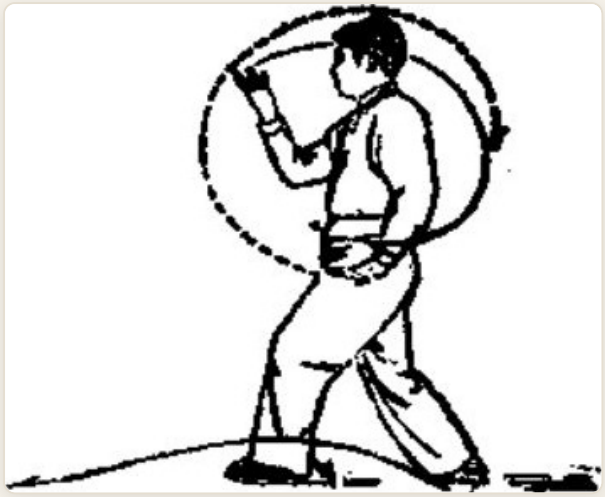
图 L1F108

Continuing from the movements of the fourteenth form, "Cover Hand and Forearm Punch", showing the posture (rear view) after this form's direction has changed, with the left foot in the southwest and the right foot in the northwest.

图 L1F109

The same as above, from another angle, showing its stance.

图 L1F110



Action one of Six Seals and Four Closings: the posture in which the right hand turns its arm in a large forward reeling and reaches to before the abdomen while the left hand with a small reverse reeling circles to before the chest, the two hands forming a closing jin.

图 L1F111

Continuing from figure 110: the posture in which the body turns slightly right with the centre of gravity shifting forward and the left leg becoming full, the right hand turning its arm forward-reeling and the left palm reeling slightly reverse, and the two hands, holding jin together, squeezing out in an arc to the upper right.

图 L1F112

Action two: the posture in which the body turns left with the whole centre of gravity shifting onto the left leg and the right foot lifted forward, the right hand reeling forward and supporting upward, and the left hand reeling reverse, turning its arm, and with the wrist joint on the back-of-hand side making an arc warding-off to the upper left with the five fingers hanging down.

Essential points:

See the essential points of the fourth form, "Six Seals and Four Closings".

Thirtieth Form: Single Whip

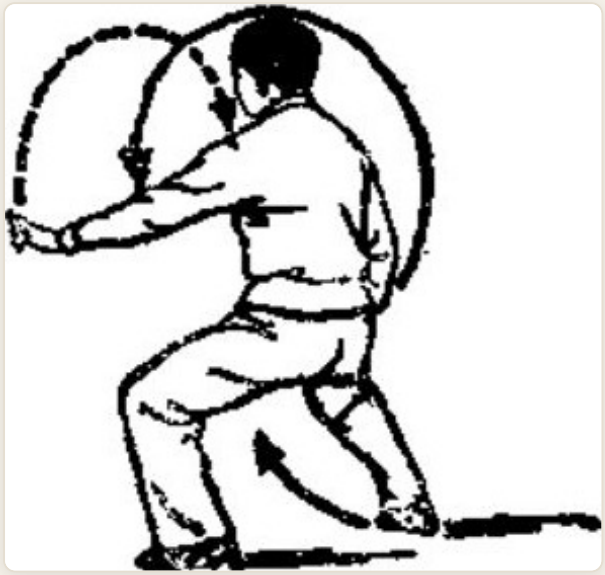
The action and the essential points are both the same as the fifth form, "Single Whip". (Figures 21–25, then continuing to figure 113)

Thirty-First Form: Wave Hands

Action one: The body turns left, the right knee slightly extended and not straightened. At the same time, the right hooked hand becomes a palm and reels forward, moving in an arc leftward up to before the right forehead, the palm facing left; the left palm reels forward from inside to outside-left, extended slightly, the arm not straightened, the palm facing down. (Figure 114) The body turns slightly right and the left foot draws half a step toward the right, touching with its toes, the right leg becoming full. At the same time, the right palm changes from forward reeling

to reverse reeling and opens out to the right, its palm changing from facing down to facing right; the left palm, from the left, goes down and reels forward rightward past before the abdomen to the right of the body, the palm slanting to the upper right. (Figure 115) The body turns slightly left, and the left foot opens half a step sideways to the left. At the same time, the right hand falls in an arc, the palm facing down; the left hand changes from forward reeling to reverse reeling, turns its arm and turns the palm to face outward, and draws an arc upward. (Figure 116)

图 L1F113

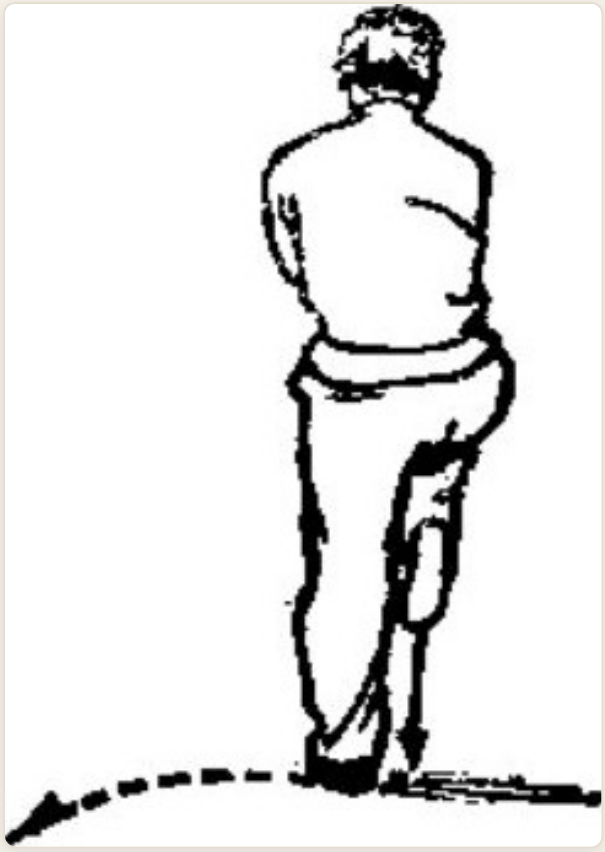


Single Whip: the action and essential points are the same as the fifth form, "Single Whip".

图 L1F114

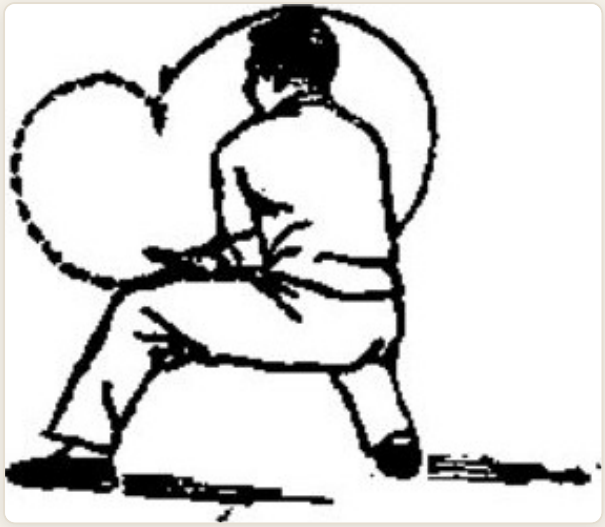
Action one of Wave Hands: the posture in which the body turns left with the right knee slightly extended and not straightened, the right hooked hand becoming a palm and reeling forward to move in an arc leftward up to before the right forehead with the palm facing left, and the left palm reeling forward from inside to outside-left, extended slightly with the arm not straightened and the palm facing down.

图 L1F115



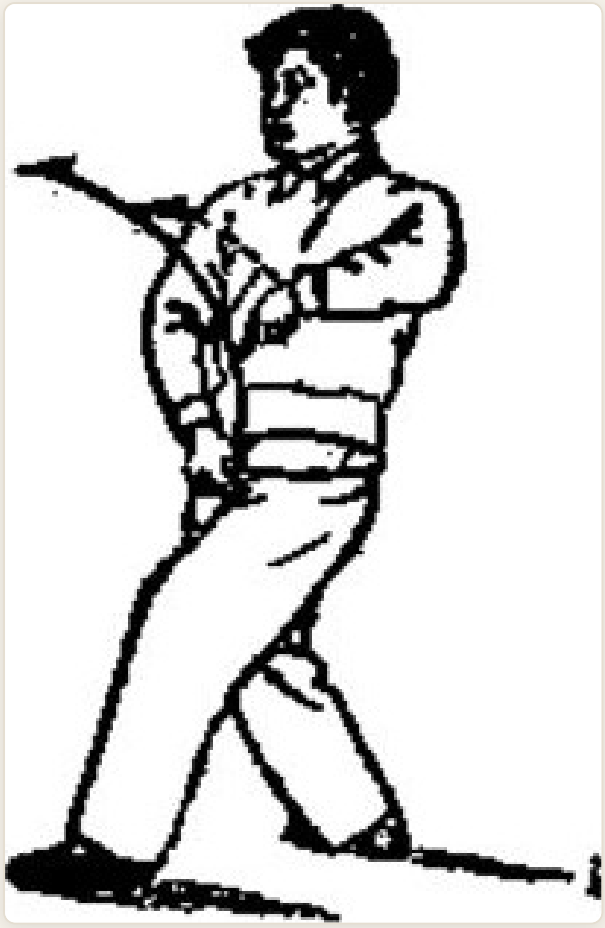
Continuing from figure 114: the posture in which the body turns slightly right and the left foot draws half a step toward the right, touching with its toes, with the right leg becoming full, the right palm changing from forward to reverse reeling and opening out to the right, and the left palm going down from the left and reeling forward rightward past before the abdomen to the right of the body with the palm slanting to the upper right.

图 L1F116



Continuing from figure 115: the posture in which the body turns slightly left and the left foot opens half a step sideways to the left, the right hand falling in an arc with the palm facing down, and the left hand changing from forward to reverse reeling, turning its arm and turning the palm to face outward and drawing an arc upward.

图 L1F117



Action two of Wave Hands: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg and the right foot steals a step to the left (east) from behind the left foot with the body turning slightly right, and the two hands reel forward, the left palm turning its arm and passing before the face to reel reverse and transport leftward with its palm turning to face left, and the right palm turning its arm and passing before the abdomen to reel reverse and transport leftward and upward with its palm turning over to face the upper left.

图 L1F118

Continuing from figure 117: the posture in which the body continues to turn slightly right and the left foot opens one step sideways to the left (east), and the two hands reel forward, the left palm turning its arm and going down from the left to reel reverse rightward past before the abdomen and transport upward with its palm slanting to the upper right, and the right palm turning its arm and going up from the left to transport rightward past before the face with its palm facing right.

图 L1F119

Continuation of Wave Hands: the posture in which the centre of gravity gradually shifts left and the body turns slightly left, the right palm transporting downward in an arc with the palm facing down, and the left hand reeling forward, turning its arm and turning the palm to face outward and reeling reverse to transport upward.

图 L1F120

Action one of High Pat on Horse: the posture in which the body turns left with the centre of gravity shifting left and the right foot stepping slanting half a step to the right front (southwest), the left hand reeling reverse and being drawn back to before the chest, and the right hand reeling forward and closing and gathering leftward past before the abdomen, the two arms crossing before the chest with the right arm outside.

图 L1F121

Continuing from figure 120: the posture in which the two arms first close slightly, contracting the crossed circle, and then the two hands reel reverse and open out separately to left and right with the palms slanting down, the centre of gravity shifting slightly right while the two arms close slightly and shifting left again when the two hands open out.

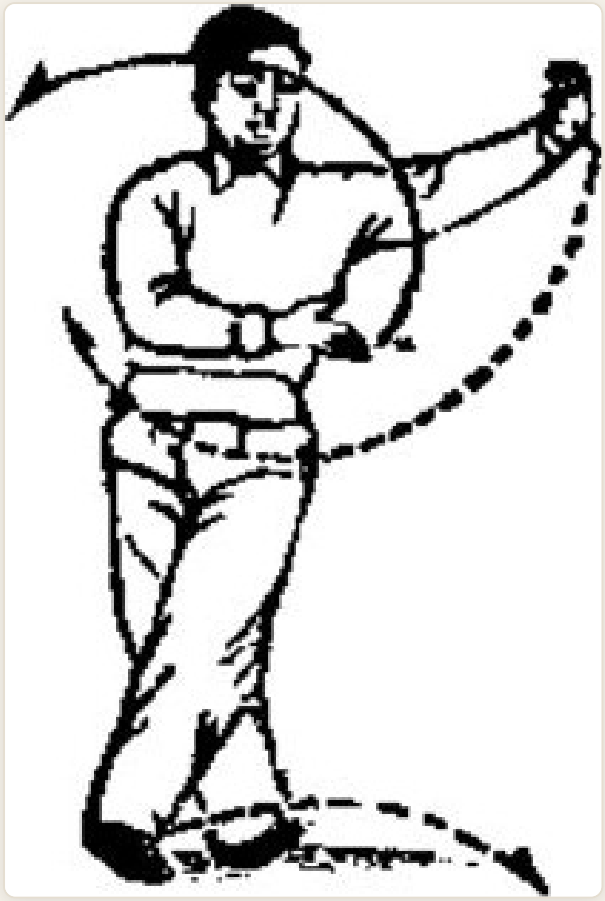
图 L1F122

Action two of High Pat on Horse: the posture in which the body turns left and the centre of gravity shifts onto the right leg, the right hand turning its arm and reeling reverse to beside the right hand with the palm slanting inward and the left hand reeling slightly forward and closing rightward with the palm facing up, the two arms extended forward.

图 L1F123

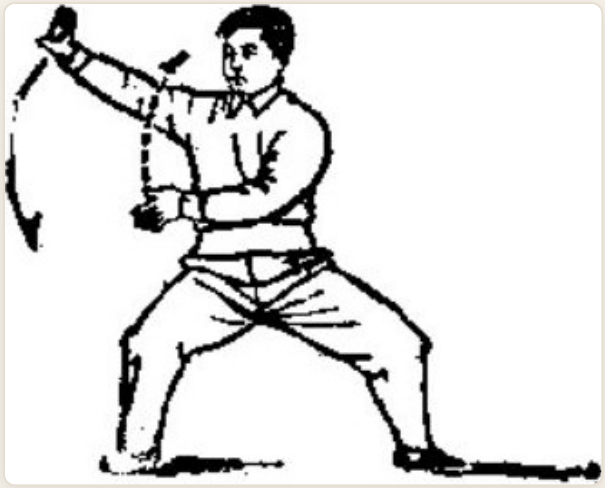
Continuing from figure 122: the posture in which, pivoting on the right heel, the body continues to turn left with the whole centre of gravity shifting onto the right leg, and the left foot is drawn back, passing inside the right ankle to step back (west), touching with its toes beside the right foot with the distance between the two feet equal to shoulder width, the left palm bending its arm and reeling reverse to draw back to the left side of the waist with the palm facing up, and the right palm reeling forward and pushing out with the palm facing outward.

图 L1F124



The last phase of action two of High Pat on Horse: the posture (rear view) in which, pivoting on the right heel, the body turns left and the left foot is drawn back, passing inside the right ankle to step back and touching with its toes beside the right foot, the left palm bending its arm and reeling reverse to draw back to the left side of the waist while the right palm reels forward and pushes out, whereupon the two hands come together and the two arms extend forward.

图 L1F124附图



The front view of the same movement as figure 124.

图 L1F125

Action one of Right Brush-Foot: the posture (rear view) in which the right hand reels slightly forward and turns over downward to before the abdomen with the palm facing left and the fingers pointing down, and the left hand, from the side of the waist, turns its arm and reels reverse to before the chest with the palm facing up, the two hands opened out.

图 L1F125附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 125.

图 L1F126

Continuing from figure 125: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns slightly right with the centre of gravity still on the right leg, and the two hands, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, ward-off outward with the right forearm at shoulder height with the left hand adhering to the inner side of the right forearm.

图 L1F126附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 126.

图 L1F127

The first phase of action two of Right Brush-Foot: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns slightly left, the left hand reeling reverse and going down from the right to open out leftward past before the abdomen with the palm facing right, and the right palm reeling forward and shifting slightly downward with the palm facing down, the two arms opened out (with the elbow tips sinking downward).

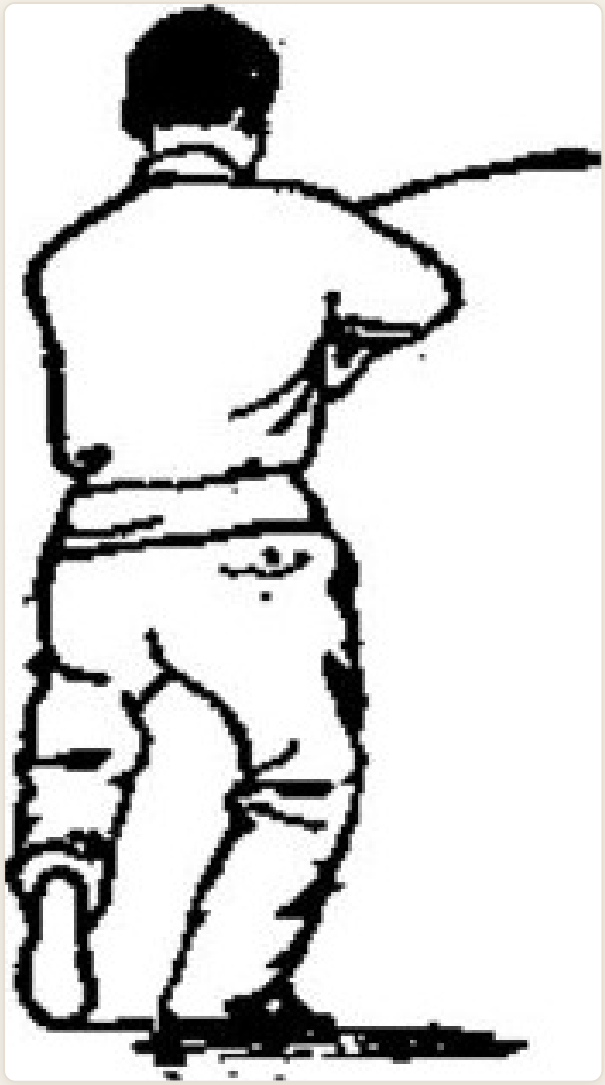
图 L1F127附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 127.

图 L1F128

Continuing from figure 127: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns slightly right, the right hand turning its arm forward-reeling and closing inward to the left of before the chest while the left hand goes up from the left and draws an arc rightward to above the right arm with the two arms crossing, and at the same time the left foot, passing before the right foot, steps across sideways to the right with the toes pointing forward.

图 L1F128附图



The front view of the same movement as figure 128.

图 L1F129

Action three of Right Brush-Foot: the posture (rear view) in which the right foot, its instep stretched flat, kicks up to the right front and the two hands reel forward and go up, opening out to left and right past before the face with the palms facing down, the right palm reeling reverse to meet and strike (brush) the right instep while the left palm follows, reeling reverse to pat down to the left rear.

图 L1F129附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 129.

图 L1F130

Action one of Left Brush-Foot: the posture (rear view, showing its right-turn-and-descend tendency) in which the right foot is drawn back and comes down to the right (east) with its toes turned out and planted, the body turning right at the same time with the centre of gravity shifting onto the right leg and the left heel lifting off the ground, and the two hands reeling forward, going down from left and right, and gathering and crossing before the chest.

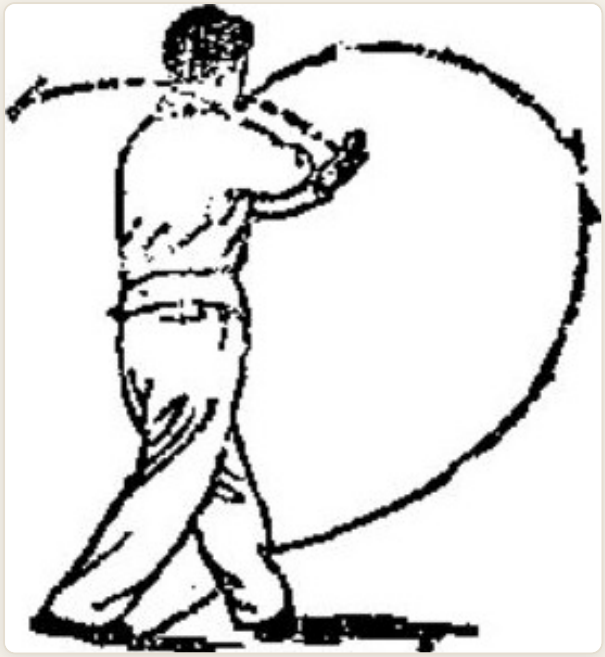
图 L1F130附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 130.

图 L1F131

The latter phase of action one of Left Brush-Foot: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns slightly right and the two hands reel forward and go up, opening out to left and right past before the face with the palms facing outward.

图 L1F132



Action two of Left Brush-Foot: the posture in which the left foot, its instep stretched flat, kicks up to the left front and the left palm reels reverse to meet and strike (brush) the left instep while the right palm follows, reeling reverse to pat down to the right rear.

图 L1F133

Action one of Heel Kick: the posture (rear view) in which the left foot is drawn back and lifted and, pivoting on the right heel, the body turns 135 degrees to the left rear, the two hands crossing before the chest with forward and reverse reeling, and as the body turns the two palms become fists, reeling reverse one circle and crossing with closing jin before the chest.

图 L1F133附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 133.

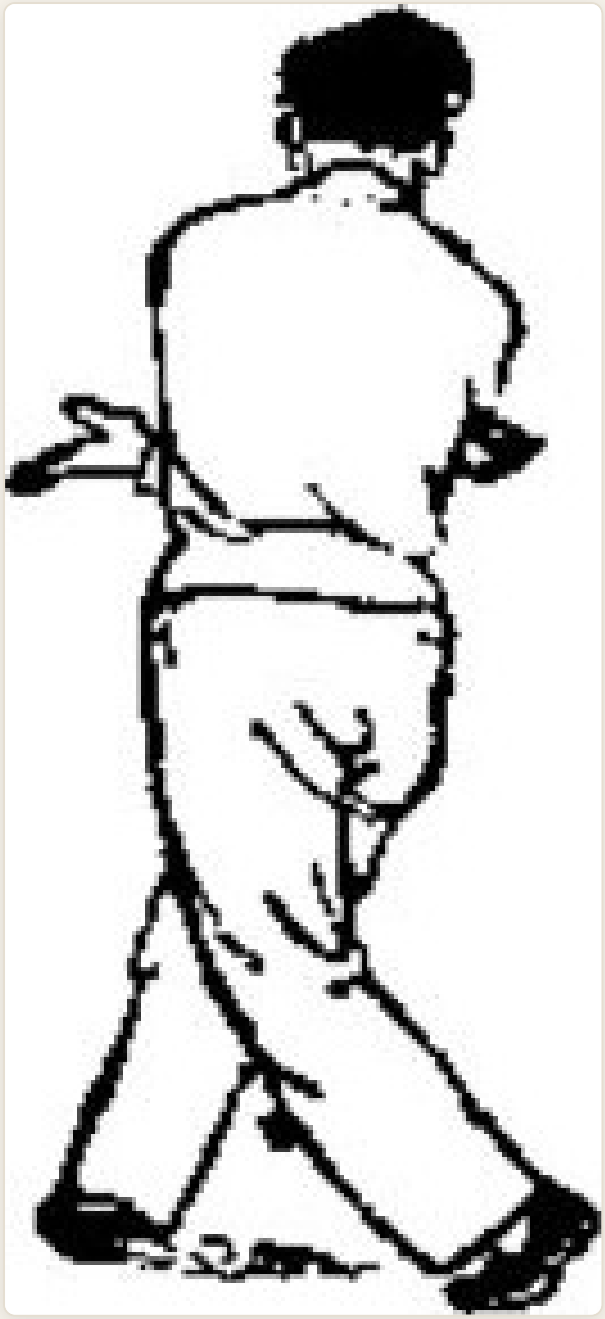
图 L1F134

Action two of Heel Kick: the posture (rear view) in which the left toes tilt up and the left heel kicks out to the left (west), and at the same time the two fists are raised and, passing before the chest, are issued separately to left and right with the fists' centres facing down.

图 L1F134附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 134.

图 L1F135



Action one of Forward Wading Twist Step: the posture in which the left foot is drawn back and lifted and the two hands become palms, the left hand reeling forward and drawing an arc to before the chest and the right hand reeling slightly reverse, both palms facing right.

图 L1F136

Continuing from figure 135: the posture in which the left foot's toes turn out and come down to the left (southwest) and the body turns left, the left hand reeling forward and turning its arm to before the chest with the palm facing right-front and the right palm reeling reverse to above the left forearm with the palm facing left-front, the two arms crossing.

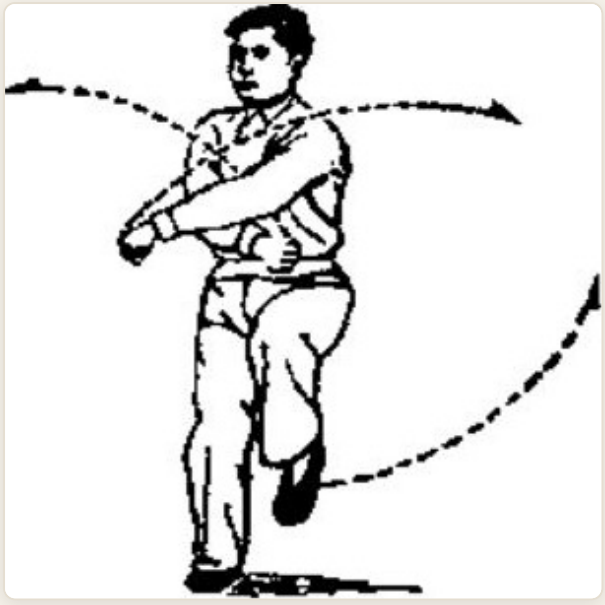
图 L1F137

Action two of Forward Wading Twist Step: the right foot steps out on the slant to the northwest (the same as action two of the tenth form, "Forward Wading Twist Step", only the direction differs).

图 L1F138

Action one of Strike the Ground with the Fist: the posture in which the body turns right with the right toes turned out, the centre of gravity shifting onto the right leg, and the left foot, passing inside the right ankle, steps up on the slant to the left front (southwest) whereupon the centre of gravity shifts left, the left palm reeling forward and moving rightward from the left past before the face and becoming a fist with the fist's centre facing inward, and the right palm changing from forward to reverse reeling, drawing an arc to the right rear and becoming a fist with the fist's centre facing front-up.

图 L1F139



Action two of Strike the Ground with the Fist: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns slightly left, the right fist reeling forward to beside the right ear with the fist's centre facing inward, and the left fist reeling forward, passing downward before the chest and dropping to the left side with the fist's centre facing up.

图 L1F139附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 139.

图 L1F140

The last phase of action two of Strike the Ground with the Fist: the posture (rear view) in which the body continues to squat slightly and the left leg continues to bow forward, the left fist reeling reverse with its elbow bent and raised to the upper left with the fist's centre facing down, and the right fist reeling reverse and striking downward to the front (reeling reverse one small circle from outside to inside) with the fist's centre facing inward.

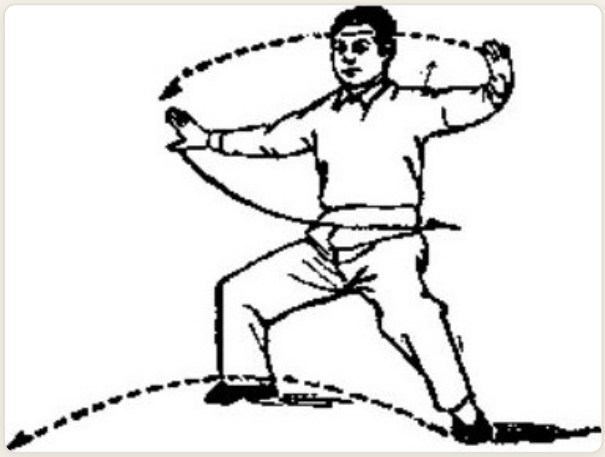
图 L1F140附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 140.

图 L1F141

The first phase of action one of Turn the Body and Kick Twice: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity on the left foot and the right leg slightly extended and not straightened, the left fist bending its arm and shifting slightly downward as the body turns, and the right fist turning its arm, bending its elbow and wrist and being raised, both fists' centres facing inward.

图 L1F141附图



The front view of the same movement as figure 141.

图 L1F142

Continuing from figure 141: the posture (rear view) in which, pivoting on the left heel, the body continues to turn right and the foot is drawn back half a step with the turning body, touching with its toes, the right fist reeling forward and dropping to the right side of the body with the fist's centre facing up, and the left fist reeling reverse, coming from the left to the front, bending its elbow and being raised with the fist's centre facing inward.

图 L1F143

Continuing from figure 142: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg and the left leg squats down (strengthening the elasticity of the left leg), the right fist turning its arm, reeling reverse and being raised in an arc from behind the body, and the left fist reeling reverse and dropping to the left side of the body.

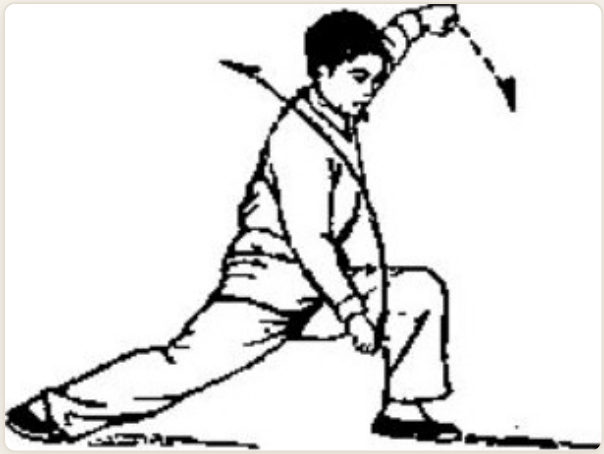
图 L1F144

Action two of Turn the Body and Kick Twice: the posture (rear view) in which the two fists become palms and reel reverse, the right hand drawing an arc forward and up and the left hand back and down, with the right palm's centre facing forward and the left palm's centre facing inward-down.

图 L1F144附图

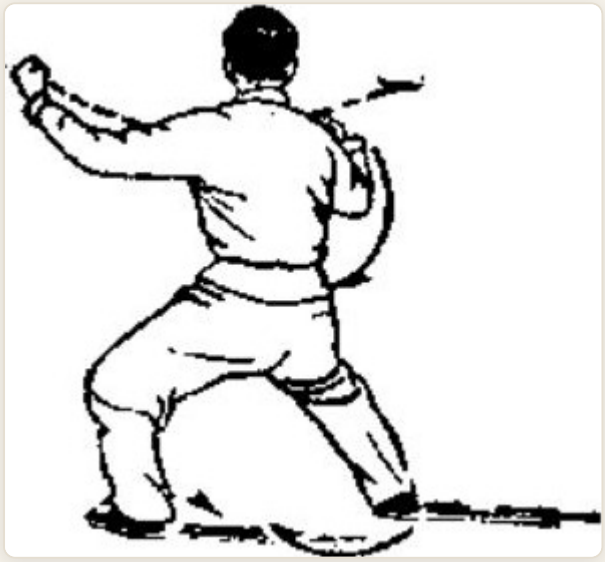
The front view of the same movement as figure 144.

图 L1F145



Continuing from figure 144: the posture in which, before the left foot has landed, the right foot pushes off the ground and leaps up, kicking up forward and upward with its instep stretched flat, the right palm meeting and striking the right instep to the front and the left palm held level to the left.

图 L1F146



Continuing from figure 145: the posture (rear view) in which the right foot kicks up into the air, the right palm strikes the right instep, the left palm is held level to the left, and the left foot then lands.

图 L1F146附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 146.

图 L1F147

Action one of Beast-Head Posture: the posture in which the right foot falls but has not yet touched the ground when the left foot leaps up, and the two hands, from the left, go up and reel forward warding-off to the upper right (the two hands having leading jin that leads the body to rise into the air, like the shooting posture in basketball).

图 L1F148

Continuing from figure 147: the posture in which the right foot then lands and the right leg squats down, and then the left foot steps out sideways to the left rear (northwest) on the slant with the left leg dropping low and the left knee slightly bent, the body turning right at the same time and the two palms dropping to the right front as the body turns with the palms facing down-right.

图 L1F149

Continuing from figure 148: the posture in which the body turns left with the centre of gravity shifting left and the left leg bowing while the right leg is straightened, and the two palms become fists with their arms turning, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, the left fist reeling from before the abdomen to the upper left with its centre facing left and the right fist reeling from the right to before the chest with its centre facing upper-left, forming the Left Tiger-Beating Posture.

图 L1F150

The first phase of action two of Beast-Head Posture: the posture in which the body turns slightly right and the right foot shifts slightly left and touches with its toes, the left fist reeling reverse, bending its arm and being drawn inward to head height, and the right fist reeling forward, bending its arm and being drawn inward to before the chest.

图 L1F151

Continuing from figure 150: the posture in which the body continues to turn slightly right, the left leg squats down, and the right heel, its inner side adhering to the ground, sweeps out to the right front (south, slightly east) into a low stance, the two fists, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, sinking down as the body squats.

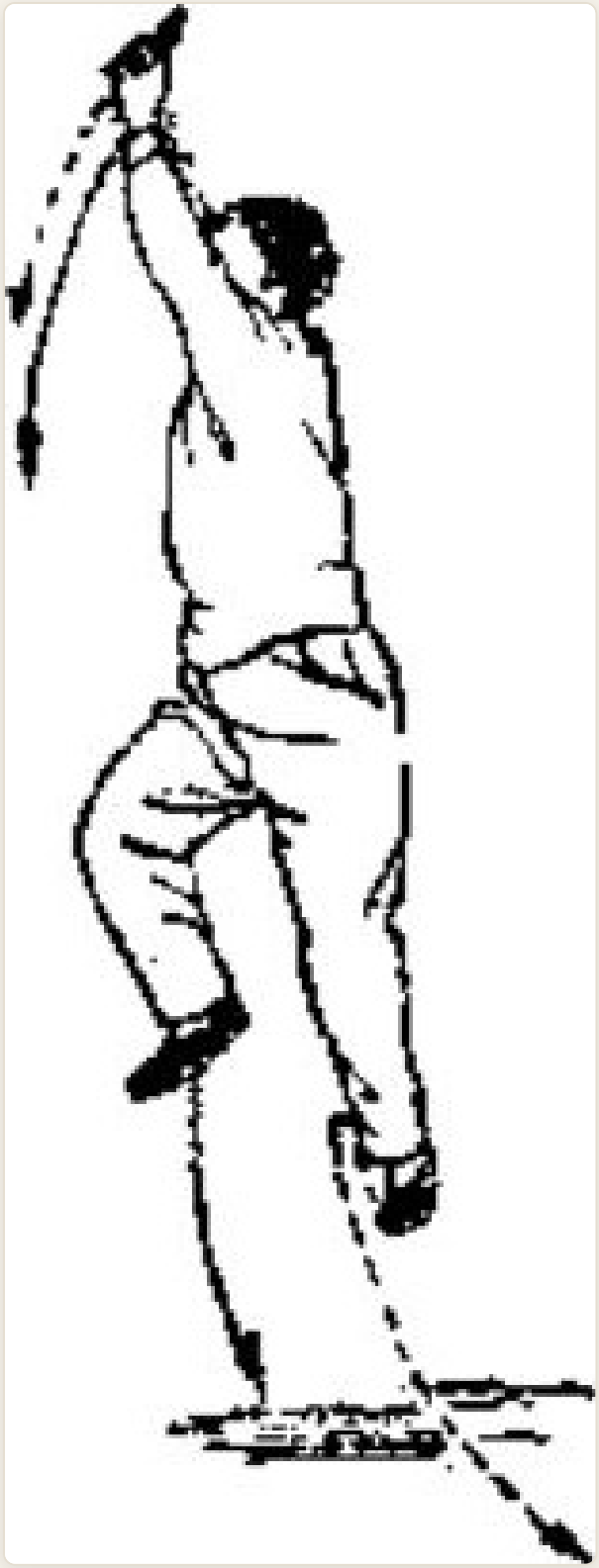
图 L1F152

Continuing from figure 151: the posture in which the body continues to turn slightly right with the centre of gravity shifting right and the right leg bowing, and the two hands turn their arms and reel reverse, the left fist shifting right with the turning body with its centre facing right-rear and the right fist, passing downward before the chest, reeling to the right side of the abdomen with its centre facing inward.

图 L1F153

Continuing from figure 152: the posture in which the body continues to turn slightly right, the left fist, passing before the chest, reeling forward leftward to before the left waist with its centre facing inward, and the right fist, from the right rear, going up, turning its arm, bending its elbow and reeling reverse to beside the right ear with its centre facing down.

图 L1F154



Continuing from figure 153: the posture in which the body turns left with the centre of gravity shifting slightly left and the left knee bending slightly, the left fist being drawn slightly inward to before the abdomen, and the right fist turning its arm and bending its wrist inward and extending forward, both fists' centres facing inward.

图 L1F155

The first phase of action one of Whirlwind Kick: the posture in which the body turns slightly left with the centre of gravity shifting left and the left leg bowing slightly, the left hand reeling forward and turning over downward to before the left abdomen with its centre facing up, and the right hand reeling forward and turning slightly to the right front to before the abdomen with its centre facing inward-up.

图 L1F156

Continuing from figure 155: the posture in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity shifting right and the right leg bowing while the left leg is extended but not straight, and the two fists become palms and reel reverse.

图 L1F157

Continuing from figure 156: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts onto the right leg and the left foot is lifted with its knee bent, the two hands separating up and down before the chest.

图 L1F158

The first phase of action two of Whirlwind Kick: the posture in which the right toes turn out and the right foot steps forward half a step with the body weight shifting forward and the left foot being lifted with it, and as the right foot is lifted and steps up, the two hands reel forward, the right palm pushing forward and the left palm dropping in an arc rightward past before the face, the left forearm coming to rest on the right forearm, the two arms crossing with closing jin, both palms facing down.

图 L1F159

Continuing from figure 158: the posture in which the two arms reel forward and open out to left and right with both palms facing back, and at the same time the left foot, from the lower rear, wraps up in an arc with wrapping jin, meeting and striking with its inner side against the left palm (at this point the chest faces south).

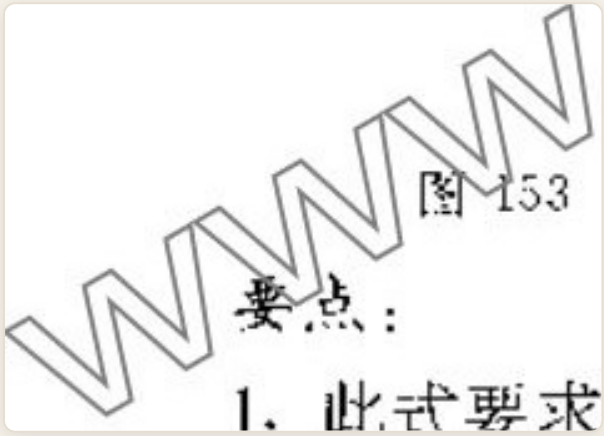
图 L1F160

The last phase of action two of Whirlwind Kick: the posture in which, pivoting on the right heel, the body turns to the right rear (180 degrees, the chest facing north), and as the body turns the two hands change from opening to closing inward and cross before the chest with the left arm on top, while the left foot also sweeps around from above to the right rear with the turning body.

图 L1F161

Continuing from figure 160: the posture (rear view) in which the body continues to turn slightly right and the left foot lands, and the two hands shrink the closing-jin circle with the left palm facing down and the right palm facing inward.

图 L1F161附图



The front view of the same movement as figure 161 (the chest facing north).

· 138 · the sweeping jin is removed, changed into the two movements of kicking the foot and heel-kicking.

Forty-First Form: Heel Kick

Action one: The body turns slightly left, the centre of gravity shifts slightly left; at the same time, the two palms' centres turn over to face forward, and the crossed circle contracts, whereupon the two palms reel reverse and open out to left and right past before the abdomen (the mind dwelling on the two little fingers); the body turns back to square as the two hands separate, and the crotch opening sinks further. (Figure 162) The body turns slightly left, the centre of gravity

shifts left, the right foot is drawn back and touches with its toes beside the left foot; at the same time, the two palms become fists and reel forward, going down from left and right to hold jin together before the abdomen, the two forearms crossing with the left arm on top, both fists' centres facing inward-down. (Figure 163, the front view of attached figure 163) The body continues to turn slightly left (the whole body's ward-off jin not lost), the two arms shrink the crossed circle (to store jin), and the right foot is lifted. (Figure 164, the front view of attached figure 146)

Action two: The two fists reel forward and issue jin to left and right; at the same time the right foot hooks up its toes and kicks out to the right side with the heel, issuing jin. (Figure 165)

Essential points:

1. The difference between this posture and the thirty-fifth form, "Heel Kick", is that the former form kicks the left foot while this one kicks the right foot. In doing this Heel Kick, one must first prepare a full storing of jin before kicking, and then issue, so as to attain the requirement of "storing and then issuing".

图 L1F162

Action one of Heel Kick: the posture in which the body turns slightly left with the centre of gravity shifting slightly left, and the two palms' centres turn over to face forward and the crossed circle contracts, whereupon the two palms reel reverse and open out to left and right past before the abdomen (the mind dwelling on the two little fingers), the body turning back to square as the two hands separate and the crotch opening sinking further.

图 L1F163

Continuing from figure 162: the posture (rear view) in which the body turns slightly left with the centre of gravity shifting left and the right foot drawn back to touch with its toes beside the left foot, and the two palms become fists and reel forward, going down from left and right to hold jin together before the abdomen, the two forearms crossing with the left arm on top and both fists' centres facing inward-down.

图 L1F163附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 163.

Forty-Second Form: Cover-Hand Forearm Punch

Action one: The right foot lifts its knee and is drawn back, the left leg standing alone; at the same time, the right fist reels forward and falls before the crotch, and the left fist reels forward and drops slightly downward. (Figure 166) With the left heel as pivot, the body turns right (east). At the same time, the right arm turns outward and reels forward inward, going up from before the crotch, and following the body's turn rolls down in an arc to the right side beside the right leg, the right arm hanging down with the fist's centre facing up; the left fist turns its arm and reels reverse from inner-low to outer-high, raising the left forearm upright with the fist's centre facing inward. (Figure 167)

图 L1F164

Continuing from figure 163: the earlier part of action two of Heel Kick, the posture (rear view) in which the body continues to turn slightly left, the two arms shrink the crossed circle to store jin, and the right foot is lifted.

图 L1F164附图

The front view of the same movement as figure 164.

图 L1F165

Action two of Heel Kick: the posture in which the two fists reel forward and issue jin to left and right, while the right foot hooks up its toes and kicks out to the right side with the heel, issuing jin.

Action two: The two fists become palms and meet before the chest, both reeling forward and dropping, the right hand slightly lower than the left, the right leg still lifted. (Figure 168) The two palms rise from left and right, leading the body up (like the double leading jin of two hands shooting a basketball), the right toes lifting up. (Figures 169–170; after the body is led up in the two figures, it should still face the same direction as figure 168, and the two · 140 · figures show its front and side) the right foot presses the ground flat with the palm of the foot and extends, the body turns slightly right, the left foot steps forward-left (northeast), both legs bend at the knees and squat; at the same time, the right palm becomes a fist and reels reverse to before the left abdomen, and the left palm reels reverse and draws in to ward-off before the chest, the left palm placed crossed above the right elbow. (Figure 171)

图 L1F166

The earlier part of action one of Cover-Hand Forearm Punch: the posture in which the right foot lifts its knee and is drawn back with the left leg standing alone, the right fist reeling forward and falling before the crotch and the left fist reeling forward and dropping slightly downward.

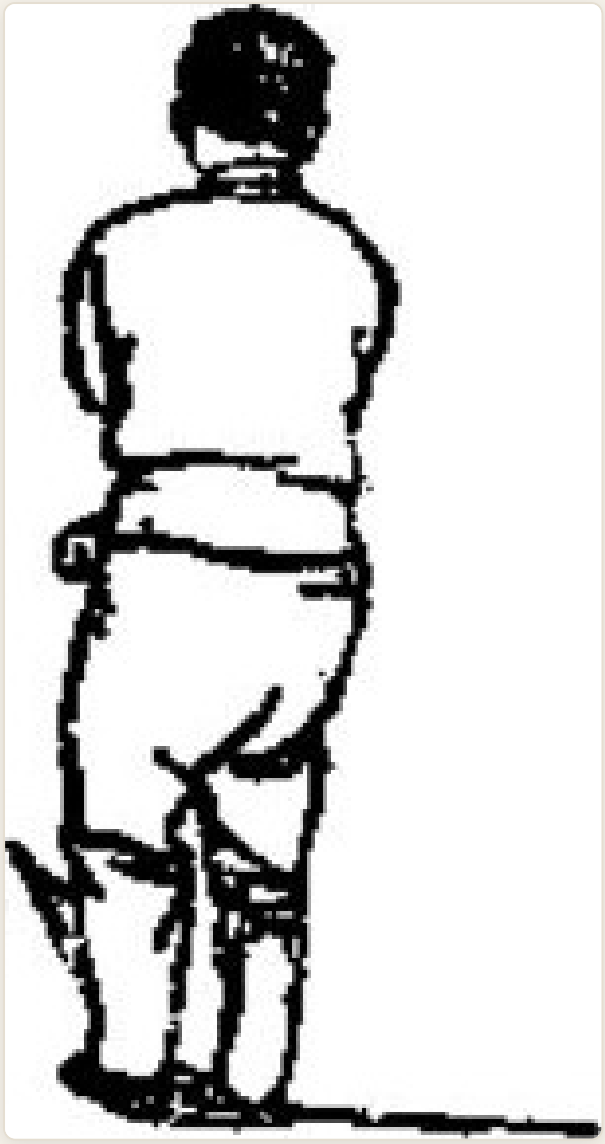
图 L1F167

Continuing from figure 166: the posture in which, with the left heel as pivot, the body turns right (east), the right arm turning outward and reeling forward inward, going up from before the crotch and following the body's turn rolling down in an arc to the right side beside the right leg with the right arm hanging down and the fist's centre facing up, while the left fist turns its arm and reels reverse from inner-low to outer-high, raising the left forearm upright with the fist's centre facing inward.

图 L1F168

Action two of Cover-Hand Forearm Punch: the posture in which the two fists become palms and meet before the chest, both reeling forward and dropping, the right hand slightly lower than the left and the right leg still lifted.

图 L1F169



Continuing from figure 168: the posture (front view) in which the two palms rise from left and right, leading the body up, with the right toes lifting up.

图 L1F170

The side view of the same movement (the body led up) as figure 169.

图 L1F171

Continuing from above: the posture in which the right foot presses the ground flat with the palm of the foot and extends, the body turns slightly right, the left foot steps forward-left (northeast) with both legs bending at the knees and squatting, while the right palm becomes a fist and reels reverse to before the left abdomen and the left palm reels reverse and draws in to ward-off before the chest, the left palm placed crossed above the right elbow.

图 L1F172

Action one of Small Catch and Strike: the posture in which the body turns right, the right fist becomes a palm with a large reverse reeling and a bent elbow with the palm's centre facing down and the tiger's mouth open, the left palm goes from the left flank with a small reverse reeling to below the chest, the right foot's toes turn outward and step forward, and the right palm reels forward and turns over so its centre faces up while the left palm reels forward and lays across the right forearm.

图 L1F172附图

The other side view of the same movement as figure 172.

图 L1F173

Continuing from figure 172: the posture in which the left foot takes a big step forward with its toes turning slightly inward in a low stance, and the two palms reel reverse and turn over, the right palm downward and the left palm forward-down separating.

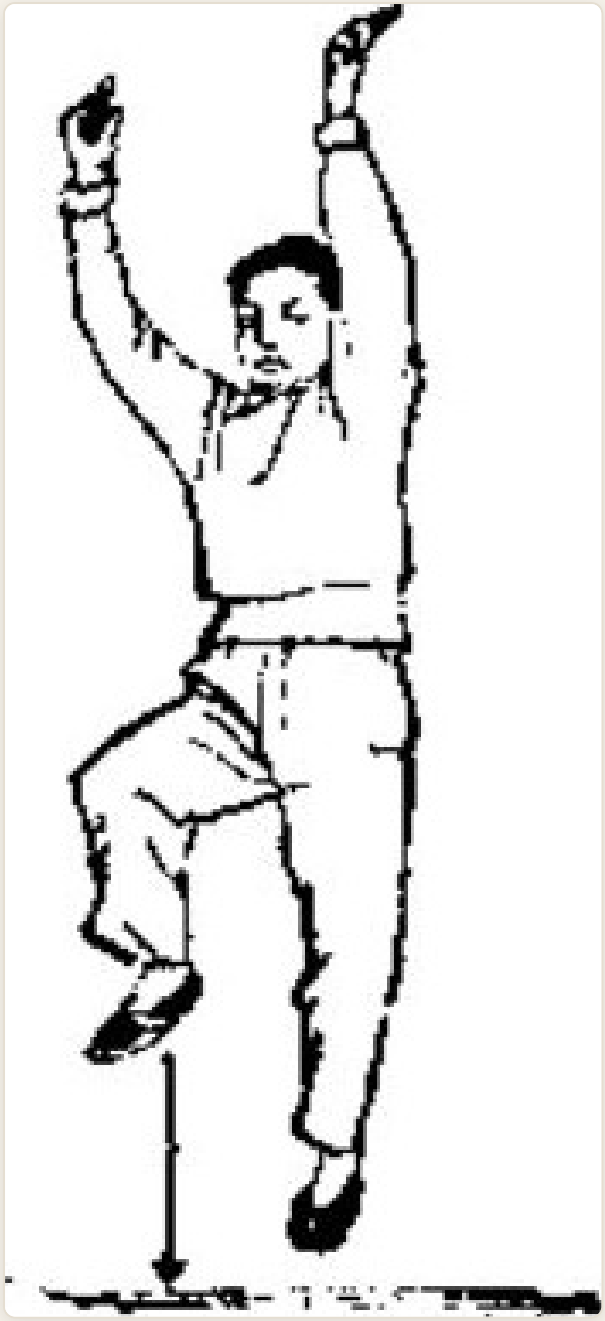
图 L1F173附图

The other side view of the same movement as figure 173.

图 L1F174

Continuing from figure 173: the set posture in which the two palms chop out suddenly with the heels of the palms (the right palm chopping downward and the left palm chopping forward-down).

图 L1F175



Action two of Small Catch and Strike: the posture in which the body turns slightly right, the right palm reels forward and falls from the upper right beside the right ribs with its centre facing the ribs, and the left palm reels forward, turning up from below with the forearm raised upright and the palm's centre facing forward-up.

图 L1F176

The last section of Small Catch and Strike: the set posture in which the centre of gravity shifts left with the left leg in a bow stance and the body turning slightly left, the left palm reeling reverse and turning its arm to drop slightly while the right palm reels forward from above to the left, the two palms crossing and closing inward to issue jin to the left (east).

图 L1F177

The earlier part of action one of Embrace the Head and Push the Mountain: the posture in which the body turns slightly right, the two palms become fists, the right fist turns its arm and reels reverse to extend forward-down with its centre facing down, and the left fist reels reverse and is drawn back from the lower left, drawing a small circle and closing to lay on the right arm with its centre facing down, the centre of gravity still on the left with the left leg in a bow stance.

图 L1F178

Continuing from figure 177: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg, the body turns to the right rear with the left heel as pivot, and the right foot draws in half a step touching the ground with its toes, while the two fists with a small forward reeling hold jin together before the chest, both centres facing inward-up.

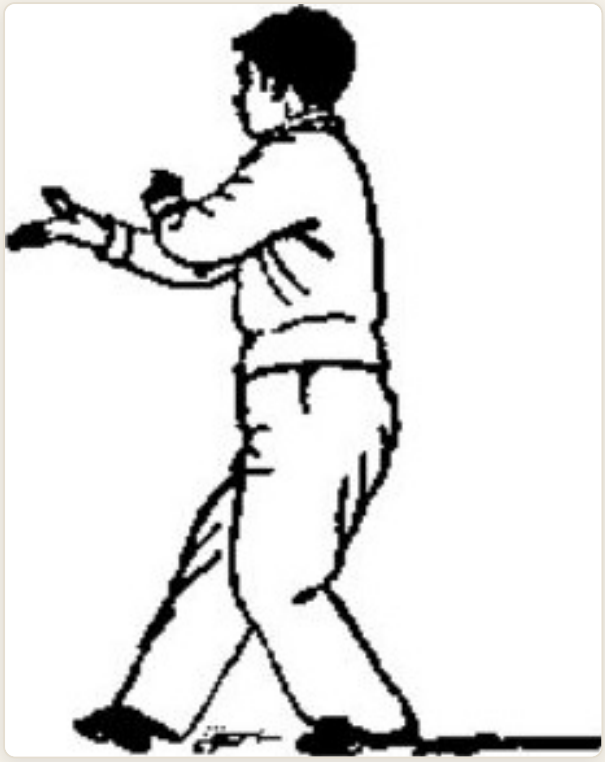
图 L1F179

Continuing from figure 178: the posture in which the two fists become palms and with a double forward reeling tighten the crossed circle and then drop, then turn their arms into double reverse reeling and separate to left and right, and as they are about to reach the end point turn into double forward reeling to release jin with the backs of the hands, the two palms' centres facing each other.

图 L1F180

Action two of Embrace the Head and Push the Mountain: the posture in which the body turns left, the two palms shift slightly left with the body's turn and the two elbows sink, the two palms being drawn back to beside the two ears — the right reeling forward and the left reeling reverse — with their centres facing the two cheeks, and the centre of gravity shifts slightly further left with the right toes still touching the ground.

图 L1F181



Continuing from figure 180: the posture in which the right foot steps forward half a step and, as the centre of gravity moves forward, the right leg bends at the knee and becomes solid and the body turns right, the two palms dropping slightly to the right from beside the two cheeks and, with the body's turn, reeling forward and pushing out, the mind dwelling on the two little fingers with the palms' centres facing outward.

图 L1F182

Action one of Three Palm Changes: the posture in which the body turns right, the left hand reels forward and turns over, extending slightly forward so its centre faces up, and the right hand reels forward, bending its elbow and drawing in to the upper side of the left arm, with the left knee reeling inward and the right knee reeling outward.

图 L1F183

Continuing from figure 182: the posture in which the body turns slightly left, the right palm reels forward and turns, turning its wrist and reeling reverse to push out with the palm held sideways, and the left palm reels forward, bending its elbow and drawing in to before the chest with its centre facing upper-right, with the right knee reeling outward and the left knee reeling inward (completing the first palm change).

图 L1F184

Continuing from figure 183: the posture in which the body turns slightly left and the right knee bows further forward, the right palm going up past before the chest and reeling forward and turning into reverse reeling to push out with the palm held sideways, the left palm turning its arm and reeling forward and dropping with its centre slanting inward-right, with the right knee reeling outward and the left knee reeling inward.

图 L1F185

Continuing from figure 184: the set posture with the right knee bowed forward, after completing the third palm change.

图 L1F186

Action one of Front Move: the posture in which the body turns slightly left with the centre of gravity shifting slightly further left, and the right hook hand becomes a palm, bending its elbow and turning its arm, raising the forearm upright and reeling forward to before the face with its centre facing upper-left, while the left hand reels reverse and presses to the lower left with its centre facing down.

图 L1F187

Action two of Front Move: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts right, the body turns right with the right heel as pivot and the right toes turn outward, the left foot is lifted and drawn close beside the right foot touching with its toes beside it, while the right hand turns its arm and reels reverse, spreading outward in an arc to the right with the palm held sideways and its centre facing outward, and the left palm turns its arm and drops, moving right in an arc with the body's turn with its centre facing right.

Essential points:

The movements of this form are like dancing while holding a long spear, the two arms forming a closing jin. First the left palm, like holding the spear shaft, leads up to the upper left, and the right palm, at the right and to the upper left, holds across like holding the spear pole, carrying the right leg up; at this moment the skin on the left side of the waist is tight and the right side is relaxed — this is a special movement that uses the waist to give a feeling of comfort.

Forty-Ninth Form: Rear Move

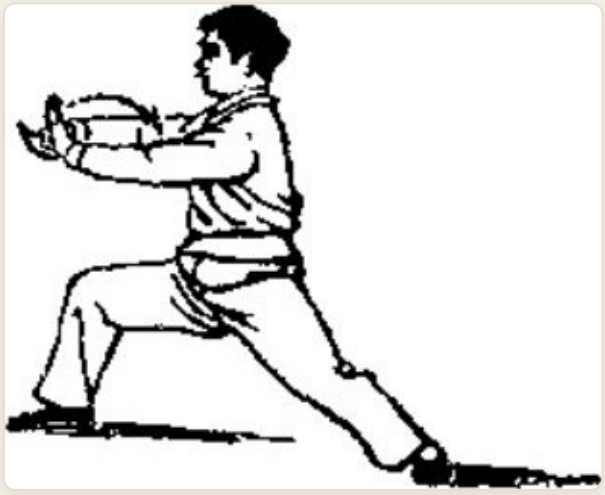
Action one: The left foot steps out sideways to the left, the centre of gravity immediately shifting left with the left leg in a bow stance. At the same time, the left hand turns its arm and reels reverse, turning over to the upper left with its centre facing outward; the right palm turns its arm and reels forward, dropping from the right with its centre facing lower-left. (Figure 188)

Action two: The body turns left, the centre of gravity continuing to shift left, and the right foot is drawn close beside the left foot, touching with its toes before the left foot;

图 L1F188

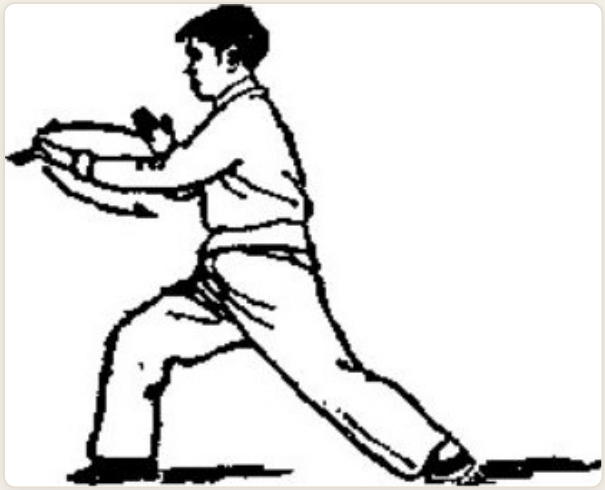
Action one of Rear Move: the posture in which the left foot steps out sideways to the left with the centre of gravity immediately shifting left into a left bow stance, the left hand turning its arm and reeling reverse and turning over to the upper left with its centre facing outward, and the right palm turning its arm and reeling forward and dropping from the right with its centre facing lower-left.

图 L1F189



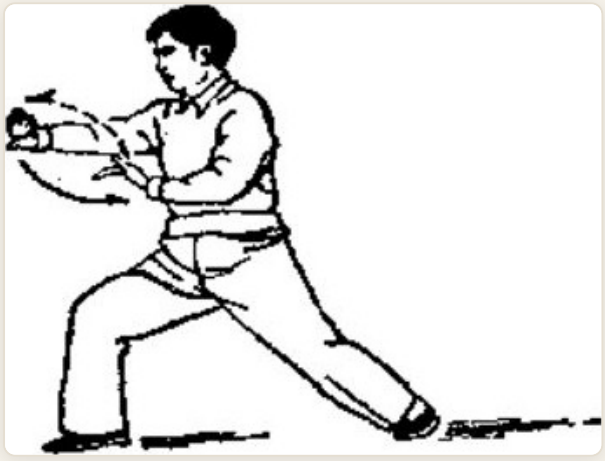
Continuing from figure 188: the posture in which the left hand reels reverse one circle.

图 L1F190



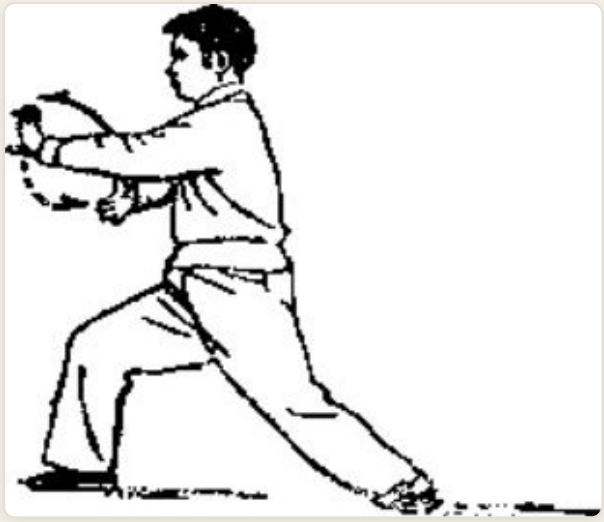
Continuing from figure 189: the posture in which the body turns slightly right, the right palm turns its arm and reels reverse and turns over in an arc with its centre facing outward, and the left palm turns its arm and reels forward and moves right in an arc from above downward, the two hands holding jin together above and below on the right side.

图 L1F191



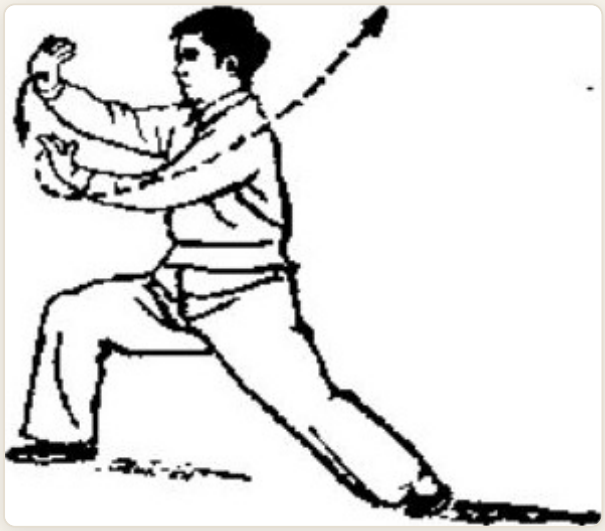
The earlier part of action one of Wild Horse Parts Its Mane: the posture in which the left hand turns its arm and reels reverse, going up past before the chest and turning over to the upper left with its centre facing left, and the right hand turns its arm and reels forward, going down from the right and bending its elbow to lift up to the right with its centre slanting inward-up, the two hands holding jin together above and below on the left side with the centre of gravity still on the left foot, the body squatting slightly and the right foot moving slightly forward with its toes lifted off the ground. (Figures 191 and 192 are printed side by side on one row.)

图 L1F192



Continuing from figure 191: the posture in which the left foot reels reverse and opens out to the left rear with its centre facing outward, the right foot steps forward and, as the centre of gravity moves forward, the right leg forms a bow stance and becomes solid, while the right hand reels forward and lifts forward following the forward movement of the centre of gravity and the left hand reels reverse and props outward to the rear at shoulder height with its centre slanting rear-down.

图 L1F193



Continuing from figure 192: the posture in which the body turns left, the right palm bends its elbow and turns its arm and reels forward to before the face, and the left palm turns its arm, bending its elbow slightly and reeling reverse to press to the lower left, with the centre of gravity still on the right leg.

· 151 · stepping forward; as the centre of gravity moves forward the left leg forms a bow stance and becomes solid. At the same time, the left hand reels forward and lifts forward following the forward movement of the centre of gravity; the right hand reels reverse and props outward to the rear at shoulder height with its centre slanting rear-down, completing the second Wild Horse Parts Its Mane. (Figure 197)

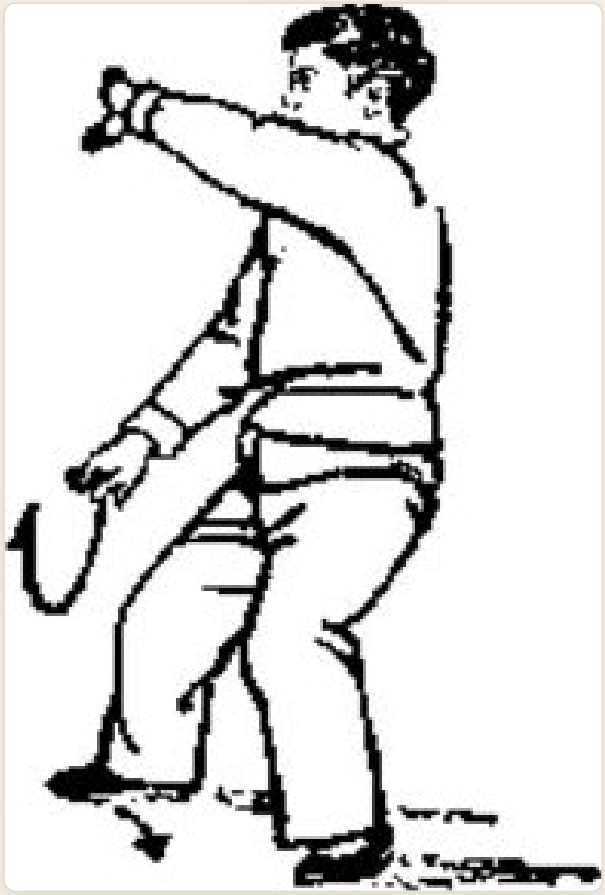
图 L1F194

The earlier part of action two of Wild Horse Parts Its Mane: the posture in which, with the right heel as pivot, the toes turn outward and the body turns right, the right palm turning its arm and reeling forward and turning up to the upper right and spreading outward with its centre facing forward-down, and the left palm drawing an arc forward with the body's turn.

图 L1F195

Continuing from figure 194: the posture in which the body continues to turn right and the right toes continue to turn outward with the whole centre of gravity shifting onto the right leg and the left foot lifted forward, while the right palm following the body's turn reels reverse and spreads sideways in an arc to the right rear (east) and the left palm drops slightly, turning its arm and bending its elbow to lift forward-up, as the left foot steps forward.

图 L1F196



Continuing from figure 195: the posture in which the left foot steps forward and, as the centre of gravity moves forward, the left leg forms a bow stance and becomes solid, while the left hand reels forward and lifts forward following the forward movement of the centre of gravity and the right hand reels reverse and props outward to the rear at shoulder height with its centre slanting rear-down, completing the second Wild Horse Parts Its Mane.

图 L1F197

Action three of Wild Horse Parts Its Mane: the posture in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity shifting slightly left and the left leg bowing further forward, the left palm following the body's turn reeling reverse and turning over to press out to the left front, and the right palm reeling reverse and drawing in from the right in an arc to before the chest.

图 L1F198

Action three of Wild Horse Parts Its Mane: the posture in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity shifting slightly left and the left leg bowing further forward, the left palm following the body's turn reeling reverse and turning over to press out to the left front, and the right palm reeling reverse and drawing in from the right in an arc to before the chest.

图 L1F199

Continuing from figure 198: the posture in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity shifting right into a right bow stance, the left palm turning its arm and reeling forward and pressing right past before the chest, and the right palm turning its arm and reeling reverse and spreading out to the right with its centre facing right.

图 L1F200

Continuing from figure 199: the posture in which the body turns slightly left with the centre of gravity shifting left into a left bow stance, the right palm reeling forward and falling to before the right abdomen with its centre facing left-front, and the left palm going down past before the chest, reeling reverse, bending its elbow and lifting to the left up to shoulder height with its centre facing left.

图 L1F201

Continuing from figure 200: the posture in which the body turns slightly right with the centre of gravity shifting right into a right bow stance, the left palm reeling forward and reeling down from the left to before the abdomen, and the right palm reeling reverse to the right up to abdomen height with the back of its centre slanting to the lower right-rear.

图 L1F202

Continuing from figure 201: the posture in which the body turns left with the left toes turning outward and the centre of gravity shifting left into a left bow stance, the left palm reeling forward, bending its elbow and wrist and turning out to the left in an arc past before the chest with its centre turning to face inward-up, and the right palm from the right past before the face reeling reverse and extending to the left with its centre edge facing forward-down.

Essential points:

1. Wild Horse Parts Its Mane is a great spreading body method that makes the qi reach the four tips, like a wild horse galloping without restraint. The sole requirement of this form is that the skin and muscle on both sides of the chain of vertebrae from below the chin down to the spine must have the meaning of a double opening-and-separating jin, as a horse parts its mane; for in this part of the body "lengthening is easy but separating is hard", and the movement is so slight that it is difficult to separate it, so one must practise repeatedly to left and right.

2. This form most easily shows the great forward and reverse reeling-silk jin. Under the requirement of standing upright, centred, at ease, and supporting the eight directions, all its movements must relatively show the Taiji six reeling-silk jins; the two hands turn with this one up and that one down, this one down and that one up, this one inside and that one outside, this one outside and that one inside, this one forward-reeling and that one reverse-reeling, this one reverse-reeling and that one forward-reeling, opening containing closing and closing containing opening. Hence it can well serve as one example representing the Taiji six reeling-silk jins.

3. Taiji demands that all movements be governed by the waist and spine, so that the qi adheres to the back of the spine is the core of the movement. But the back of the spine (such as the seven vertebrae of the neck region) is the hardest part to separate and knead; therefore this fist form was included in the set precisely to meet this requirement.

Fifty-First Form: Six Seals and Four Closings

The movement is the same as action two of the twenty-ninth form, "Six Seals and Four Closings". (Figure 203, continuing from figures 19–20)

Essential points:

See the essential points of the fourth form, "Six Seals and Four Closings".

Fifty-Second Form: Single Whip

The movements and essential points are both the same as the fifth form, "Single Whip". (Figures 21–26)

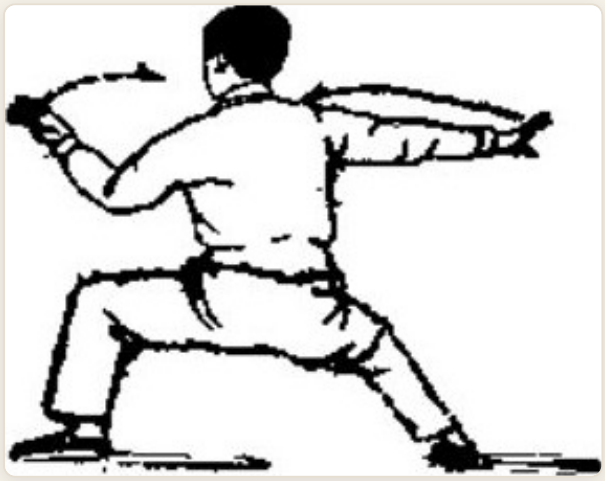
图 L1F203

Action two of Six Seals and Four Closings: the action-two posture as shown in the twenty-ninth form, "Six Seals and Four Closings" (see figures 19–20).

图 L1F204

The earlier part of action one of Double Swinging Foot: the posture in which the body turns left with the centre of gravity shifting left into a left bow stance while the right leg extends slightly without straightening, the right hook hand becoming a palm and reeling forward, reeling from the right down past before the abdomen to the left to before the left flank (the inner jin not lost and not flattened) with its centre facing left, and the left hand reeling forward and extending to the left with its centre facing down.

图 L1F205



Continuing from figure 204: the posture in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity shifting right into a right bow stance while the left leg extends without straightening, the right palm turning its arm and reeling reverse, going up from before the left flank past before the face and spreading out to the right with its centre facing forward, and the left palm turning its arm and reeling reverse, bending its elbow and lifting slightly with the body's turn with its centre facing up.

图 L1F206

The earlier part of action two of Double Swinging Foot: the posture in which the body continues to turn right with the left toes turning inward and the centre of gravity shifting back onto the left leg and the right foot drawing in slightly touching the ground with its toes, the left palm going from the left past before the face and reeling reverse and dropping to the upper side of the right elbow, and the right palm turning its arm and reeling forward, going down from the right and sweeping forward-up to before the chest.

图 L1F207

Continuing from figure 206: the first of the postures in which the two hands reel reverse before the chest, leading the whole body up with reeling-silk jin and lifting the right leg, as the left foot pushes off the ground and leaps up.

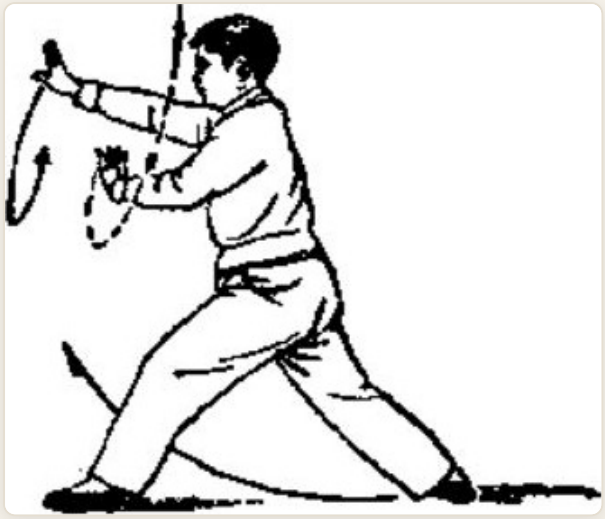
图 L1F208

Continuing from figure 206: the second posture, in which the body leaps up into the air with the right leg lifted.

图 L1F209

The last section of action two of Double Swinging Foot: the posture in which the two feet land left first and right after (also called Double Landing Foot), stamping the ground and shaking the foot with the left heavy and the right light, the two palms pressing down as the foot stamps with their centres turning to face down.

图 L1F210



The earlier part of action one of Jade Girl Works the Shuttles: the posture of the process in which the right foot leaps forward half a step, the right palm pushes forward level and issues jin and leads the left foot to leap forward a big step, the body turning right accordingly with both feet leaving the ground.

图 L1F210附图

The simplified practice of the same movement as figure 210 (omitting the airborne process for the old and weak).

图 L1F211

Continuing from figure 210: the posture in which the body in the air continues to turn to the right rear through 270 degrees, the left foot lands and then the right foot also lands in a crosswise step to the right with the body's turn, and the two hands — the right reeling forward and the left reeling reverse — the right hand to the upper right and the left hand to the lower left open out apart, forming opening jin.

图 L1F212

Action two of Jade Girl Works the Shuttles: the posture in which the body turns square to the left (facing south) with the left knee bending slightly, the two palms closing with forward reeling and separating with reverse reeling, the right up and the left down.

图 L1F213

The earlier part of action one of Swinging Foot and Falling into a Split: the posture in which the body turns right with the centre of gravity shifting left and the left knee bowing out, and the two palms joined to each other reeling the right reverse and the left forward and shifting level to the right side of the body at shoulder height with both centres facing right.

图 L1F214

Continuing from figure 213: the posture in which the whole centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg, the body rises and the right foot is lifted, going up from the left past before the chest and swinging across to the right, while the two palms — the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward — go from the right shoulder side to the left, the left palm first and the right palm after, moving across to meet and slap the outer side of the right foot's instep with two successive sounds, both palms' centres facing left.

图 L1F215

The earlier part of action two of Swinging Foot and Falling into a Split: the posture in which the two palms become fists after slapping the foot, the left hand reeling reverse inward, going down from the left and drawing an arc to the right past before the chest while the right hand reels forward outward and falls before the abdomen, the two arms holding jin together and crossing before the chest with the left fist stacked on the right arm; and after the right foot has swung across and fallen from the right beside the left foot, stamping the ground and shaking the foot with the whole body's qi sinking down and the left heel lifting slightly.

图 L1F216

The later part of action two of Swinging Foot and Falling into a Split: the posture in which the right leg bends at the knee and squats while the left toes point up and the foot thrusts out to the left with its heel against the ground, the right knee turning inward with the hips loosened and the crotch closed and sinking so that the buttocks, the inner side of the right knee and the rear side of the left leg all touch the ground, and the right fist goes up past before the face and is raised to the right in an arc with its centre slanting to the upper right while the left fist goes down along the inner side of the right arm and extends forward as the left foot thrusts out with its centre facing up.

图 L1F217

The last section of action two of Swinging Foot and Falling into a Split: the posture in which the body rises forward, pushing off the right leg and bowing the left leg to form a left bow stance, with the left fist thrusting up forward with its face and its centre facing inward and the right fist turning its arm and reeling forward and falling beside the right hip.

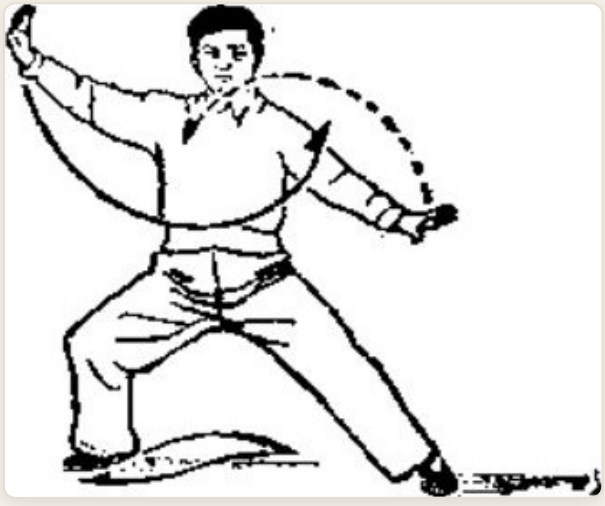
图 L1F218

Action one of Left and Right Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg: the posture in which the whole centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg, the body turns slightly left with the left leg standing up and its knee bending slightly, the right leg is lifted with the right instep drawn flat, and the two fists reel forward — the left fist going down from the left front and the right fist going up forward from the right rear — crossing past each other before the chest; as the right leg is about to lift the two fists become palms with the right hand reeling forward and lifting up from before the right chest while the left hand reels reverse and presses down; and as the right leg lifts the right palm reels reverse and opens out to the upper right and the left palm to the lower left, forming the left-style Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg.

图 L1F219

Action two of Left and Right Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg: the posture in which the left leg bends slightly to store jin and then springs up with both feet leaving the ground, immediately landing left first and right after and stamping the ground and shaking the foot (the left heavy and the right light; this is the Double Landing Foot) with the two knees bending slightly, and the right palm, as the right foot lands, pressing down at the same time to before the right hip while the left palm also presses down to before the left hip.

图 L1F220



Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg: the posture in which the body turns slightly right and then turns left, the right foot steps sideways to the right (south) in a big step with the left leg bending at the knee and squatting, and the two palms, as the right foot steps out and the body turns left, pass before the chest to the left with the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward in a great reeling up to shoulder height, both centres facing left.

图 L1F221

Continuing from figure 220: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts right and the left foot is drawn close to the right, touching the ground with its toes beside the right foot so that the right leg is substantial and the left leg insubstantial, while the two palms reel forward and fall respectively beside the two hips.

图 L1F222

Continuing from figure 221: the posture in which the left foot is set down solidly and the centre of gravity shifts left with the left leg becoming substantial, then the centre of gravity is shifted back onto the right leg which again becomes substantial with the left heel still lifted off the ground, while the left palm turns its arm and reels forward, bending its elbow and lifting up, and the right palm reels reverse and presses down in coordination on the right side.

图 L1F223

Continuing from figure 222: the posture in which the left leg is lifted and, as the left palm goes to the upper left and the right palm to the lower right, both reeling reverse and opening out, one forms the right-style Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg.

图 L1F224

Action one of Step Back and Roll the Arm: the posture in which the right leg bends at the knee and squats, the left palm reels reverse down past before the face, and the right palm, from the right upward, turns from forward reeling into reverse reeling and reels in an arc to beside the right cheek with its centre slanting to the left front.

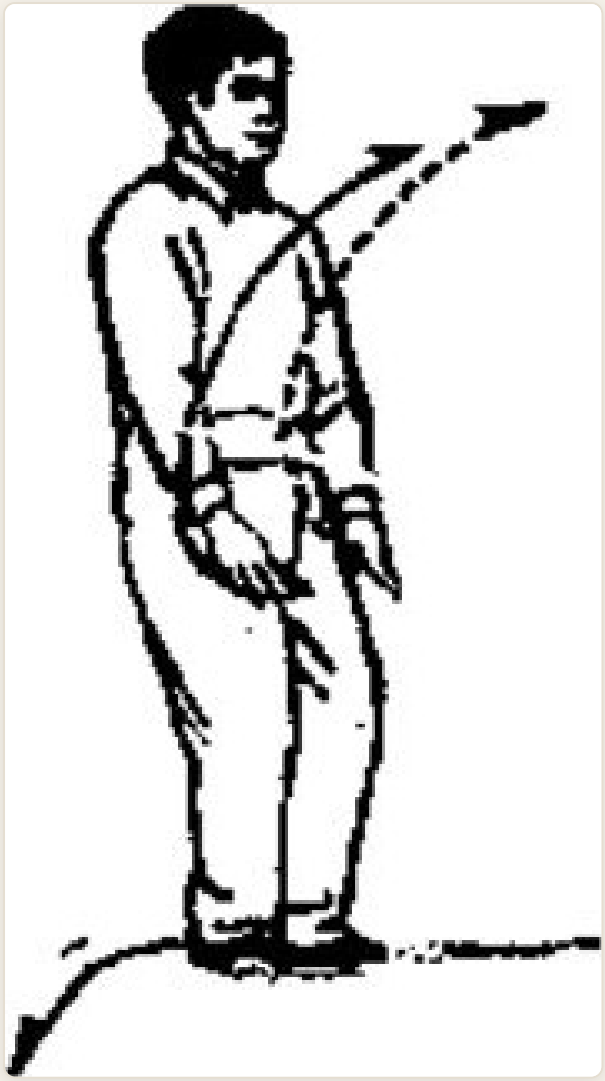
图 L1F225

The earlier part of action one of Cross-Shaped Swinging Lotus: the posture in which, following the opening of High Pat on Horse, the left foot is lifted back and touches the ground with its toes beside the right foot with the right leg still substantial and the left leg insubstantial, and the two palms turn their arms with the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward, the left palm going from the left up to the right and the right palm from the right down to the left, drawing arcs, the two hands crossing at the wrists before the chest.

图 L1F226

Continuing from figure 225: the posture in which, with the right heel as pivot, the body turns right with the left toes still touching the ground, and the two hands reel reverse, shrinking the crossed circle with the left hand inside, the two hands holding jin together.

图 L1F227



Continuing from figure 226: the posture in which the body continues to turn right, the right leg bends at the knee and squats, the left foot is lifted and steps sideways to the left (northeast) in a big step with the centre of gravity shifting left into a left bow stance, and the two hands reel reverse, the right palm spreading to the upper right and the left palm to the lower left, both centres facing outward.

图 L1F228

The earlier part of action two of Cross-Shaped Swinging Lotus: the posture in which the right palm turns its arm and reels forward, going down from the right and reeling left past before the abdomen to under the left armpit with its centre facing rear-down, and the left palm turns its arm and reels forward, bending its elbow so that the forearm is raised upright with its centre facing upper-right.

图 L1F229

Continuing from figure 228: the posture in which the body turns slightly right, the left palm reels forward, going past before the neck to the right and closing onto the upper side of the right arm with its centre facing down, and the right hand under the left armpit reels forward so that its centre turns to face down, with the centre of gravity shifting further left at the same time.

图 L1F230

The earlier part of action three of Cross-Shaped Swinging Lotus: the posture in which the right foot is lifted and swings outward to the right in a half circle, going up from the left front, while the left palm reels reverse and moves to the left to meet and slap the outer side of the right foot's instep.

图 L1F231

Continuing from figure 230: the posture in which, with the left heel as pivot, the body continues to turn right and the right leg is lifted with the knee bent.

· 166 · the body turns right (west); at the same time the two palms become fists, the left reeling reverse and the right reeling forward; the right fist passes before the chest and goes right and

down, while the left fist turns its arm, bends its elbow and, together with the other, issues energy from the left upward; the right fist is at hip height with its centre facing up, and the left fist is slightly higher than the head, with its centre facing right. (Figure 231)

Key points:

1. This posture passes from a tight closing to a great opening; at this time the momentum is required to sink. While turning left the two hips must be linked together — this is opening hidden within closing; afterwards it opens again — this is closing hidden within opening.

2. Because the left palm slaps crosswise against the outer side of the right foot's face, it is called Crosswise Lotus Swing . After the slap, the left fist lifts up and the right fist turns down, both issuing energy at the same time; the coordination of this energy-issue is what brings stability after the turn of the body.

3. In performing Crosswise Lotus Swing one often feels comfortable and the back becomes warm — this is the phenomenon of causing the chi to pervade the whole body.

Posture 73　Point-at-the-Crotch Punch

图 L1F232甲

Point-at-the-Crotch Punch action one: the posture in which the left foot springs up slightly to the left and the right foot falls to where the left foot had been, stamping the ground with a shock; the body turns right, the left foot steps diagonally forward-left (southwest) and the centre of gravity gradually shifts left; as the right foot falls and stamps, the left hand turns its arm and reels forward to the right of the chest and the right fist reels forward from the right upward and falls to the left, resting on the left forearm (front view).

图 L1F232乙

Continuing from figure 232甲: another view of the same action, the right fist reeling forward and falling onto the left forearm as the centre of gravity gradually shifts left.

图 L1F233

First part of Point-at-the-Crotch Punch action two: the posture in which the body turns slightly right, the left fist turns its arm and reels forward falling before the chest, and the right fist turns its arm and reels reverse from the right upward, passing beside the right ear and falling before the chest onto the inner side of the left arm, the two hands joining strength (the figure is a side view; the two feet still remain on their original spots, unmoved).

图 L1F234

Continuing from figure 233: the posture in which the body turns left, the centre of gravity shifts left and the left leg is bent in a bow, the left fist turns its arm and reels forward, drawing back to circle at the left ribs with its centre facing inward, and the right fist turns its arm and reels reverse, striking out toward the lower front-left and issuing energy.

图 L1F234附图

The side view of figure 234, showing the side posture in which the right fist reels reverse and strikes out toward the lower front-left while the left fist is drawn back to the left ribs.

图 L1F235

First part of White Ape Offers Fruit action one: the posture in which the body turns slightly left, the right fist reels reverse and is drawn in to the left, gathering at the left side of the waist, while the left fist reels reverse before the left ribs, cooperating to circle a small round, the two hands joining strength and not collapsing.

图 L1F235附图

The side view of figure 235: a side view of the same posture, with the right fist gathered at the left side of the waist and the left fist circling before the left ribs.

图 L1F236

Continuing from figure 235: the posture in which the body turns right, the centre of gravity shifts right and then still shifts back to the left; the two hands reel reverse and move from the left forward to before the chest at chest height, and as the centre of gravity shifts back onto the left leg the two fists turn over inward and outward, joining strength.

图 L1F236附图

The side view of figure 236: showing the side posture in which the two hands reel reverse and move to before the chest while the centre of gravity returns to the left leg and the two fists turn over, joining strength.

图 L1F237

White Ape Offers Fruit action two: the posture in which, with the left heel as the pivot, the body turns left, the right leg is lifted with the top of the right foot stretched flat and the toes pointing down; the right fist turns its arm and reels forward, and as the right leg is lifted it spirals and thrusts upward from the right and below to eye height with its centre facing inward, while the left palm turns its arm and reels reverse one circle, gathering and placing at the left side of the waist.

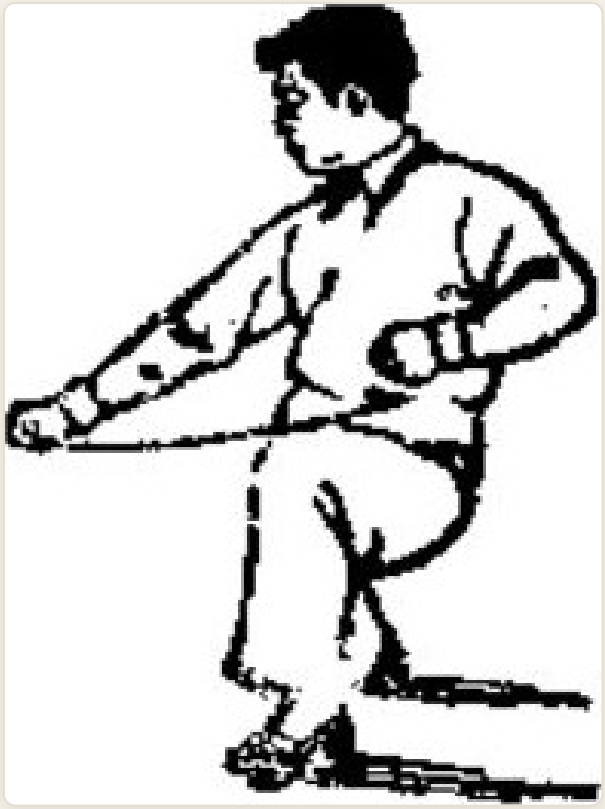
图 L1F238

Sparrow Dragon action one: the posture in which the body turns left and the left leg forms a forward bow, while both hands change into fists and reel reverse, the right fist going from the right downward, passing before the belly and sweeping up to the left with the fist's centre facing up, and the left fist closing to the right onto the upper side of the right arm with the fist's centre facing inward, the two hands joining their strength.

图 L1F239

Continuing from figure 238: the posture in which the centre of gravity turns right and the body turns slightly right with the right leg bending at the knee and squatting down, while the two hands reel forward on the right and reverse on the left, the left fist going from the inner side of the right arm to the left and downward and the right fist going from the outer side of the left forearm to the right and upward, each opening out separately, with the left fist extending to above the left knee, the left fist's centre facing upper right and the right fist's centre facing upper right.

图 L1F240



Sparrow Dragon action two: the posture in which the body turns slightly left, the left leg sinks down into a crouching leg and the right leg continues to squat down, with the left fist extending forward to above the left ankle, the fist's centre facing up, the right fist sinking slightly, and the eyes looking level ahead.

图 L1F241

Continuing from figure 240: the posture in which the left toes turn out, the body rises forward, the right leg pushes and the left leg bows to form a left bow step, while the left fist thrusts up and forward with the face of the fist, the fist's centre facing inward, and the right fist turns its arm and reels forward, falling beside the right hip.

图 L1F242

Step Up to the Seven Stars, action: the posture in which the left toes turn out, the body turns left and the centre of gravity moves entirely onto the left leg, the right foot steps forward half a step and touches the ground with its toes, the left fist reels forward and closes inward, and the right fist reels forward and, from the right downward, as the right leg steps up, thrusts up forward past the outer side of the left wrist, the two fists crossing at the wrists with both fists' centres facing inward.

图 L1F243

Continuing from figure 242: the posture in which, as the right foot steps up and touches the ground with its toes, the two fists, using the crossing point where the wrists are pressed tightly together as an axis, describe a small circle from above inward, downward and forward, then change into palms and extend slightly forward.

图 L1F244

Step Back and Bestride the Tiger, action one: the posture in which the two palms, before the chest, use the crossing point where the wrists are pressed tightly together as an axis and go from the front downward, inward and upward, rolling the wrists back, and then, using the left heel as an axis, the body turns right (south) and the right foot steps back one step.

图 L1F245

Continuing from figure 244: the posture in which the two arms close slightly and, after contracting the crossing circle a little, give the two palms a shake and they separate to the lower left and lower right, both palms' centres facing down.

Action one: The left foot springs up slightly to the left, and the right foot falls to where the left foot had been, stamping the ground with a shock; the body turns right, the left foot steps diagonally forward-left (southwest), and the centre of gravity gradually shifts left. As the right foot falls and stamps, the left hand turns its arm and reels forward to the right of the chest; the right fist reels forward from the right upward and falls to the left, resting on the left forearm; as the left foot steps out, the left fist squats down; at the same time, the two palms turn their arms and reel reverse, the right palm opening out to the upper right and the left palm to the lower left, the right palm's centre facing obliquely upper right and the left palm's centre facing obliquely lower left, forming Bestride the Tiger. (Figure 247)

图 L1F246

Step Back and Bestride the Tiger, action two: the posture in which the centre of gravity shifts right and the left foot is drawn close to the right foot, touching the ground with its toes beside the right foot, while the two hands reel reverse on the right and forward on the left, the right palm going from the right upward and describing an arc before the face and the left palm going from the left upward and describing an arc before the belly, the two hands joining their strength above and below.

图 L1F247

Continuing from figure 246: the posture in which the body squats down slightly and the two palms turn their arms and reel reverse, the right palm opening out to the upper right and the left palm to the lower left, the right palm's centre facing obliquely upper right and the left palm's centre facing obliquely lower left, forming Bestride the Tiger.

Key points: 1. The only form in this set that retreats continuously is Repulse the Monkey, and the only one in which, after stepping forward, one immediately steps back one step is Step Back and Bestride the Tiger. The preceding form follows the requirement of energy and steps forward,

while this form likewise follows the giving of energy and steps back. This is a method of practising one advance to one retreat.

· 174 · 2. In the preceding form the two wrists roll from below inward and forward, and there is naturally a Ward-off energy issuing; in this form, after turning back through one circle, one gives a sudden shake, an energy like slipping off a handcuff, and then the two separate and open, while at the same time the breath and the blocking energy must sink down.

Form Eighty: Turn the Body and Double Sweep the Lotus Action one: Using the right heel as an axis, the body turns 180 degrees back to the right, and the left foot is lifted and swings back to the right with the turn of the body. At the same time, the right palm, with the turning of the body, also revolves horizontally through 180 degrees, reeling reverse and lying crosswise at the upper right, the palm's centre facing right; the left palm reels forward and sweeps horizontally back to the right until it is before the right elbow, the palm's centre facing right. (Figures 248–249)

图 L1F248

Turn the Body and Double Sweep the Lotus, action one: the posture in which, using the right heel as an axis, the body turns 180 degrees back to the right and the left foot is lifted and swings back to the right with the turn, while the right palm with the turning body revolves horizontally through 180 degrees, reeling reverse and lying crosswise at the upper right with the palm's centre facing right, and the left palm reels forward and sweeps horizontally back to the right until it is before the right elbow with the palm's centre facing right.

图 L1F249

Continuing from figure 248: the same action of the body turning back to the right, with the right palm revolving horizontally and lying crosswise at the upper right and the left palm reeling forward and sweeping horizontally back to the right until before the right elbow.

图 L1F250

Turn the Body and Double Sweep the Lotus, action two: the posture in which the left foot steps down forward (northwest) on a diagonal, and as the centre of gravity shifts left with the left leg bending at the knee and squatting down while the body turns right at the same time, the two palms reel reverse on the left and forward on the right and sink slightly from the right.

图 L1F251

Cannon Fired Point-Blank, action one: the posture in which the right foot, after the outer swing, steps down toward the right rear (south), while the two palms change into fists, turn their arms and reel forward, chopping down and then turning to thrust slightly forward and upward, the two fists' centres facing each other with the left fist in front and the right fist behind, and with the thrusting fists the left knee forms a forward bow.

图 L1F252

Continuing from figure 251: the posture in which the two palms change into fists, turn their arms and reel forward, chopping down, with the two fists' centres facing each other and the left fist in front and the right fist behind.

图 L1F253

Continuing from figures 251 to 252: the posture in which, after turning the arms and reeling forward to chop down, the fists thrust slightly forward and upward, and with the thrust the left knee forms a forward bow.

图 L2F1

In a bow stance, the right hand holds the hooked hand in front of the body and the left palm extends forward; the opening posture of the Second Routine diagrams.

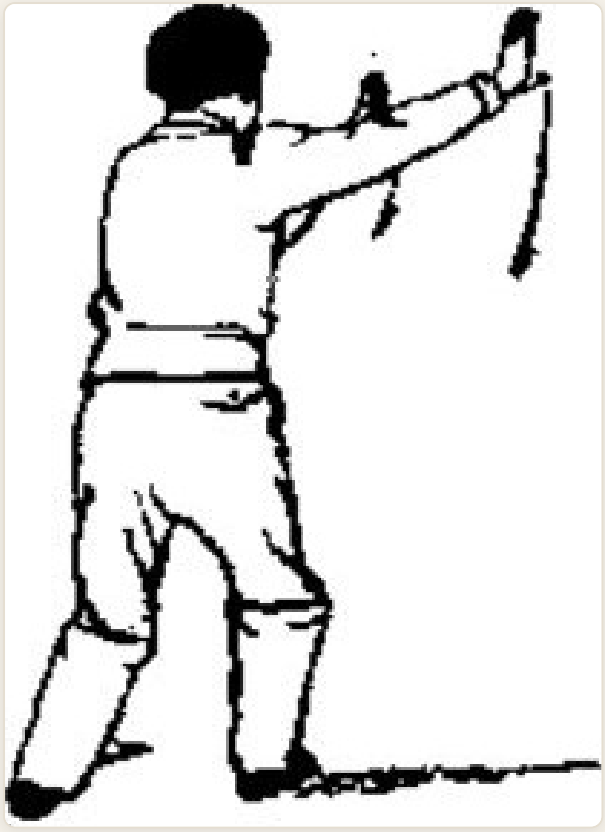
图 L2F2

Facing forward in a bow stance, both fists strike horizontally to the left; the posture as the center of gravity then shifts right for the rightward horizontal strike.

图 L2F3

Facing forward in a bow stance, both fists strike to the right, with the right arm raised in an arc.

图 L2F4



The right leg bends and squats, the body turns left, and the left fist is lifted to guard the chest.

图 L2F5

Standing with feet apart, both hands drawing together before the chest.

in an arc reeling forward to the left-rear-lower, down to the left side of the waist, the fist-heart slanting toward the upper right; the right fist, first reeling backward then forward, follows the turning of the body from the right upward, passes the front side of the right forehead and goes left, and strikes downward at the same time as the right foot lands. (Figure 4) The left fist reels forward and is raised to the left to the height of the shoulder; the right fist reels forward and draws inward. (Figure 5) The left fist goes from the left forward, passes the outside of the right fist, downward and inward; the right fist goes from the inside outward; the two fists cross past each other before the chest; then both hands reel forward, the left fist draws inward, and the right fist thrusts forward with the back of the fist near the wrist; at the same time the center of gravity sinks. (Figure 6)

Key points:

In Taijiquan movements, whenever a circle is to be enlarged, it must first be made smaller; this is to strengthen the "ward-off" energy , so that under the condition of "qi clinging to the spine" the internal power is threaded through and reaches the root of the palm. When the two hands perform the inside-outside, left-right double backward reeling and open up before the chest, the combining energy arises — right in front, left behind; finally, like the character ∞, the two circles meet before the chest to guard the heart; at the same time the circles are gradually made smaller, forming stored power like a drawn bow, to strengthen the ward-off energy.

Form Eight　Slanting Twist-Step Walk (chest toward east, turning to southeast)

图 L2F6

In a bow stance with the body turned sideways, the two fists cross before the chest and the right fist thrusts forward with ward-off energy.

图 L2F7

Standing with the body turned sideways, both fists crossed and drawn in before the chest.

图 L2F8

Standing with the body turned sideways, the two palms dividing up and down.

图 L2F9

Standing on one leg with the body turned sideways, the two palms spread up and down.

图 L2F10

Standing on the left leg with the right leg lifted, both palms joined before the chest.

图 L2F11

In a broad bow stance, the two palms divided left and right, the body upright and the posture steady.

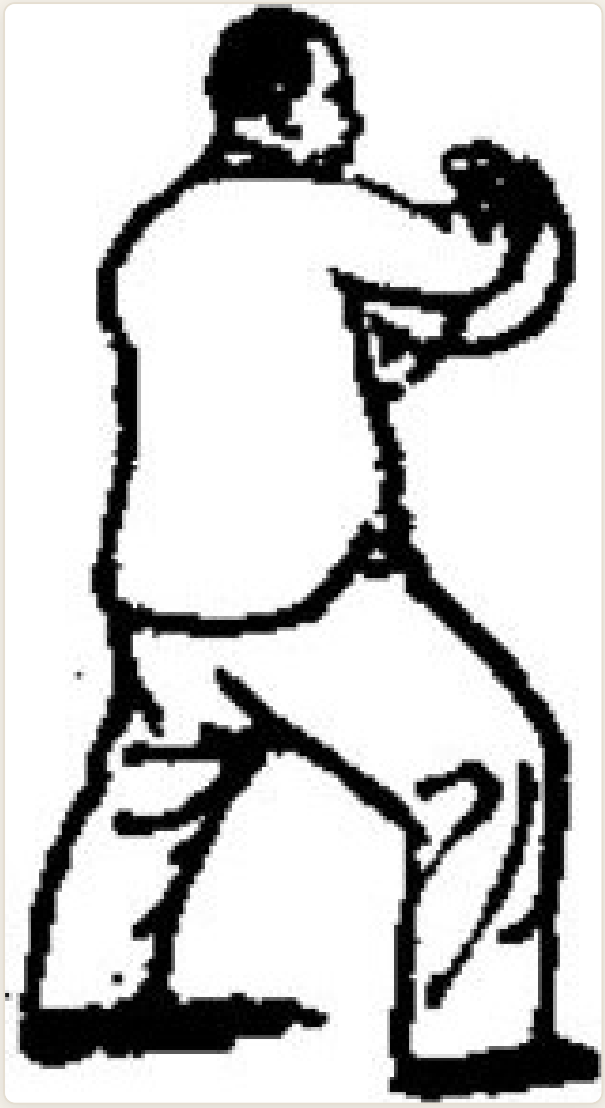
图 L2F12

In a low horse stance, the right fist placed above the right knee and the left fist combining energy above.

图 L2F13

Standing with the body turned sideways, both hands turning over at the sides of the waist, palm-hearts facing up.

图 L2F14



Standing upright with feet together, both arms spread left and right, palm-hearts facing outward.

图 L2F15

Standing upright with feet together, the two arms crossed before the chest, the two palms combining energy.

图 L2F16

Standing with feet together, the right fist dropped into the left palm, the right foot lifted to stamp.

图 L2F17

Sinking into a horse stance, the two hands facing each other above and below before the chest, palm-hearts facing each other.

图 L2F18

In a bow stance with the body slanting, the right arm raised above the head and the left palm pressing down.

图 L2F19

Fourteenth Posture, P'ieh-shen Ch'ui: the body turns slightly right, the left fist turns over its back to strike out to the left side, the right fist releases energy toward the right rear, the chest facing southeast.

After the above, with the two fists guarding the chest, the two fists open into palms and perform silk-reeling — right forward, left backward — uniting before the chest. At this moment the right hand is above and the left hand below, with the right palm · 189 · **Key points:** When the left [fist] has turned to the left crotch and the left arm is again plucked, in order neither to lose nor to resist, one should adapt to the essential force of the pluck and, following the direction of the opponent's essential force, strike out to the left with energy. This is a direct and straightforward technique for seeking release. Therefore in this posture the left fist counter-strikes as the main action, but the root of the strike lies in the right fist, which rotates with forward twining at the upper right, and through it the internal energy is threaded and poured into the left arm.

Fifteenth Posture Chan-shou (Chopping Hand) (chest southeast, turning north)

Movement: This posture supposes that in the strike of the preceding posture "P'ieh-shen Ch'ui" no release was obtained; then once more, following the direction of the essential force, step up with the right foot; the right hand, with forward twining, turns up from the right rear and over with the body, and joins above the left hand; at the same instant that the plucked left hand is suddenly lifted, the edge of the right palm chops down like a knife, forming the double-opening forward-cleaving posture of left high and right low, accompanied by a sinking stamp of the right foot. This is stepping up with the right foot so as to place both hands within one's own square-and-round circle; it is a technique of striking free in which two hands and one foot act simultaneously. At this moment the chest has turned to the north. (Figure 20)

Key points:

图 L2F20

Fifteenth Posture, Chan-shou: stepping up with the right foot, the right hand turns up with forward twining and then the edge of the right palm chops down, the left hand simultaneously lifting, forming a double-opening forward-cleaving posture of left high and right low, the chest turning to the north.

This is the method of releasing the plucked left hand a second time. The method most commonly used in plucking energy is the downward-pressing pluck, which forces the opponent to find it hard to follow, so that the plucked person cannot but tend toward a kneeling posture; hence he cannot but adopt a hand-leading-the-body step-up, so as to hasten the method of release in which the "right chop," the "left lift," and the "foot stamp" are all three applied together. Therefore, under the requirement that the right hand's energy be unbroken, one uses a small forward-twining rotation to step up with the right foot, bringing the plucked left hand within one's own square-and-round circle; this is the basic method of using lightness to overcome heaviness. Before stepping up and after stepping up, as well as · 190 · When chopping down, the tail gate (coccyx) must in every case be centered and upright; on no account may the downward strike cause the tail gate to topple forward.

Sixteenth Posture Fan-hua Wu-hsiu (Turning the Flower, Dancing the Sleeve) (chest north turning south, then turning northeast)

Movement: Suppose the second release has still not succeeded, that is, beneath the lifting-up and chopping-down the opponent's plucking hand still cannot be chopped away; then one must, by a turning-over movement of the body, release further — that is, following the opponent's upward-resisting chop energy, suddenly leap up; the left hand, with reverse twining, lifts up and circles over the top of the head, and the body turns over. This is a great turning of the body from below upward. The inertial force of the turn is led by the left hand. At this moment the right hand also uses reverse twining from below upward to assist, and with double-opening energy the body leaps up and turns over. At the same time the left foot lifts, and brings the right foot to leap

up along with it. This movement includes using the energy of both arms and the shoulder-leaning to release the plucked hand. (Fig. 21; this figure is the instant of leaping up and turning the face) Then, in the continuing top-to-bottom rotation, when the left hand on the left side passes from reverse twining to forward twining and moves downward, the left foot simultaneously lands with a foot stamp. This is an action performed by the left hand and left foot at the same time. When the left foot lands and the right foot steps forward to the right, the right palm must simultaneously pass from reverse twining at the rear-upper position to forward twining, and chop down forward with the edge of the palm (at the chop the energy is the same as the chopping energy of splitting the frame). At the same time, the left hand forms a fist and, with forward twining, strikes out to the left rear as the guest. At this moment the left foot is solid. (Fig. 22; this figure is the posture at the moment of rotating the body, landing, and giving one chop)

图 L2F21

Sixteenth Posture, Fan-hua Wu-hsiu, the leap-up and turn of the face: the body leaps up, the left hand lifts and circles over the top of the head turning over, the right hand assists, the right foot leaps up along with the left foot.

图 L2F22

Fan-hua Wu-hsiu, landing with one chop: the left foot lands with a foot stamp and becomes solid, the right foot steps forward, the edge of the right palm chops forward and down, the left fist strikes out with forward twining to the left rear.

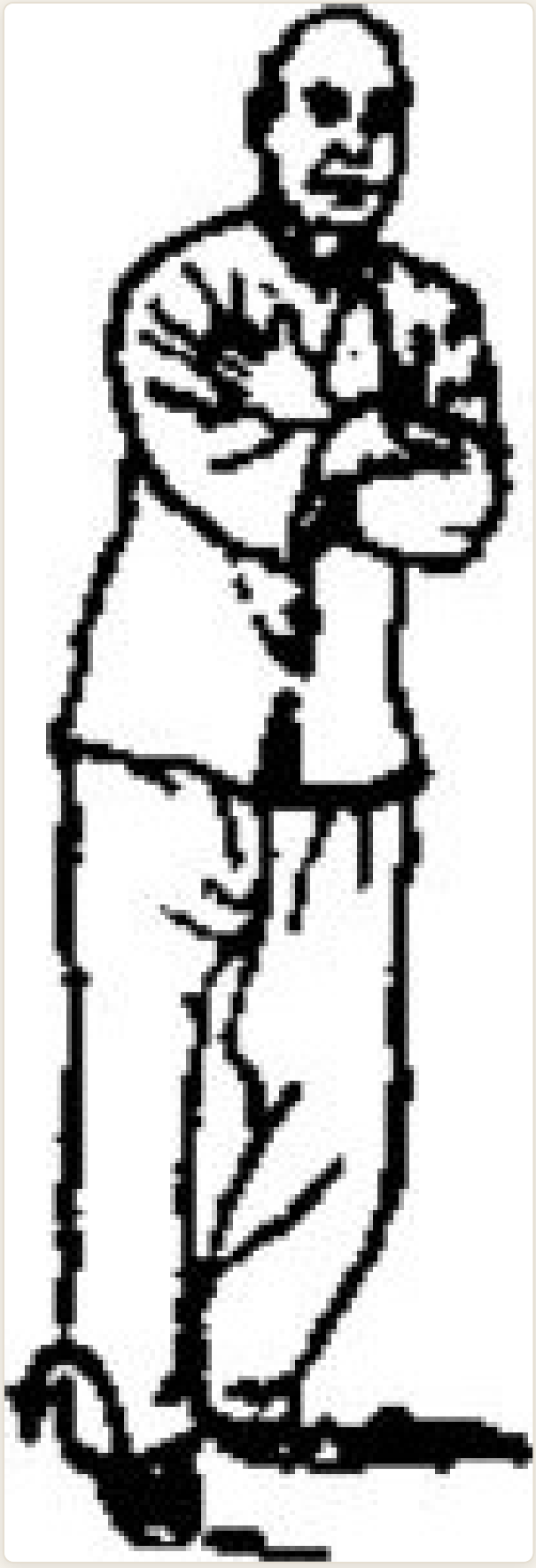
· 191 · **Key points:** The characteristic of the preceding posture's chopping-hand release method is that both parties' arms are at the front, and the distances from the point of application of force to both parties are equal; whereas the body-turn of this posture "Fan-hua Wu-hsiu" employs the rotating action of the body method and the lumbar spine, causing the distances of the force's point of application suddenly to form a striking contrast (near to oneself, far from the opponent). That is to say, the release point is made far from the opponent and near to oneself. This relationship of one near and one far forms a change in the magnitude of the torque. After turning the body, of the two feet the left foot lands first with a foot stamp and the right foot lands slightly later; in this way the inertial force of the rotation of the waist axis is strengthened, and consequently the downward-chopping energy of the right hand is also strengthened — this is where the key to yet another method of seeking release lies. This kind of release uses the downward chop of the edge of the right palm to take over the rotational inertia of the right hand's forward-twining turn-over. At the same time, the downward chop must be loosened and elastic, for only thus can the next posture be prompted to leap up nimbly. This kind of release is also another example of using lightness to overcome heaviness, and is the concrete expression of one technique serving two purposes, that is to say, a dual use in which release conceals a strike

and the strike conceals a release. Therefore this posture consists mainly in one hand releasing while the other hand chops down following the rotation.

Seventeenth Posture Yen-shou Kung-ch'üan (Covering-Hand Forearm Punch) (chest northeast, turning east)

Movement: This is a posture whose main purpose is the practice of storing energy and of issuing energy; within the frame of the Second Routine, it is mostly used to link things up whenever it follows a special posture. This is the first Covering-Hand Forearm Punch of the Second Routine. It borrows the elastic energy of the chop of the preceding posture: both hands, with double forward twining, leap the body up, and the front-rear positions of the left and right legs are exchanged; then the right foot lands with a foot stamp and becomes solid, and the left foot steps forward with a lifting (ch'ien/jian) movement and becomes empty. At the same time, with double reverse twining the whole body's energy is bent and stored, and the ring-circle of both arms is made smaller to strengthen the stored energy. At this moment the left hand is above and the right hand below, the right foot is empty and the left foot is solid. (Figure 23) Then, the latter half of the section is the issuance of energy. Before issuing, the right hand first makes a small reverse-twining circle and places it at the waist, the center of the fist facing upward; at the same time the left hand relatively does reverse twining, the center of the fist facing downward — this is the left storing of energy. When the right hand is at the right waist, the right hand sinks its energy, and amid that steadiness still uses reverse twining to sud- · 192 · With the momentum of the issuance, the energy is sent forward. At this moment the center of the fist faces downward. At the same time, the left hand relatively turns to reverse twining, releasing the fist backward to draw it back, and places it at the left waist. The center of the fist faces downward. When storing energy, the right foot is solid; when issuing energy, the left foot is solid. (Figure 24)

图 L2F23



Seventeenth Posture, Yen-shou Kung-ch'üan, storing energy: the right foot solid and the left foot empty, the left hand above and the right hand below, with double reverse twining bending and storing the energy.

图 L2F24

Yen-shou Kung-ch'üan, issuing energy: the right fist is sent forward, the center of the fist facing downward, the left hand releases energy backward and draws back to the left waist; at the issuance the left foot is solid.

Key points:

This posture is the one most frequently used (six times) in the second frame, and its key point lies in strengthening the practice of the energy of "storing energy like drawing a bow." It is led by containing the chest and pulling up the back, causing both arms to possess a joining energy shaped like the character 6. When practicing the issuance of energy, there must be the issuance energy of lifting a thing up and then bringing it down. Therefore the first half-section must be like drawing a bow to strengthen elasticity, and the second half-section must further have the twining energy of releasing an arrow deep into the target. This is the concrete expression of making the movement issue far and long. For this reason, before issuing energy there must be a sinking small circle, so that the drawn-out stored energy and the issued energy become one; one may not simply use a straight-line storing-and-issuing energy that has no drawing along with it.

Eighteenth Posture Fei-pu Niu-luan Chou (Flying Step, Twisted Phoenix Elbow) (chest east turning north, then turning south)

Movement: After the issuance of energy of the preceding posture "Yen-shou Kung-ch'üan," both fists make a small reverse twining in their original position, joining energy front and rear; when

the right fist with reverse twining goes forward and the left fist with reverse twining goes backward to open, the right foot is accordingly lifted, and leaps forward with a flying step, landing as solid. At the same time, with · 193 · With the right foot serving as the pivot of the turning heel, the left foot sweeps an arc past the right foot and comes to the east side of the right foot, causing the body to spin in the air through 270°. (Figure 25) This supposes that in the preceding posture "Yen-shou Kung-ch'üan," after the right hand has issued its energy, it is plucked by the opponent, and it is a posture adopted when there is no time to draw it back. The opponent is applying energy along the direction of the issuance, so one cannot but follow quickly, to adapt to the person, using a flying step to comply with and transform the energy. In the course of complying with the flying step, one naturally turns the body to the left, using the back-bending-and-leaning energy to release the plucked right hand; this is similar to the various "Jade Maiden Works the Shuttle" postures of the First Routine.

图 L2F25

Eighteenth Posture, Fei-pu Niu-luan Chou, the body spin: with the right foot as the pivot of the turning heel, the left foot sweeps an arc past the right foot, the body spins in the air through 270°, the left fist with reverse twining trailing behind.

图 L2F26

After the great 270° turn, the wide horse stance: both hands draw apart to form one great ring, the body sinks into a horse stance, the left foot on the left, both fists separated front and rear.

It is likewise a leaping step, but the hand method is different. (Figure 26) After the great 270° body-turn, suppose the back-bending-and-leaning energy of the great turn still cannot release the plucked right hand; then after the turn, both hands with double reverse twining unite as one, the center of the left palm presses upon the opponent's plucking hand, causing both arms to form a transverse ring, and the right elbow energy strikes forward. This is the final application of one technique to two uses: it is release and also advance-and-attack. After the turn, the right foot is solid; at the issuance of elbow energy, the left foot is solid. The Niu-luan Chou finally formed is as in Fig. 27.

图 L2F27

Niu-luan Chou, the fixed posture: both hands with double reverse twining unite as one, the center of the left palm presses upon the opponent's plucking hand, both arms form a transverse ring, the right elbow strikes forward; after the turn the right foot is solid, and at the issuance of elbow energy the left foot is solid.

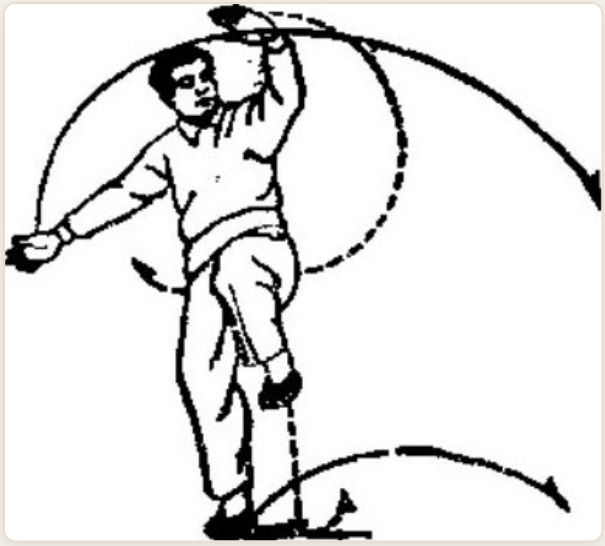
· 194 · **Key points:** This is the final method of using the back-bending-and-leaning energy to release the plucked right hand. Because of the rotation of the body, it can also cause the distances of the force's point of application suddenly to form a striking contrast favorable to oneself, so as to achieve overcoming heaviness with lightness; it is a posture and strike that releases without seeking to be released. At the same time, what distinguishes this posture from the preceding several is that the left palm is pressed at the right elbow, and the back and elbow are joined to strike the opponent transversely. This is a special posture that presses down the opponent's plucking forearm, fixing the opponent's plucking point so that he cannot change it, and throws the person out sideways. Therefore it is likewise one technique with two uses. Its key point lies in being able, after flying out with the step, still to land with the body established upright and centered. Most especially, one must note that after issuing, both arms must still be bent and stored with reserve, rather than extending the hands fully straight. Therefore one must use the flying step to come out in order to suit the essential energy. This is the method of final release in a whole series of release movements; that is, it is an example of the Second Frame's practice of plucking and of releasing from the pluck. Although this posture strikes forward with elbow energy, its root is still in the back-bending-and-leaning energy of the right side. For this reason, its essential requirement is that only on the basis of establishing the body upright and centered can the unity of using elbow and leaning together be obtained.

Nineteenth Posture Yün-shou (Moving Hands / Cloud Hands) (the first three, chest south)

图 L2F28

Nineteenth Posture, Yün-shou, the first segment: both hands move simultaneously to the left, the body established upright and centered, the two palms tracing arcs one front and one rear.

图 L2F29



Yün-shou, the right-turning segment: both hands move simultaneously to the right and then to the left, the two palms tracing arcs along a circular path.

图 L2F30

Nineteenth Posture, Yün-shou, the third movement: the left foot opens half a step sideways to the left, the center of gravity shifts left, the left foot becomes solid and the right foot becomes empty, both hands with left reverse and right forward twining, the left palm passing before the face and the right palm before the abdomen, moving and turning to the left.

Movement: Both hands move simultaneously to the left, then simultaneously to the right, and then move to the left again, forming **Key points:** In this posture one must, under a smooth and gentle curved movement, perform the silk-twining transformations of left forward and right reverse, and right forward and left reverse, and must lift and lower the legs under the condition of not moving the step, fully expressing the requirement of the division of solid and empty in which hands and feet follow one another above and below; this is also the basic requirement of this posture. The Second Frame, having passed through the preceding several leaping and strenuous fist postures, can here adjust its breathing movement a little. Therefore in this figure-∞ movement of the hands, the speed of movement may be slow or fast; this is the place where the Second Frame is naturally divided into sections.

Twentieth Posture Kao T'an Ma (High Pat on Horse) (chest west)

Movement: After performing the first three Moving Hands, with the left heel as the axis the body turns right, and the right heel leaves the ground; at the same time both hands, the right with reverse twining and the left with forward twining, move and turn to the right, the right palm passing before the face and the left palm passing before the abdomen; when the left palm has moved and turned to the right of the body, the center of the hand faces upward. (Figure 31) Then the right foot is lifted, and the body continues to turn right; at the same time the right palm, with forward twining, passes beneath the left palm · 196 · draws in from the side, the center of the palm facing upward, and the left hand with reverse twining pushes forward past the upper side of the right palm, the center of the palm facing outward and downward. (Figure 32)

图 L2F31

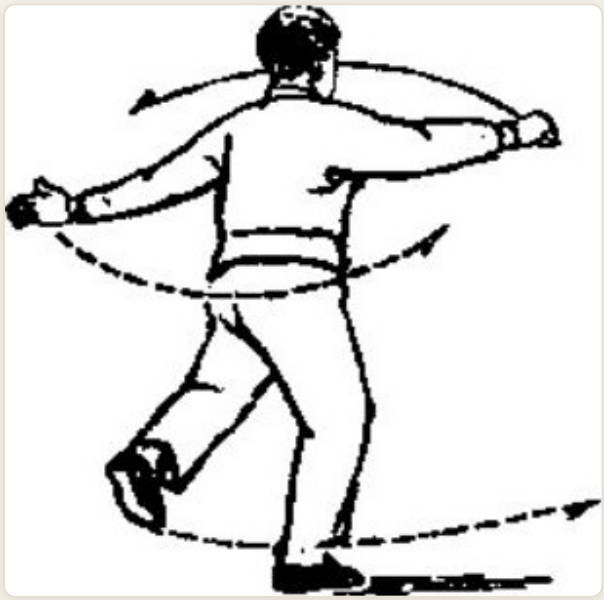
Twentieth Posture, Kao T'an Ma, the Moving Hands before it: both hands with right reverse and left forward twining move and turn to the right, and when the left palm has moved to the right of the body the center of the hand faces upward.

图 L2F32

Twentieth Posture, Kao T'an Ma, the fixed posture: the right palm draws in from the side, the center of the palm facing upward, and the left hand with reverse twining pushes forward past the upper side of the right palm, the center of the palm facing outward and downward.

Twenty-first Posture Yün-shou (Moving Hands) (the last three)

图 L2F33



Twenty-first Posture, Yün-shou (the last three), the exchange: both hands with right reverse and left forward twining, the right hand turning toward the right front and the left hand turning toward the front of the chest, the whole body with the left foot as the turning axis rotating 90°, the right foot landing with a foot stamp and becoming solid.

图 L2F34

Yün-shou (the last three), the left sideways step: the left foot opens one step sideways to the left, touching the ground first with the heel, and the center of gravity shifts to the left leg.

Movement: After performing Kao T'an Ma, then both hands, with right reverse and left forward twining, turn the right hand toward the right front, while the left hand turns toward the front of the chest. At the same time as this exchange of the two hands, the whole body, with the left foot as the turning axis, rotates 90°. At the same time, the right foot lands with a foot stamp and becomes solid, and the left foot opens one step sideways to the left, touching the ground first with the heel. (Figure 33) The center of gravity shifts to the left leg. The left foot · 197 · Steady the foot; the right foot steps half a step to the left, touching the ground first with the toe. At the same time, the two hands turn: the left hand with reverse (ni) coiling and the right hand with forward (shun) coiling; the left palm passes in front of the face and the right palm passes in front of the abdomen, moving to the left. (Figure 34) Then the right foot stamps firmly, and the left foot opens half a step sideways to the left; at the same time, the two hands turn: the right hand with reverse coiling and the left hand with forward coiling; the right palm passes in front of the face and the left palm passes in front of the abdomen, moving to the right. (Figure 35)

Key points:

In the second routine (form) there are the first three and the last three "moving hands" (yün shou); the first three face the chest south, the last three face the chest north. Their basic requirements and functions are the same, so they will not be repeated. Therefore this form's key points no longer discuss the moving-hands action itself, but only the turn from doing the high pat-on-horse (kao t'an ma) after raising the leg to the front, into the turn toward the back. This action requires turning the body around within a gentle curve, with unbroken silk-reeling and continuous inner strength; therefore one must make a good small circle of the left hand drawn back in front of the chest in reverse coiling. Through this reverse coiling one shifts the torso, and

the torso and the silk-reeling can be changed over suspended in the air. In this way not only is the inner strength kept unbroken, but it can also be threaded through into the next action. Hence this form is also a rather difficult action for practising the threading-through of section after section.

In order to make the turn-around easier, after Chen Fa-ke came to Peking, and to popularize Chen-style taijiquan, he added two boxing forms — cloud hands (yün shou) and high pat-on-horse — into this turn. Thus there was no longer the requirement of threading through while turning sharply in the air, and it became easier to do.

Twenty-second Form: High Pat on Horse (chest north turning northwest)

Action: After the right turn-palm of the previous form, when the body turns left again, the two hands first both turn forward (shun) and close together, so that the two hands cross in front of the chest and pass each other; then both turn reverse (ni) and open.

图 L2F35

Hands moving with left reverse and right forward coiling, body turning and left foot opening half a step sideways

up. When closing, the left foot is full. (Figure 37) When opening, the right foot is full (Figure 38). This is a boxing form linking to the next, and its jin is the same as "white crane spreads its wings" in the first routine; only the hands are more evenly levelled in height, and the two legs straddle wider, so as to manifest a rounded crotch.

Key points:

This is a boxing form that closes from double forward (shun) coiling and then opens from double reverse (ni) coiling; it requires that in the process of turning open after closing there be no

corners, ridges or hollows, so that the silk-reeling jin is carried onto the back of the bow. At the same time, it requires that in the enlarged and expanded posture one strengthen the elastic training with section-after-section threading, so as to raise the taut (beng) jin. When closing, pay attention to the two thumbs, chiefly the left-hand fingers; when opening, pay attention to the two little fingers, chiefly the right-hand fingers.

Twenty-third Form: Linked Pearl Cannon, part one (chest northwest turning west)

图 L2F36

Two hands with double forward coiling and double closing, crossed before the chest, left foot full

图 L2F37

Double reverse coiling opening up, right foot full, rounded crotch

图 L2F38

Double reverse coiling issuing the pressing-out jin, right palm outward and left palm down, right foot advancing half a step

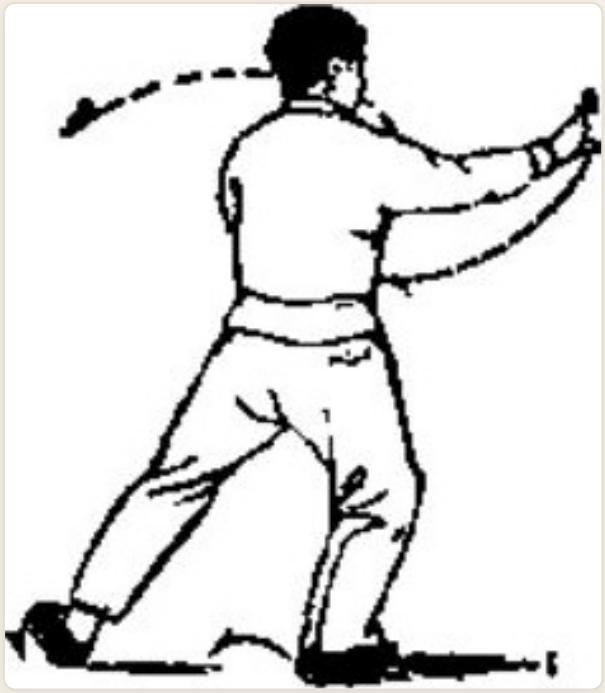
图 L2F39

Right foot following up half a step, the heel grinding the ground with a sound

图 L2F40

Sitting on the left leg storing jin, right hand forward-coiling before the chest and closing with the left hand

图 L2F41



Right hand reverse-coiling to guard outside the left forearm, centre of gravity moving forward, right leg full

图 L2F42

Right hand reverse-coiling to right-rear-above, left hand reverse-coiling to left-front-below, left foot lifted and hands separating

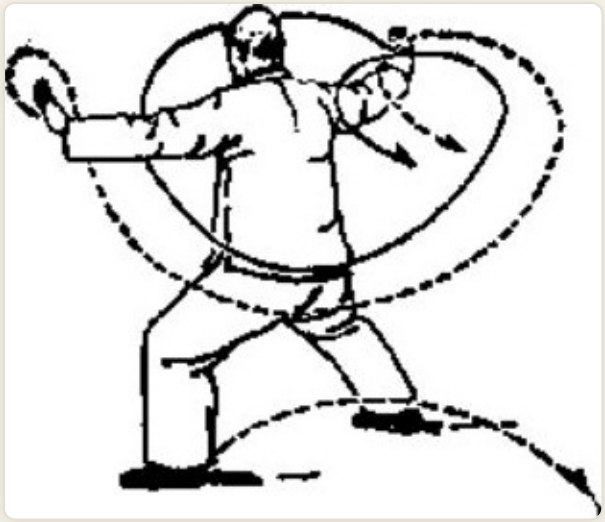
图 L2F43

Turning right 180° with the right foot as axis, the body turning to face east

图 L2F44

The body carried around from opening to closing, right hand lower right with palm down, left hand upper left with fingers erect

图 L2F45



After the left foot strides backwards, the right hand forward-coils and strikes out the pressing jin to the front, the left foot stepping forward half a step full and the right foot following up

Action: From the opening jin of the previous form to the closing jin of this form, it is a closing by double reverse coiling. At this time, the right hand reverse-coils to the right of the chest, palm facing outward left; the left hand reverse-coils to the front of the chest, palm facing outward right; the two hands close into one closing jin in front of the chest. At this time the left foot is full, the right foot empty. Then the two hands forward-coil and press out (peng) to the front; at the same time the right foot becomes full, and when the two hands press out and come down with double forward coiling, the left foot retreats one step and the centre of gravity immediately shifts left, sitting on the left leg as full. When the two hands sink down (t'a), the whole body forms a posture of storing jin. (Figure 38) Then the two hands again turn to double reverse "covering-hand forearm punch (yen shou kung ch'ui)," and afterwards do the third "white snake spits out its tongue"; this makes it much easier to do). When practising the forward stride of the opposite step, at first it feels a little awkward, so one must practise a great deal. At the same time, this boxing form is a short-distance storing and issuing, so one must hollow the chest and raise the back, with the spinal column leading, so as to achieve section-after-section threading and the issuing of jin from the spine. This is the representative action of the whole set for issuing jin from the spine. If the curved issuing is manifested only by the two arms, it does not meet the requirement. It would be even better if one could take it out for special practice.

Twenty-sixth Form: White Snake Spits Out Its Tongue, part two (chest east)

Twenty-seventh Form: White Snake Spits Out Its Tongue, part three (chest east)

图 L2F46

Right hand in front forward-coiling and storing to the front of the chest with palm facing left, left hand reverse-coiling to the left flank, centre of gravity shifted back with right foot full and left toe touching ground

图 L2F47

Right palm forward-coiling a small circle in front and striking out with the taut jin of the fingers

Action: The stored jin of the previous "white snake spits out its tongue" was completed by the closing posture of "riding the qilin backwards" splitting and turning and then one more closing jin. But the stored jin of this "white snake spits out its tongue" is stored after the issuing jin of the

"white snake spits out its tongue." This is the point of difference between the two "white snake spits out its tongue." At the start, the right hand in front forward-coils and stores to the front of the chest, palm facing left. At the same time, the left hand, on the left, reverse-coils and turns to the left flank. When storing, the two arms hold the jin together, the centre of gravity shifts back, the right foot is full, and the left toe touches the ground as empty. (Figure 46) Then the right palm, in front, chiefly forward-coiling a small circle, strikes out with the taut (beng) jin of the fingers. At the same time, the left palm behind, with reverse coiling, coordinates with the right palm and issues together. At this time the left foot steps forward half a step and lands full, the right foot immediately follows up, grinding the ground with a sound, completing the second "white snake spits out its tongue." (Figure 47) This form also, according to the practitioner's need, may be done several extra times, the same number of times as the "linked pearl cannon."

Key points: Same as the first white snake spits out its tongue.

Thirtieth Form: Turning Over the Flower at the Bottom of the Sea (chest east turning west)

Action: This is a special boxing form. After the previous form's right hand has issued the pressing-out (peng) jin forward, it immediately closes with the left hand behind in a double forward coiling that crosses. After closing, with the double opening jin of right forward and left reverse, the body is turned right 180°. At this time the centre of gravity shifts onto the left foot, forming an independent posture. In the course of turning to the west, the left and right hands become fists; the right fist strikes with the back of the fist downward and backward, the fist-heart facing forward. The left fist strikes upward and backward, the fist-heart facing right. (Fig. 48. From Fig. 48 onward to the last figure, because formerly when photographing Teacher Chen Fa-ke all the photographs of the action were taken from the reverse side, in all the following figures, facing the reader is north, back to the reader is south, the left side as one faces the reader is east, and the right side as one faces the reader is west. This will not be repeated hereafter.)

Key points:

This boxing form chiefly exercises the elbow joint. The left fist striking backward and upward and the right fist striking backward and downward — striking up and down — is a rarely seen issuing backward, so its key point lies in requiring that the balance of the body be maintained when issuing up and down and backward.

Thirty-first Form: Covering-Hand Forearm Punch (chest west)

图 L2F48

Left and right hands form fists, right fist striking down-backward with the back of the fist and fist-heart forward, left fist striking up-backward with fist-heart right, the body turning right 180° with the centre of gravity shifted to an independent posture on the left foot

Action: In the previous form the right leg is raised, and the two fists strike backward to the sides, one above and one below backward, the right fist, after slightly lifting up with forward coiling, sinks down again with forward coiling, the back of the fist facing down, and the right foot simultaneously stamps the ground. At the same time, the left fist, coordinating with the right fist, after slightly sinking with reverse coiling, is immediately raised; the whole body's centre of gravity is all on the one stamp of the right leg. When the right fist forward-coils until the fist-heart faces up again, and after adding a sinking jin, then it changes to reverse coiling and sends the jin out. The issuing hand must still keep some leeway, and must not be fully extended. At the same time, the left fist, raised with reverse coiling, turns once into forward coiling and issues backward as the guest (secondary), so as to maintain a double issuing with host and guest. (Figure 49)

Key points: Same as the seventeenth form, "covering-hand forearm punch."

Thirty-second Form: Turn the Body, Six Harmonies (chest west, from north turning south)

图 L2F49

Right fist forward-coiling, lifted and sunk, back of the fist facing down, right foot stamping the ground, left fist after reverse-coiling and sinking is raised

图 L2F50

Right hand forward-coiling and gathering before the left shoulder, left hand reverse-coiling and extending before the chest, centre of gravity shifting right and the body turning right

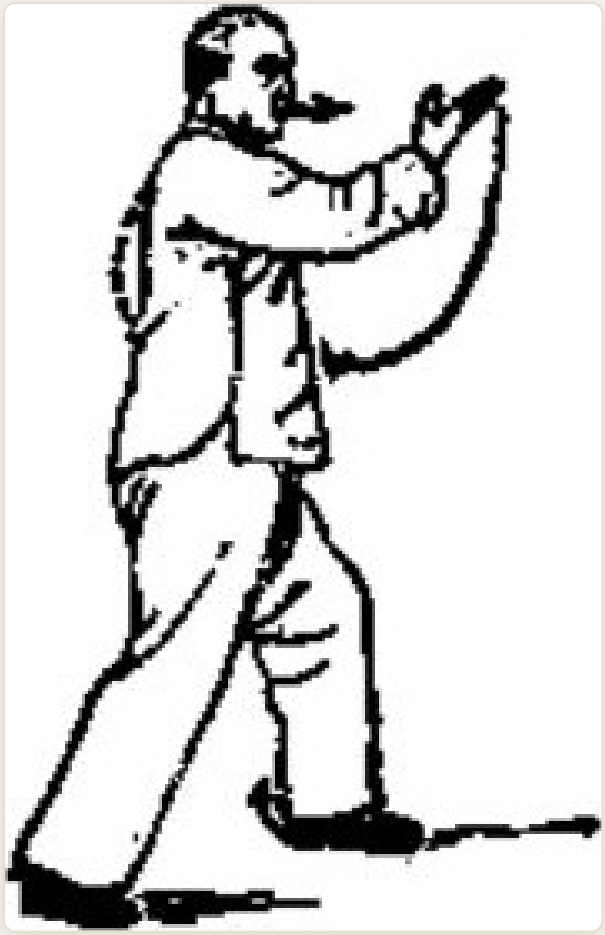
图 L2F51

The two fists separating to left and right

图 L2F52

Weight shifted onto the left leg, right foot lifted, body turning to the right-rear, both fists brought together and crossed before the abdomen, right fist inside

图 L2F53



Right foot landing with a stomp, the posture of the body turning right

图 L2F54

Left foot stepping sideways to the left, both hands double-reverse issuing power to the left and right outer sides, fist-hearts facing forward and up

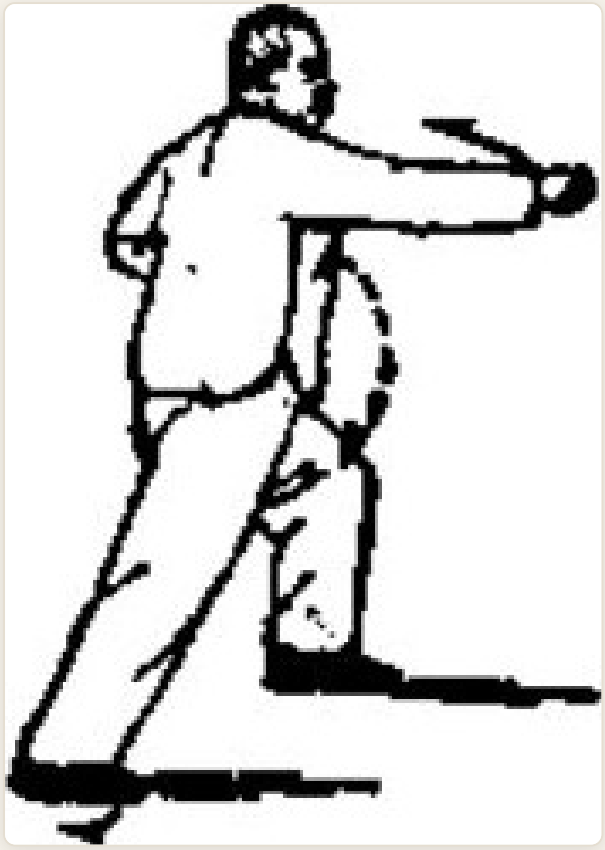
图 L2F55

Both fists brought together in front of the lower abdomen, weight shifted left, right foot lifted and set down to the left of the left foot, both fists and both feet crossed and wrapped

图 L2F56

Both fists turn double-reverse issuing power to the left and right outer sides, left foot stepping sideways to the left

图 L2F57



Taking the left foot as pivot and lifting the right foot, both fists double-reverse twisting brought together before the lower abdomen with fist-backs facing each other, body carried turning 180° to the left

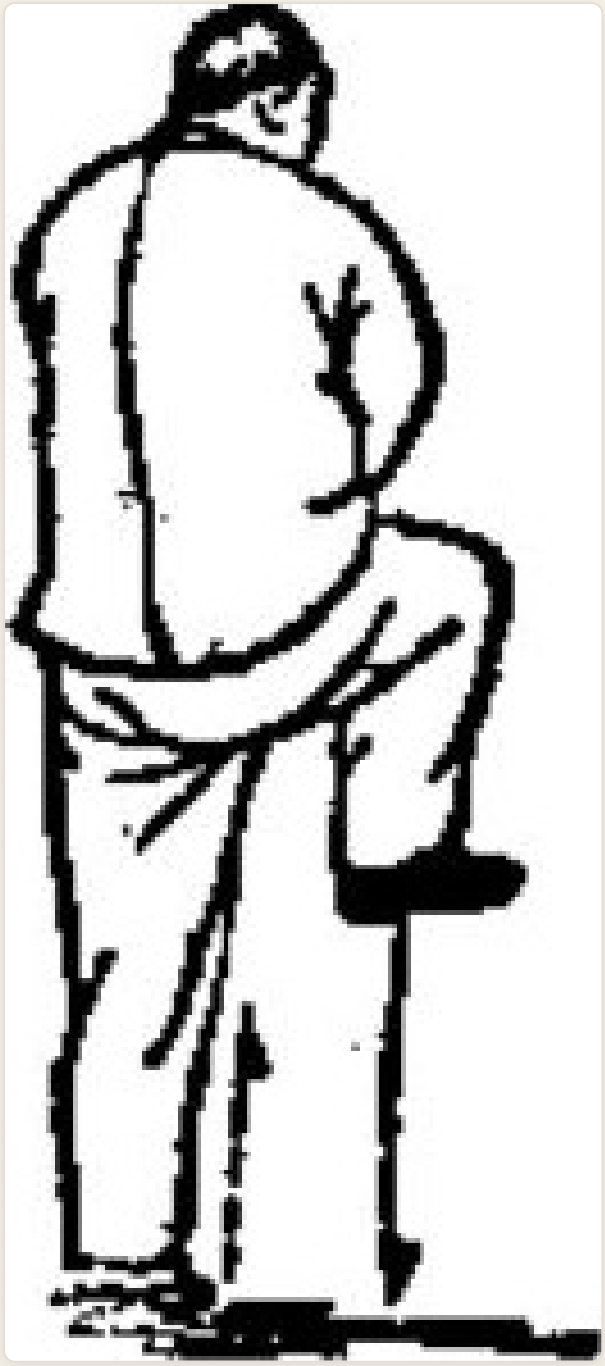
图 L2F58

Both fists turning double-reverse issuing firm power to the left and right sides, left hand and left foot dominant, forming the first Wrap-Whip after the turn

图 L2F59

Both fists brought together before the lower abdomen, right foot lifted, Right Wrap-Whip Cannon storing its power

图 L2F60



Right foot set down to the right of the left foot, both fists and both feet crossed and wrapped

图 L2F61

Both fists turning double-reverse issuing firm power to the left and right sides, chest facing north

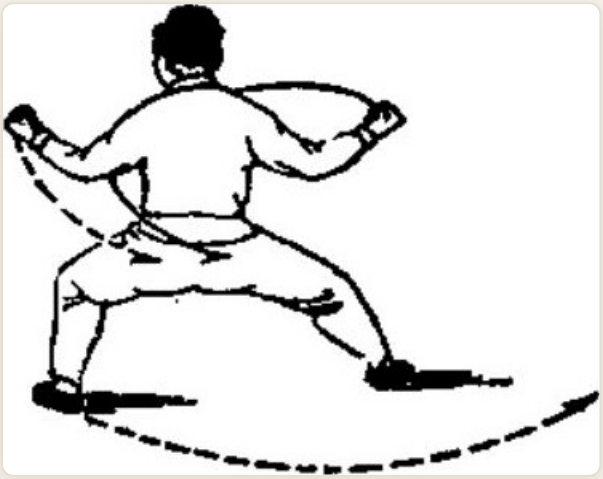
图 L2F62

Right fist twisting shun drawing an arc to beneath the left elbow, left fist twisting ni rising up, forming the double-closing posture, right foot solid

图 L2F63

Left arm twisting shun pressing horizontally left and releasing power, right hand turned beneath the elbow bringing the forearm forward horizontally to issue elbow power

图 L2F64

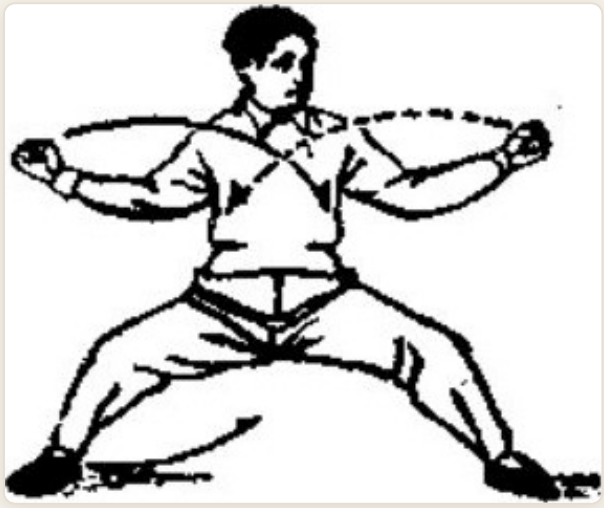


Both palms crossed and closed together, crotch rounded and sunk, left foot stepping out into a bow stance

图 L2F65

Issuing the left-shoulder leaning power, right foot solid

图 L2F66

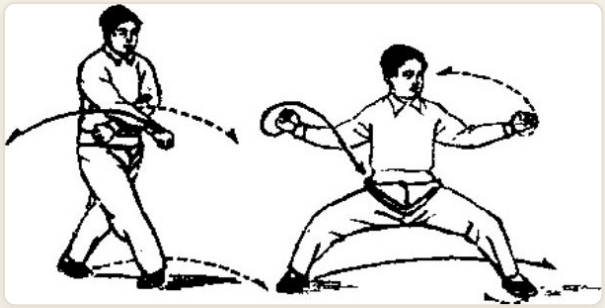


Right hand twisting ni downward and inward striking to the rear, left hand twisting shun upward and outward striking upward

图 L2F67

Right hand twisting ni chopping down with the palm edge from front-high to front-low, left hand striking to the left-rear as a feint, left foot landing solid to form a bow stance

图 L2F68



Right leg lifted and set down parallel to the left leg with a stomp to become solid, right hand changed from palm to fist placed at the right waist issuing power, left hand twisting ni releasing power backward

Action: From the opening of the previous form "covering-hand forearm punch," the right hand which had issued in front is gathered with forward coiling before the left shoulder; at the same time, the left hand reverse-coils and extends before the chest. At the same time the centre of gravity shifts right, and the body turns right. (Figure 50) Then, next, the two fists separate to left and right. (Figure 51) Then · 214 · open; because it is a relaxed chopping power, when doing the next fist-form one uses the elasticity of the downward chop to lead the body up, as if gathering the power from all four sides into a single point and lifting with it. And by the time the right foot lands with a stomp and the left foot stretches out in a step, there is again in the mind the intention of spreading the power out. This is the spirit this fist-form should have.

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Form 41. Taming the Tiger (chest turning from east to southeast)

Form 41. Taming the Tiger (chest turning from east to southeast)

Movement: after the issuing of power of the right fist in the preceding form, the right fist is drawn back with a ni twist, while the left hand, twisting ni, becomes a fist and is released open toward the left-front. As the right fist twists ni to the rear, the right foot behind shifts a further half step to the rear-right and becomes solid; and when the right fist, twisting ni, has made one large circle to the right-outside and then a small circle, so that it reaches the left forehead corner, the fist-form of Taming the Tiger is completed. At the same time, the drawn-back left fist makes a small circle to the left-inside, and when it turns to the left waist side, it props at the left waist. Now the right foot is solid and the left foot empty. (Figure 69)

Key points: When this form rotates one large circle left and right, front and rear, up and down (a great storing of power), the body must sink ever lower as it turns, and at the same time the large circle must also turn ever smaller—this is the clearest example of forming a downward spiral of the body. What distinguishes this form from ordinary fist-forms is that it forms its stored movement in an open posture; for the lower the body turns, the greater the elasticity of the power stored in the legs. This stored power can prepare the elastic force for the light and nimble springing up of the next form. This is the lowest fist-form in the Second Routine, and also the clearest fist-form of the silk-reeling of the legs coordinated with the silk-reeling of the hands.

Form 42. Wiping the Brows Red (chest turning from southeast to north, then to south)

图 L2F69

Right fist twisting ni making a large circle to the right-outside and then a small circle to reach the left forehead corner, left fist propping at the left waist, right foot solid and left foot empty

图 L2F70

Right hand flings downward with forward-twisting, left fist makes a reverse-twisting full circle upward, torso lifted with right foot springing forward and both feet off the ground

图 L2F71

Having leapt to the opposite side with the right foot landing, the torso turns 180° left in midair and the left fist lowers to the waist

图 L2F72

Right hand makes a forward-twisting downward circle before the chest, right foot lifts as empty

图 L2F73

Right hand circles upward, right foot lands as solid

图 L2F74

Right hand continues circling to stir the water, left fist propping the waist, right foot shifting between empty and solid

Movement: the preceding fist-form is a great body-storing method; in doing this form, then, it is on the basis of the preceding Key points: According to the requirements of motor skill, the simpler the fist posture, the harder it is to fulfill the requirement that one movement moves everything. In this posture only the single right hand circles, with the right foot coordinating in up-and-down division of empty and solid to carry out the movement; such a movement is comparatively simple, and therefore it is a basic exercise for training the silk-reeling energy to achieve joint-by-joint continuity. To achieve "one movement moves everything," the key still lies in the leading of the waist-spine and the loosening-open of the arm's energy, circling like a whip — this is where the crux of doing this posture well lies.

This is precisely the second segment of the second routine of the form, and it may be repeated several times as needed. Because before "stirring the water," a whole series of fairly intense movements has been performed in succession, so here one may obtain a certain rest and recovery.

· 217 · Forty-fourth Posture: Left Yellow Dragon Stirs the Water Three Times (chest facing south, turning north)

图 L2F75

After turning the body, the left fist opens and meets upward to the right, the left hand circles to the left with reverse-twisting, and the right hand after a small forward-twist rests at the right waist

图 L2F76

Left hand circles to stir the water in front of the body, left foot lifts as empty

图 L2F77

Left hand circles upward, left foot lands as solid

Movement: Continuing from the previous posture, turn the body around and change to the left hand "stirring the water" and circling. Its method is basically the same as the right hand's "stirring the water" movement; the difference is that when the left and right hands alternate and the body turns, the internal energy must be kept unbroken. In the previous posture, when the right hand has circled down and turned left, the left fist propping at the left waist opens and reverse-twists upward to the right to meet it, forming a joining with the left slightly lower and the right slightly higher. At this moment the right foot lifts as empty; as soon as they cross, both hands immediately become double reverse-twisting, and led by the waist-spine and drawn by the right hand, the body turns and carries a turn of 180° to the right. At the same time, the right foot lands as solid and serves as the pivot of the rotation. Following this, the left foot also immediately arcs around with the body and is placed to the west side of the right foot, completing the process of turning the body. At the same time, the left hand circles to the left side from reverse-twisting to forward-twisting, while the right hand, after a small forward-twist, is placed at the right side of the waist. (Figure 75) This is the starting point after "Left Yellow Dragon Stirs the Water Three Times" has turned the body. Thereafter, just as with "Right Yellow Dragon Stirs the Water Three Times," when the left hand circles downward, the left foot must lift as empty. (Figure 76) When the left hand circles upward, the left foot again drops as solid. (Figure 77), completing one "stirring the water." Then do two more "stirring the water" movements. (Fig. 78, 77, then again 78, 77, 78)

Key points: The requirements of this posture itself are the same as those of "Right Yellow Dragon Stirs the Water Three Times," but special attention must be paid to the fact that at the moment of turning the body and changing hands, one must not only turn with a gentle curve, but at the same time must also keep the movement threaded through as one breath, allowing no

interruption and no hollows or bumps to occur. The crux lies in that when the left hand opens and joins with the right hand, forming a mutual linkage of the two arms, one can, upon separating again for one turn, pass the energy from the right hand over to the left hand.

Although the key points and movement of this posture are the same as the previous posture, in order to give the left hand the same degree of nimbleness as the right hand, this posture may be done several or a dozen times; in this posture the position of the right foot does not change, so doing it several times in place does no harm to the structure of the entire form.

Forty-fifth Posture: Left Kick with One (Single) Leg (chest facing north)

图 L2F78

Left hand forward-twists and arcs from inside outward, left hand propping the waist opening and closing, left foot shifting between empty and solid

图 L2F79

Both hands gather and close in front of the abdomen, opposed to the body's center, both feet standing

图 L2F80

Left arm forward-twists and arcs outward, right hand opens and circles in opposition, left foot lifts — the initiating pose of the kick

Movement: After the above "stirring the water," when the left arm forward-twists and arcs from inside to outside, the right hand propping the waist opens and takes the opportunity to join in a circling that is at once opposed and at once divided; when turning after passing one circle and then turning downward, it becomes a double closing energy. At this moment palm faces palm, both hands opposed and slightly narrower than the shoulders, placed in front of the abdomen. When the right hand joins in and finally closes, the left foot goes from solid to empty. (Figure 79) With the two hands ceaselessly circling, continue to tighten into a single closing with a double forward-twist, making both palms become fists crossing before the chest. At this moment the left hand is outside and the right hand inside; at the same time, raise the left leg. (Figure 80) After reaching the end point of the crossing, issue the energy with both hands and the left foot together, each with full force to left and right. This is kicking out the left foot with energy while standing on the right foot alone. At this moment the left hand is host and the right hand is guest. (Figure 81)

Key points: The elastic energy of this posture is a double opening energy produced within the double closing, because when the two hands are in a double closing, the elbows and upper arms have a double opening energy. At the same time, when the two feet bend slightly and close

doubly, the rounding of the crotch gives the legs a double opening energy as well. This shows that both arms and legs have a linked outward-bracing energy; this is the crux of being able to issue energy crisply. When the two hands and the left foot split and issue to the left and right sides together, because of the stabilizing effect of the two hands' splitting, the torso obtains a certain stability at the moment of issuing. This kind of energy issuance is a good method for training the joint ligaments and strengthening their elasticity.

Forty-sixth Posture: Right Kick with One (Single) Leg (chest facing north, turning south)

Movement: After the previous posture "Left Kick with One Leg," the two hands close to the left with reverse-twisting, drawing the torso to turn left; at the same time the left foot lands with a stamping of the foot, and the right leg is raised, forming standing on the left leg alone, with the two hands closing their energy on both sides of the right knee. (Figure 82) Then issue the energy with both hands and the right foot together, each with full force to left and right — this is kicking out the right foot with energy while standing on the left foot alone. At this moment the right hand is host and the left hand is guest. (Figure 83)

图 L2F81

After the hands have crossed to the end point, both hands and the left foot issue energy together to left and right; in the right-leg-standing posture the left foot kicks out, with the left hand as host and the right hand as guest.

图 L2F82

Standing on the left leg alone with both hands closing energy on both sides of the right knee, the right foot kicking out and issuing to left and right

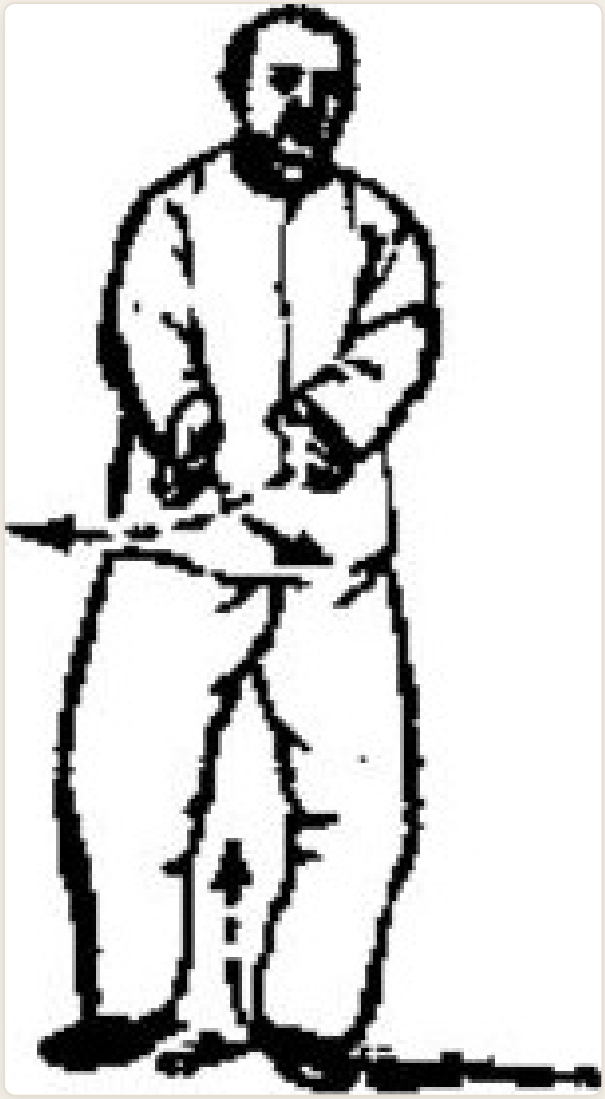
图 L2F83

Standing on the left foot alone, both hands and the right foot issuing energy together to left and right

图 L2F84

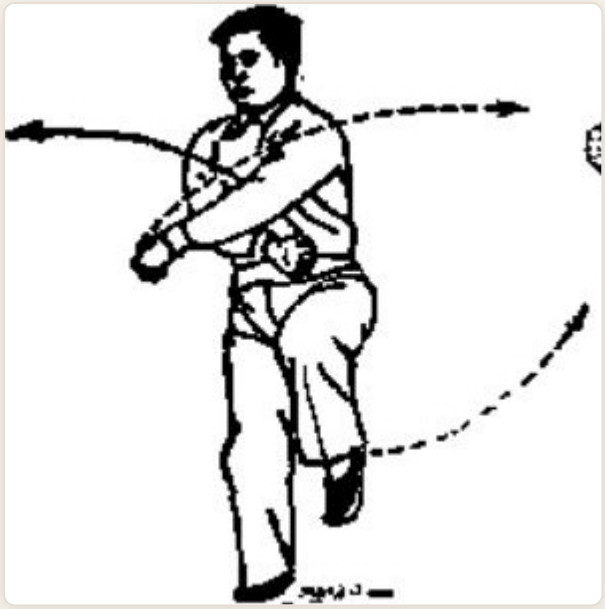
"Sea Bottom Turns Over the Flower," turning the body with a smaller amplitude to turn over the flower

图 L2F85



"Cover-Hand Forearm Punch" issuing energy, right fist issuing forward with reverse-twisting and left fist releasing to the rear with reverse-twisting

图 L2F86



Right hand in front draws back with reverse-twisting then circles forward, left hand behind circles forward then backward with reverse-twisting

图 L2F87

Right hand draws back with reverse-twisting to before the right waist, right foot stamps, left fist raises forward-upward with reverse-twisting

Forty-ninth Posture: Sweeping-Leg (turning the waist and smashing, chest facing east, turning north, then turning south and again turning north)

Movement: After the energy issuance of "Cover-Hand Forearm Punch," the right hand in front draws back with reverse-twisting and then makes a circle forward, while the left hand behind

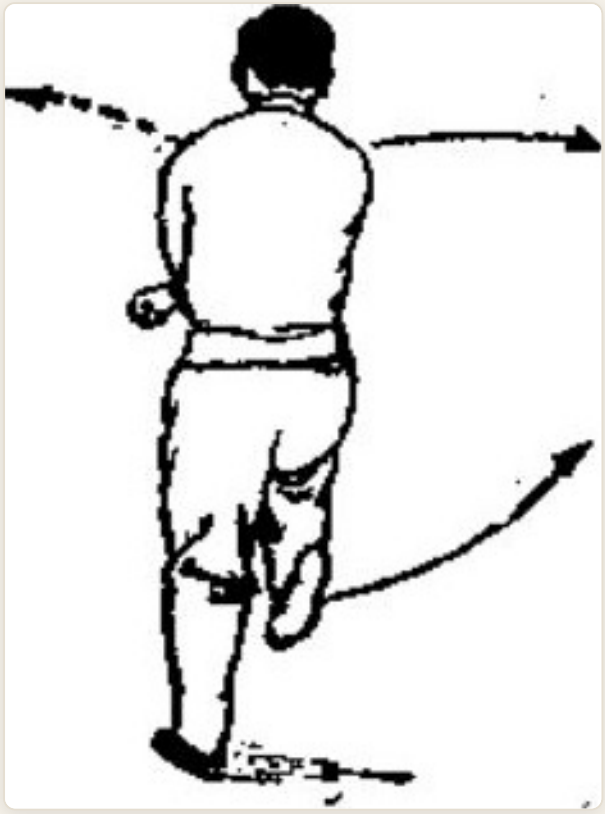
circles forward and then backward with reverse-twisting. (Figure 86) When the right hand again draws back with reverse-twisting from the front to before the right waist, the right foot stamps the ground with a stamping of the foot; at this moment the left fist raises forward-upward with reverse-twisting. (Figure 87) Immediately after the stamping of the foot, the right toe turns outward and steps out a small half-step to the right rear, forming a rotational momentum, carrying the body to turn toward the right rear · 222 · about 280°; the right leg squats down, and the left foot follows by extending the leg and arcing around to sweep-turn 280°, sweeping to the northwest of the right foot. (Figure 88)

Key points: This posture is for practicing the ankle-striking energy when the foot sweeps horizontally. In order to rotate the left leg stably and sweep one full circle horizontally, one must make the intent and energy manifest as though the right foot had taken root in the ground. Second, in order to strengthen the leg's horizontal sweeping energy, one must use the right foot's stepping a small half-step to the right rear with the toe turned out, to drive the rotation of the torso and form a rotational momentum. Third, one must coordinate upper and lower consistently, so that the torso can rotate nimbly yet steadily; this applies mainly to the first half-circle of the movement, where the change of posture goes from high to low, while in the latter circle of the movement the internal energy must again go from low to high and then land. This is also a comparatively difficult movement, a movement of leg-leading-body, which can lengthen and strengthen the leg muscles. In order to strengthen the leg's horizontal sweeping energy, it may be singled out for specialized free-hand practice, and one may also do two 360° sweeping-legs.

Fiftieth Posture: Cover-Hand Forearm Punch (chest facing north, turning east)

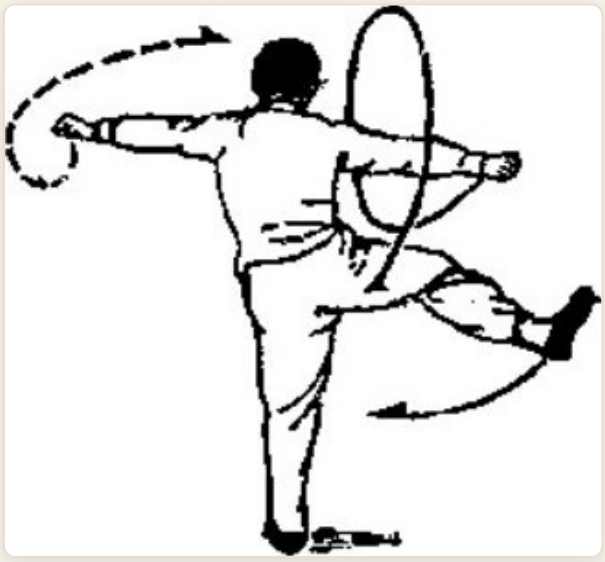
Movement: After the previous posture has turned through 280°, both hands cross and close before the chest ; then the two palms change and separately arc upward and spread out to the left and right sides; at the same time, the right foot lifts off the ground, and the left foot immediately pushes off the ground and springs up. Then the right foot lands to the southwest, and the left foot follows to land to the northeast. Both hands from above close before the chest with double reverse-twisting, then open with forward-twisting and close with reverse-twisting; then the right fist strikes out, and the left fist is drawn in beneath the left ribs. (Figure 90) What differs between this posture and the previous seventeenth posture is only the leaping-step movement; once both feet have landed, it is the same as the other "Cover-Hand Forearm Punch" postures.

图 L2F88



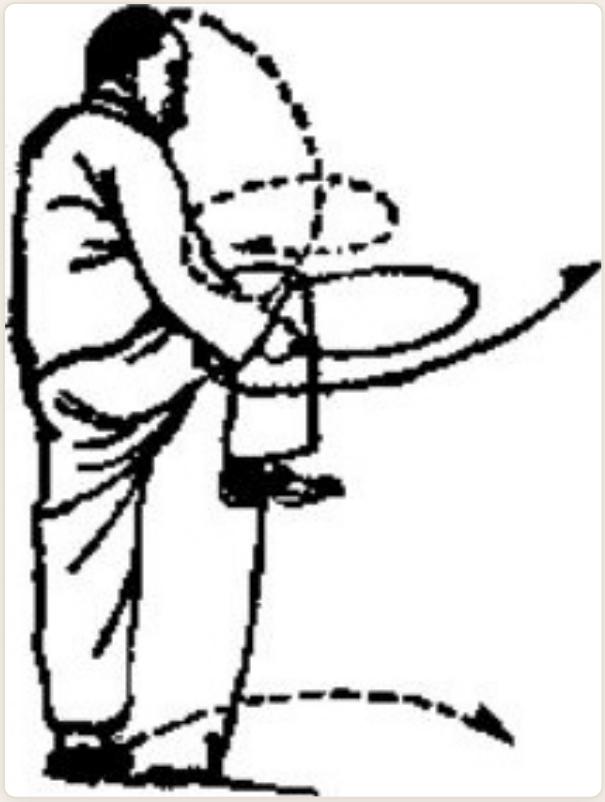
The left foot extends the leg and arcs around in a horizontal sweep to the northwest of the right foot, right leg squatting

图 L2F89甲



Both hands crossing and closing before the chest

图 L2F89乙



Both palms arcing open to left and right, right foot lifted off the ground and left foot pushing off to spring up

图 L2F91

Right bow stance, both fists thrust forward, gathering posture

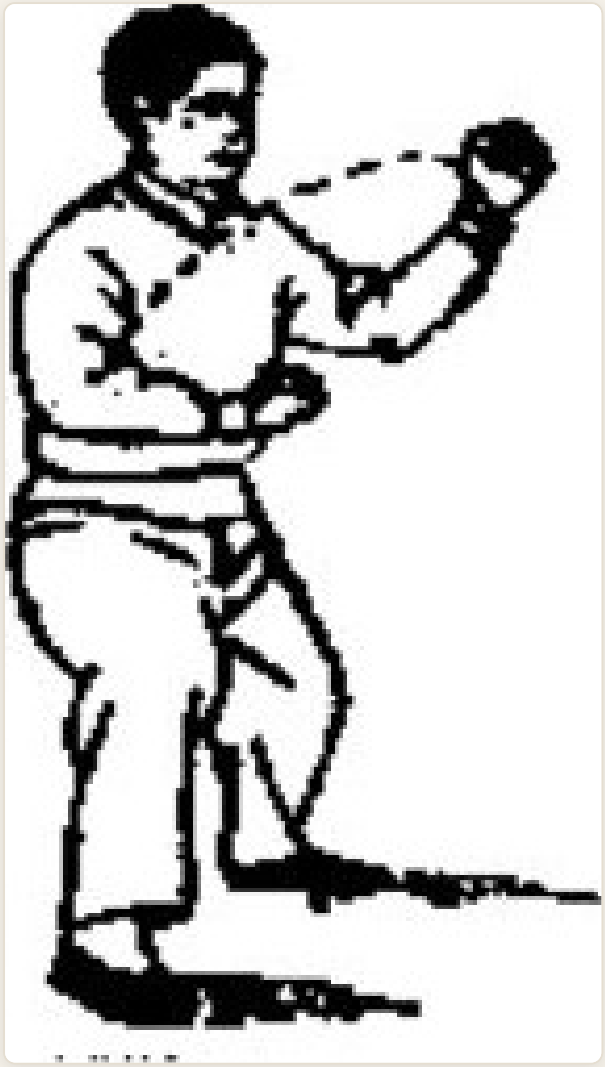
图 L2F92

Knee lifted in single-leg stance, both fists raised in a circling motion

图 L2F93

Left foot full, energy sunk and gathered

图 L2F94



Right foot full, both fists shaken forward

· 225 · —the swings gradually grow smaller, reducing step by step to a single circle; finally, as soon as the intention is aroused, the shaking energy can be issued in the same way. This is the deepest skill in issuing shaking energy.

Fifty-second Form — Right Thrust (chest facing east)

Movement: Because the movement begins with the right leg in front, it is called "Right Thrust". In this form the right leg is in front first, and finally changes to the left leg in front; the two fists first travel from the left rib side to the right rib side, and after describing two large circles they shake out the energy. In these two respects this form is exactly the opposite of the previous form, so its movement path is symmetrical to that form. (Figs. 95, 96, 97)

Key points: Same as "Left Thrust".

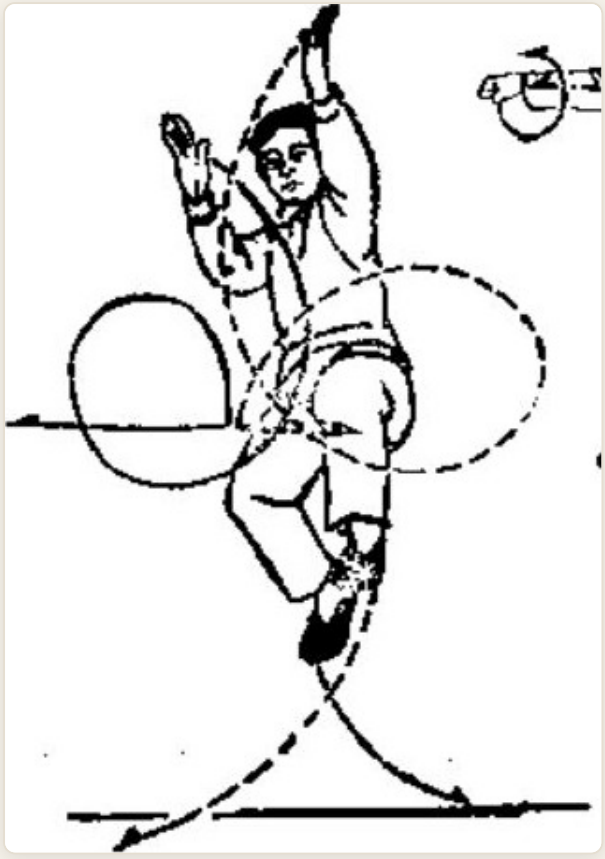
Fifty-third Form — Reverse Throw-Down (chest facing east, turning northeast)

Movement: After the previous form has issued the double shaking energy, suppose the right hand is plucked (this kind of plucking energy often makes the one plucked kneel down); in order to achieve sticking, adhering, connecting and following, so that there is no opposing resistance, the right hand follows downward with reverse twining, bringing the right hand together with the left hand. As they join, the left hand is placed beneath the plucking hand, and the right hand presses down, making a preliminary release. At this moment the right hand is full downward, the right foot steps up as empty, standing alongside the left foot with the toes touching the ground, so that the two hands are close to the upper and lower parts of one's own body; this is "release within joining", another example of overcoming weight with lightness. (Figure 98)

图 L2F95

Knee lifted with fists held, gathering and turning

图 L2F96



Bow stance advancing, both fists circling and sinking

图 L2F97

Right leg in front bow stance, both fists shaken forward

· 226 · Fifty-fourth Form — Turning the Flower at the Seabed (chest facing east)

Movement: If in the previous form the reverse insertion cannot achieve "release within joining", then sink further and suddenly turn, lengthening the body, and change into opening the hands above and below. This is done with the energy adhering to the spine, the body led up by the crown energy, as a second release; it is the method of "release within opening" after "release within joining". Simultaneously with this "opening release", the right hand twines with forward twining to the upper right and then turns to the lower right, the left hand twines with reverse twining to the lower left and then turns to the upper left; the whole body lengthens, the left foot stands alone, the right foot is lifted (as preparation for a kick); the left fist releases energy upward to the left, with the fist centre facing right; the right fist releases energy downward to the right waist side, with the fist centre facing forward. Its movement is the same as the previous "Turning the Flower at the Seabed" forms, except that this form turns the body only slightly, whereas the previous forms turned the body through a larger range. (Figure 99)

图 L2F98

Both feet together, hands joined at the side

图 L2F99

Left foot standing alone, hands opening above and below, Turning the Flower at the Seabed

图 L2F100

Bow stance, covering hand and forearm punch, right fist issuing energy forward

图 L2F101

Both fists joined and drawn in, left foot stepping forward

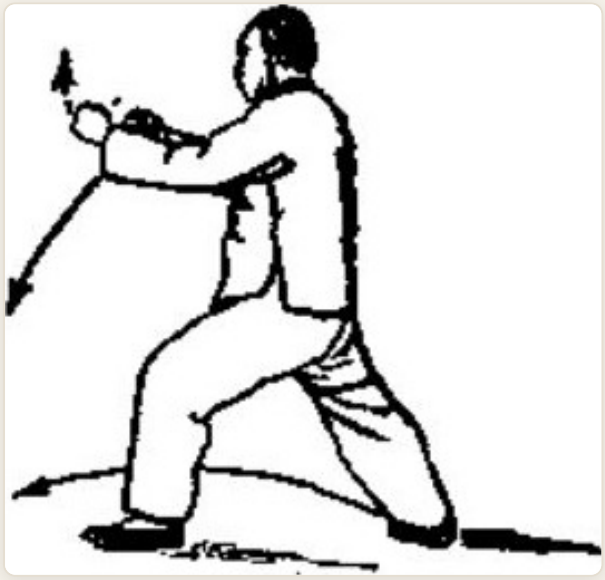
图 L2F102

Right fist bent outward, left fist bent inward, energy joined and stored

图 L2F103

Right foot darting forward issuing energy, right arm thrust sideways, left fist releasing energy backward

图 L2F104



Bow stance advancing, both fists twining with upper and lower energies opposed

Key points: Taijiquan often uses downward plucking energy, so that the opponent cannot easily use connecting and following to gain release; for this reason the right hand twines with reverse twining downward, the right foot steps forward, and the left hand is placed beneath the plucking

hand. Because the right foot steps up in "Reverse Insertion", one's own two hands are brought close to one's own centre of the circle, thereby increasing the moment applied to the opponent while reducing one's own moment; one large and one small — this is again a model of overcoming weight with lightness, and can make one · 230 · —preparation for storing energy. (Figure 105)

After the left step has been taken in the previous form, the second right step is taken in succession; this is the final step of the ren-shaped upward step. The two fists, like a windmill, twine over one another inside and outside in front of the chest through one large circle. In the previous movement, when the right fist twines forward, upward and inward with forward twining, the right foot is drawn back half a step with the toes touching the ground. Then the right fist sinks its energy downward in front of the chest in coordination with the left fist moving upward, so as to release the plucked right hand a second time. At the same time the right foot shakes downward in a stamp, and taking advantage of the momentum darts forward along the ground. Simultaneously the right fist, arm held horizontally, moves forward and issues energy horizontally outward. (Figure 106)

Key points: If the warding-off issuing energy of the previous form is still not enough to release the plucked right hand, then to avoid opposing resistance one must use connecting and following and, dragging along, step up in succession. Therefore the main content of practice in this form is to step forward two paces in succession without any break in energy occurring, and to have at all times the opportunity to release and to strike. To attain this requirement, the key point is that the two arms are linked together so that the two fists turn over up and down in the course of advancing, shaking the spine to shake off the plucking of the right hand.